2009 Honda Civic SI (FG2)

Complete Build Guide

Chassis: FG2 (8th Gen Coupe)

Engine: K20Z3 -- 2.0L i-VTEC, 197 HP / 139 lb-ft (stock)

Transmission: 6-Speed Manual

Mileage: ~170,000 miles

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2009 Honda Civic SI Coupe -- My Build Log

Chassis: FG2 (8th Gen Coupe) **Engine:** K20Z3 -- 2.0L i-VTEC, 197 HP / 139 lb-ft (stock) **Transmission:** 6-Speed Manual **Color:** Blue **Mileage:** ~170,000 miles

What I'm Going For

Daily-drivable with a sport mode toggle. Quiet when I need it, loud when I want it. I'm building a full bolt-on NA K20Z3 targeting **220-240 WHP on pump gas, 230-250 WHP on E85** -- headers, intake manifold, throttle body, exhaust, pulleys, flex fuel, and a Hondata tune to tie it all together. I'm doing a valved 3" exhaust with a QTP cutout so I can switch between a quiet daily tune and an aggressive straight-piped sport tune. Flex fuel with real-time ethanol content sensing lets me run pump gas or E85 seamlessly. And eventually, I'm putting a LattePanda mini PC in the car for permanent Hondata management and exhaust valve control.

The rule that overrides everything: engine longevity comes before power. Every tune ships as two calibrations (Daily + Sport), and Sport means "squeeze the engine for everything it's got WITHIN the reliability envelope" -- not "push it to the edge." See 07-Hondata-FlashPro/tuning-workflow-and-maps.md for the tuning rules I'll live by.

Modification Status

Installed

#	Mod	Part	Actual Cost	Status
1	Clutch & Flywheel	Exedy Stage 1 Organic (08806) + Exedy Lightweight Flywheel (HF02)	$960.43*	Installed
2	Cold Air Intake	K&N Typhoon 69-1014TS	$504.17	Installed
3	Short Shifter + Bushings	Acuity 3-Way Adjustable + Trans-Side Bushings	$622.20	Installed
4	Tires	Continental ExtremeContact DWS06 Plus 215/45ZR17 91W XL	$715.00	Installed

\$960.43 includes clutch, flywheel, and strut bar bundled together (incl. tax/shipping)*

Purchased -- Awaiting Install

#	Mod	Part	Actual Cost	Status	Notes
5	Engine Mounts	Hybrid Racing 70A	$657.15	Awaiting install	
6	Brakes	Hawk HPS Pads + R1 Concepts Slotted Rotors	$532.14	Awaiting install	Full 4-corner upgrade
7	Strut Bar	Megan Racing Race Spec Front Upper (Polished)	(in #1)	Deferred until coilovers -- BC Racing camber plates will change strut-top geometry anyway	
8	Hondata FlashPro	Hondata FlashPro	$859.59	Awaiting first flash	ECU tuning, datalogging, gauges

Total spent to date: $4,850.68 (all prices include tax, shipping, and insurance)

Planned -- Not Yet Purchased

#	Mod	Details	Notes
8	Valved Exhaust	DIY 3" QTP cutout bypass (keep OEM mufflers)	3" dump, step-down to 2.5" for muffled path
9	Headers	Skunk2 Alpha 4-2-1 (412-05-1930) + Berk HFC	Best available, stepped primaries, 10-18 WHP
10	Intake Manifold	Skunk2 Ultra Street + bored stock TB (66mm)	Larger plenum, shorter runners, DBW compatible
11	Pulleys & Harmonic Balancer	ATI Super Damper + NST accessory pulleys	Proper damping + reduced parasitic loss
12	Flex Fuel & Fuel System	Flex fuel sensor + Bosch EV14 550cc injectors + Acuity rail + DW300C pump	E85 capable, 5-15 WHP on NA over pump gas
13	Clutch Hydraulics	Hybrid Racing HYB-CMC-01-20 complete kit + rear main seal + throwout bearing	170k-mile reliability upgrade + "free labor while trans is out" bonus items
14	Suspension	BC Racing BR coilovers + full bushing refresh + sway bars + camber kit	Complete suspension overhaul -- coilovers, bushings, geometry correction
15	Ignition Refresh	NGK plugs + OEM Honda coils (30520-RWC-A01) + VTC actuator (14310-RBC-003 updated part)	New. Critical before any tune. Fixes cold-start rattle.
16	Cooling System	Koyorad HH060063 aluminum radiator + OEM thermostat + hoses + water pump	New. Plastic end tank failure insurance + headroom for E85 heat. Must precede headers.
17	Wideband AFR	AEM X-Series 30-0300 wideband UEGO	New. Required before any dyno tune. Integrates with FlashPro analog input.
--	In-Car PC	LattePanda 3 Delta permanent install	Controls FlashPro + exhaust valve

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How This Repo Is Organized

Each mod has its own folder with some subset of:

- **overview.md** -- What the mod is, why I chose it, part numbers, status
- **install-guide.md** -- Step-by-step install instructions
- **brainstorm.md** -- Research, alternatives I considered, pros/cons, things I ruled out
- **purchasing.md** -- Parts list with part numbers and prices

Simple bolt-ons might only have an overview. Complex mods (valved exhaust, LattePanda, headers) have all four.

Special Folders

- 07-Hondata-FlashPro/Temporary-Setup/ -- Getting started with a laptop before the permanent install
- 07-Hondata-FlashPro/Permanent-LattePanda-Install/ -- Full guide for the in-car PC build
- 07-Hondata-FlashPro/tuning-workflow-and-maps.md -- Daily/Sport map rules, reliability-first ceilings, and how I work with Claude on tune changes
- 08-Valved-Exhaust/ -- My DIY valved exhaust design, parts, and planning
- docs/ -- Cross-cutting reference documents

Docs

- docs/mod-order-and-maintenance.md -- Chronological mod order + 170k-mile maintenance plan
- docs/vehicle-specs.md -- Stock specs for the FG2
- docs/install-references.md -- Guides, videos, and community threads I've collected
- docs/torque-specs.md -- **New.** K20Z3 / FG2 torque reference for every fastener I'll touch
- docs/maintenance-parts-catalog.md -- **New.** OE + aftermarket part numbers in one place
- docs/baseline-logs.md -- **New.** A/B datalog protocol for every mod

Quick Reference

Spec	Value
Engine Code	K20Z3
ECU Code	PRB (37820-RRB-A58 or similar)
Displacement	1998cc (2.0L)
Compression	11.0:1
Stock HP / TQ	197 HP @ 7800 RPM / 139 lb-ft @ 6200 RPM
Redline	8000 RPM (fuel cut at 8200 RPM)
Stock Exhaust Diameter	2.36" (60mm) from cat back
Fuel	Premium 91+ octane required
OBD2 Port	Under dash, left of steering column
Interior Fuse Box	Driver side lower dash, behind removable panel
Fuse Type (Interior)	Mini blade

Build Principles I'm Living By

1. **Reliability over power, always.** At 170k I'd rather leave 10 WHP on the table than risk a bearing.
2. **Every tune = Daily + Sport maps.** Quiet daily mode, aggressive-but-safe sport mode.
3. **Cross-reference every decision.** If Mod X changes the situation for Mod Y, the Y doc says so explicitly.
4. **Phase 0 maintenance comes first.** A sick engine can't be tuned well no matter what parts go on.
5. **No lean WOT fuel, ever, on any tune.** Pump gas = 12.0 AFR minimum; E85 = lambda 0.82 minimum.
6. **Dyno verification for every timing change.** No armchair advances.

Contributing / AI Assistant Reference

See CLAUDE.md for the AI assistant reference file containing full context about this build, conventions, and instructions for AI tools assisting with this project.

Last updated: 2026-04-18

2009 Honda Civic SI Coupe (FG2) -- Vehicle Specifications

Stock specs for my car. I put this together as a quick reference since I'm constantly looking up bolt sizes, torque specs, and dimensions when planning mods.

General

Spec	Value
Year	2009
Make / Model	Honda Civic SI
Trim	SI (top performance trim)
Body Style	Coupe (2-door)
Generation	8th Gen (2006-2011)
Chassis Code	FG2
Production	East Liberty Auto Plant, Ohio

Engine

Spec	Value
Engine Code	K20Z3
Type	2.0L DOHC i-VTEC Inline-4
Displacement	1998cc
Bore x Stroke	86mm x 86mm
Compression Ratio	11.0:1
Horsepower	197 HP @ 7800 RPM
Torque	139 lb-ft @ 6200 RPM
Redline	8000 RPM (fuel cut at 8200 RPM)
VTEC Crossover	~5800 RPM (stock)
Fuel System	Sequential multi-port fuel injection
Fuel Requirement	Premium unleaded 91+ octane
Engine Management	Keihin PRB ECU
Emissions	ULEV-2

Transmission

Spec	Value
Type	6-speed manual
Transmission Code	K20Z3 close-ratio 6MT
Final Drive	4.764:1
LSD	Helical limited-slip differential (front)

Brakes (Stock)

Spec	Front	Rear
Type	Ventilated disc	Solid disc
Diameter	11.8" (300mm)	10.2" (260mm)
Caliper	Single-piston sliding	Single-piston sliding

Suspension (Stock)

Spec	Front	Rear
Type	MacPherson strut	Multi-link
Anti-roll bar	Yes	Yes

Dimensions

Spec	Value
Wheelbase	104.3"
Length	175.4"
Width	68.9"
Height	54.7"
Curb Weight	~2,877 lbs
Weight Distribution	~61/39 F/R

Electrical

Spec	Value
Battery	12V, Group 51R
Alternator	~130A
OBD2 Port	Under dash, left of steering column
Interior Fuse Box	Driver side lower dash, mini blade fuses
Engine Bay Fuse Box	Near battery, standard blade fuses

Exhaust (Stock)

Spec	Value
Header	Cast iron log-style manifold
Catalytic Converter	Close-coupled to header
Pipe Diameter (cat-back)	2.36" (60mm)
Resonator	Yes (mid-pipe)

Muffler	Single oval canister, rear
Tailpipe Exit	Single, driver side

Chronological Mod Order & 170k-Mile Maintenance Plan

2009 Honda Civic SI (FG2) -- K20Z3, ~170,000 miles, 6MT

This is my game plan -- the order I'm tackling every mod and the maintenance I need to knock out first. **Maintenance intervals here are based on community experience (8thcivic.com, Reddit r/CivicSi, K-series forums) -- NOT Honda's factory intervals**, which are way too conservative for a 17-year-old, 170k-mile sport compact that's actually been driven.

Phase 0: Critical Maintenance (Do First -- Before Any More Mods)

I need to handle these before adding any more power or stress to the drivetrain. At 170k miles, some of these are honestly overdue.

#	Item	Why	Community Interval	Est. Cost (DIY)	Est. Cost (Shop)
1	Timing chain inspection	K20Z3 uses a timing chain, not a belt -- no replacement interval. BUT chain stretch is real at 170k. A stretched chain causes retarded cam timing, VTEC engagement issues, and eventually jumps teeth. I already know this needs checking.	Inspect at 150k+. Replace if stretch measured or chain noise present.	$20 (inspection) / $300-500 (replacement parts)	$100 (inspection) / $800-1,200 (replacement)
2	Valve adjustment	K20Z3 has solid lifters (no hydraulic lash adjusters). Valves go tight over time -- tight valves burn. Community consensus: check every 30k-60k on a driven SI. At 170k, if never done or unknown history, this is urgent.	Every 30,000-60,000 miles	$10 (feeler gauges)	$150-250
3	Spark plugs	NGK ILZKR7B-11S (stock iridium, pre-gapped). Even iridium plugs degrade by 100k. At 170k, if they're original, they're well past done. Misfires, poor fuel economy, lost power.	Every 60,000-80,000 miles (community). Honda says 100k -- too long.	$40 (set of 4)	$80-120
4	Coolant flush + thermostat	OEM Honda Type 2 coolant (blue). At 170k, the coolant has been through thousands of heat cycles. Thermostat can stick partially open (overcooling) or closed (overheating). I'm replacing both proactively.	Coolant every 50,000-60,000 miles. Thermostat at 100k+ or with coolant flush.	$30 coolant + $15 thermostat	$100-150
5	Transmission fluid change	Honda MTF or Amsoil Synchromesh. The 8th gen SI 6MT synchros are sensitive to fluid quality. Notchy 2nd gear is often a fluid issue, not a synchro issue.	Every 30,000-40,000 miles	$25 (3 quarts Honda MTF)	$80-120
6	Brake fluid flush	DOT 4 (Motul RBF 600 or ATE TYP 200). Brake fluid is hygroscopic -- absorbs water, boiling point drops, internal corrosion increases. If never flushed, the fluid is original from 2009.	Every 2 years or 30,000 miles	$15	$80-100
7	Clutch fluid flush	Same as brake fluid but separate reservoir on the FG2. Especially important before the CMC/CSC upgrade.	Every 2 years or 30,000 miles	$10	$50-80
8	Serpentine belt	Visual inspection -- cracking, glazing, squealing. At 170k, I'm likely on the 2nd or 3rd belt. Replace if there are any signs of wear.	Every 60,000-80,000 miles or at first sign of wear	$25	$80-120
9	Water pump	K20Z3 water pump is driven by the timing chain. I'll inspect it during the timing chain inspection. Weeping from the weep hole = replace immediately.	Inspect at timing chain service. Replace proactively at 150k+.	$50 (pump)	Included in timing chain labor

10	Motor oil + filter	Honda recommends 0W-20, but community consensus for a 170k-mile K20Z3 that's driven hard: 5W-30 full synthetic (Mobil 1, Pennzoil Platinum, or Castrol Edge). Thicker oil compensates for worn bearing clearances.	Every 5,000-6,000 miles with synthetic. Honda says 7,500 -- too long for an SI driven spiritedly.	$35	$60-80
11	PCV valve	17130-RTA-000 or equivalent. Cheap, easy, often neglected. A failed PCV causes oil consumption, rough idle, and boost leaks if ever turbo'd.	Every 60,000-80,000 miles	$10	$30-50
12	VTC actuator (REVISED part 14310-RBC-003)	#1 K20Z3 gripe on 8thcivic -- the cold-start rattle. Original actuator's spring weakens; new part has stronger spring and better locking pin. Universal replacement at 170k. Free labor if doing timing chain inspection. Critical before any dyno tune.	At timing chain service or 150k+	$280 (DIY)	$280 + $150-300 labor if standalone
13	Valve cover gasket + plug tube seals	OEM 12030-RRA-A01 kit. Universal 170k oil leaker. Oil in plug wells will foul new spark plugs in weeks. Cheap fix.	150k+	$40	$120-180
14	Oil filter housing gasket/o-ring	OEM 15301-PT0-003. Weeps at 170k. $8 fix while oil is drained for oil change.	150k+	$8	$50

Timing Chain Deep Dive

The K20Z3 timing chain is rated for the life of the engine, but "life of the engine" assumes Honda's idea of a normal lifecycle (~200k miles of grandma driving). On a 170k-mile SI that's been driven like an SI:

- **How to check:** I can measure cam timing with the Hondata FlashPro. Retarded cam timing (more than 2-3 degrees off spec) indicates chain stretch. A mechanic can also check with a dial indicator on the tensioner.
- **Chain noise:** A rattling or slapping noise at cold start (first 5-10 seconds) that goes away once oil pressure builds is the classic symptom of a stretched chain with a maxed-out tensioner.
- **If the chain is fine:** No action needed. I'll recheck at 200k.
- **If the chain is stretched:** Replace chain, tensioner, guides, and VTC actuator as a set. Do NOT replace just the chain. Budget $300-500 in parts, $600-900 in labor (or 8-12 hours DIY).

Phase 0.5: Ignition Refresh -- Between Maintenance and Mods

After the fluids/belt/PCV maintenance but BEFORE any dyno tune session, the ignition system gets its own focused refresh. See 15-Ignition-Refresh/overview.md for full detail.

#	Item	Why	Approx Cost
1	NGK ILZKR7B-11S plugs x4 (pump gas)	New iridium plugs before any tune work -- clean spark baseline	~$40
2	Honda OEM coils 30520-RWC-A01 x4	Tired coils misfire on E85 tunes and get blamed on tuning	~$160-200
3	Honda VTC actuator 14310-RBC-003 (updated part)	Fixes cold-start rattle. Free labor during timing chain inspection. Must be fresh before any tune.	~$280
	Subtotal		~$480-520

Cross-reference: Do VTC actuator DURING timing chain inspection (Phase 0). Plugs + coils can wait until just before Phase 1E (FlashPro first flash).

Phase 1: Immediate Installs (Already Purchased or Priority Purchase, No Dependencies)

These mods are already bought (or need to be bought first) and have no dependencies. Install order within this phase doesn't really matter -- they're all standalone.

Order	Mod	Time (DIY)	Standalone?	Notes
1A	Clutch hydraulics (CMC/CSC)	3-5 hrs	Yes	Not yet purchased -- priority buy. I need to do this before anything else. 170k miles = ticking time bomb. Improves pedal feel immediately. Also do: rear main seal (91214-RDA-A01), throwout + pilot bearings, fresh MTF while trans is out. See 13-Clutch-Hydraulics/overview.md cross-reference section.
1B	Engine mounts (Hybrid Racing 70A)	3-4 hrs	Yes	Reduces wheel hop, improves shift feel. NVH increase is noticeable but livable.
1C	Brakes (Hawk HPS + R1 Concepts rotors)	2-3 hrs	Yes	Full 4-corner upgrade. I need to bed the pads properly (follow Hawk's bedding procedure). Want this done before I have more power to stop.
1D	Strut bar (Megan Racing)	30 min	DEFERRED -- don't diagnose now	BC Racing BR coilovers (Phase 5) replace the strut-top geometry entirely. Whatever fits or doesn't fit today will be different once coilovers are in. Revisit after suspension overhaul. See 06-Strut-Bar/overview.md.
1E	Hondata FlashPro -- first flash	1-2 hrs	Yes	Register unit, flash base map, verify no CELs. I'm not tuning yet -- just getting it online. This enables datalogging for all future work. See 07-Hondata-FlashPro/tuning-workflow-and-maps.md for the tuning rules.
1F	Cooling system refresh	2-3 hrs	Yes	New phase addition. Koyorad aluminum radiator + fresh OEM thermostat + hoses. Must precede headers and E85. See 16-Cooling-System/overview.md.
1G	Wideband AFR install	1-2 hrs + bung welding	Tied to header install	AEM X-Series 30-0300 wideband. Bung welds into Skunk2 Alpha header collector during Phase 2B. See 17-Wideband-AFR/overview.md.

My planned order within Phase 1: 1A -> 1F -> 1C -> 1B -> 1E -> 1G (at header install) -> 1D (at coilover install)

- **1A Clutch hydraulics first** -- reliability risk at this mileage + RMS job shares labor
- **1F Cooling refresh** -- must be done before headers; not time-critical but same weekend as 1A works fine since I'm already under the car
- **1C Brakes** -- more power needs more stopping; independent of other jobs
- **1B Engine mounts** -- quality-of-life; no dependencies
- **1E FlashPro first flash** -- AFTER ignition refresh (Phase 0.5) is done; clean baseline for datalogging
- **1G Wideband** -- physically ties into the 2B header install; bung gets welded when the system is off the car
- **1D Strut bar** -- defer entirely until after coilovers (Phase 5)

Phase 2: Exhaust System (Must Be Done Together)

The valved exhaust and headers are interrelated. My plan is to install the exhaust cutout first, tune it, then add headers and retune.

Order	Mod	Time (DIY)	Standalone?	Notes
2A	Valved exhaust (QTP QTEC30 cutout)	4-6 hrs (shop recommended for welding)	Semi-standalone	Install cutout + dump pipe + reducer. Get both tunes working (valve open/closed). I can do this without headers using the stock manifold.
2B	Headers (Skunk2 Alpha + Berk HFC)	6-10 hrs DIY / 3-5 hrs shop	Must be done with 2A complete	PB Blaster the manifold studs 3-5 days before. I'll probably have a shop do this ($300-500 labor) -- seized stud risk at 170k is real.
2C	Hondata retune (dyno)	2-3 hrs on dyno	Must be done after 2A+2B	Tune both calibrations (daily quiet + sport loud) with headers installed. Verify AFR in both valve positions. Budget $300-500 for dyno tune.

Important: Do NOT install headers without planning the exhaust cutout first. Headers change the entire exhaust flow, and the cutout position needs to account for header length + HFC placement. I'm installing the cutout first (2A), validating it works, then adding headers (2B) and retuning everything (2C).

Stud prep is critical: I'm starting PB Blaster on the exhaust manifold studs at least 3-5 days before the header install. Heat cycle the car + spray daily. At 170k miles, those studs WILL be seized. I'll have new M10x1.25 stainless studs and copper-plated flange nuts ready.

Phase 3: Intake System (Must Be Done Together, After Exhaust)

The intake manifold and throttle body work together and need a retune after install.

Order	Mod	Time (DIY)	Standalone?	Notes
3A	Intake manifold (Skunk2 Ultra Street)	3-5 hrs	Paired with 3B	I could technically install this alone, but doing it with the TB at the same time saves a retune.
3B	Bored throttle body (stock DBW -> 66mm)	N/A (send out for boring)	Paired with 3A	I'll send the stock TB to Drag Cartel or HeelToe Auto for boring to 66mm. Lead time: 1-2 weeks. I need to order this BEFORE buying the manifold so both arrive together.
3C	Hondata retune (dyno)	2-3 hrs on dyno	Must be done after 3A+3B	Retune for the new manifold + TB. This is the "full bolt-on" tune. Budget $300-500.

Why after exhaust: The intake manifold tune depends on exhaust flow. If I tune the manifold first and then change headers, I'd need to retune again -- wasted dyno time and money. Headers -> intake manifold -> single comprehensive tune is more efficient.

Note: My K&N Typhoon cold air intake (already installed) stays in the system. The flow path becomes: K&N filter -> intake pipe -> bored TB -> Skunk2 Ultra Street manifold -> K20Z3.

Phase 4: Rotating Assembly (Standalone, After Full Bolt-On Tune)

Order	Mod	Time (DIY)	Standalone?	Notes
4A	Pulleys + Harmonic Balancer (ATI Super Damper + NST kit)	3-5 hrs	Yes	Standalone install. Requires crank bolt removal (impact gun needed, 250+ ft-lbs). Doesn't require a retune -- it's a mechanical change, not an airflow change.

Why after the tune: The pulley system doesn't affect tuning, but it does affect accessory drive belt routing. I'm

installing it after the full bolt-on tune so I'm not juggling multiple changes at once. The ATI Super Damper is especially important at 170k miles -- the stock damper's elastomer is likely degraded by now.

Phase 5: Flex Fuel System (Final Power Adder)

Order	Mod	Time (DIY)	Standalone?	Notes
5A	Fuel pump (DeatschWerks DW300C)	1-2 hrs	Can be done early (standalone)	Drop-in replacement. I can install this anytime, even before injectors -- the stock ECU handles it fine.
5B	Fuel rail + injectors (Acuity + ID1050x)	2-3 hrs	Paired with 5C	Install rail, injectors, and ethanol sensor at the same time.
5C	Ethanol content sensor + fuel lines	1-2 hrs	Paired with 5B	Inline sensor before fuel rail. -6 AN PTFE braided lines.
5D	Hondata flex fuel tune (dyno)	3-4 hrs on dyno	Must be done after 5A+5B+5C	Flex fuel calibration: gasoline map + E85 map with real-time interpolation. This is the most complex tune in the build. Budget $400-600.

Why last: E85 is the biggest power adder (5-15 WHP) but also the most complex. I want the full bolt-on tune dialed in on pump gas first, THEN add flex fuel as the final layer. That way the tuner has a known-good base to build the flex fuel calibration on top of.

Clutch warning: Full bolt-on + E85 targets 230-250 WHP / 165-180 lb-ft. My Exedy 08806 Stage 1 is rated to ~280-300 WHP / ~200-210 lb-ft. I'm within the margin, but I'll be monitoring for clutch slip under hard acceleration in 3rd-6th gear after the E85 tune.

Phase 6: In-Car PC (Quality of Life -- Anytime After FlashPro)

Order	Mod	Time (DIY)	Standalone?	Notes
6A	LattePanda 3 Delta permanent install	6-10 hrs (spread over a weekend)	Yes	Can be done anytime after the FlashPro is registered and working. The PC replaces my laptop for Hondata management and adds exhaust valve control via Arduino GPIO.

Note: The LattePanda is a quality-of-life upgrade, not a performance mod. It doesn't need to happen in any specific order relative to power mods. That said, having it installed before the flex fuel tune would make the dyno session easier -- permanent Hondata connection, real-time monitoring, no laptop balancing act.

Master Timeline (Recommended Execution Order)

```
PHASE 0 -- MAINTENANCE (do immediately, before any mods)
  |-- Timing chain inspection
  |-- Valve adjustment
  |-- Spark plugs (NGK ILZKR7B-11S)
  |-- Coolant flush + thermostat
  |-- Transmission fluid (Honda MTF)
  |-- Brake fluid flush (DOT 4)
  |-- Clutch fluid flush (DOT 4)
  |-- Serpentine belt (inspect/replace)
```

```
  |-- PCV valve
  |-- Water pump (inspect with timing chain)

PHASE 1 -- ALREADY PURCHASED (install in order)
  |-- 1A: Clutch hydraulics (CMC/CSC upgrade)
  |-- 1B: Brakes (Hawk HPS + R1 Concepts)
  |-- 1C: Engine mounts (Hybrid Racing 70A)
  |-- 1D: Hondata FlashPro (first flash + base map)
  \-- 1E: Strut bar (if clearance resolved)

PHASE 2 -- EXHAUST SYSTEM
  |-- 2A: Valved exhaust (QTP QTEC30 + 3" dump)
  |-- 2B: Headers (Skunk2 Alpha + Berk HFC)        <- PB Blaster studs 3-5 days before!
  \-- 2C: Dyno tune #1 (both calibrations)

PHASE 3 -- INTAKE SYSTEM
  |-- 3A: Intake manifold (Skunk2 Ultra Street)
  |-- 3B: Bored throttle body (stock DBW -> 66mm)    <- Send out 1-2 weeks before
  \-- 3C: Dyno tune #2 (full bolt-on tune)

PHASE 4 -- ROTATING ASSEMBLY
  \-- 4A: ATI Super Damper + NST pulleys             <- No retune needed

PHASE 5 -- SUSPENSION (can be done anytime, no tune dependency)
  |-- 5A: BC Racing BR coilovers + rear camber arms
  |-- 5B: Full bushing refresh (Energy Suspension + Hardrace)
  |-- 5C: Sway bars (Progress front + rear) + end links
  |-- 5D: Ball joints + tie rod ends + roll center adjusters
  \-- 5E: Professional 4-corner performance alignment  <- MANDATORY

PHASE 6 -- FLEX FUEL
  |-- 6A: Fuel pump (DeatschWerks DW300C)            <- Can be done earlier
  |-- 6B: Fuel rail + injectors (Acuity + ID1050x)
  |-- 6C: Ethanol sensor + fuel lines
  \-- 6D: Dyno tune #3 (flex fuel calibration)       <- Most complex tune

PHASE 7 -- IN-CAR PC (anytime after FlashPro)
  \-- 7A: LattePanda 3 Delta permanent install
```

Dyno Tune Summary

I'll need **3 dyno sessions** total (or 2 if I combine exhaust + intake in one session -- but that's risky because troubleshooting gets harder if something doesn't tune well):

Session	After Installing	What's Tuned	Est. Cost
Tune #1	Exhaust (cutout + headers + HFC)	Both calibrations (daily quiet + sport loud), AFR, timing with headers	$300-500
Tune #2	Intake manifold + bored TB	Full bolt-on pump gas tune -- the main event	$300-500
Tune #3	Flex fuel system (injectors + ethanol sensor)	Flex fuel calibration (gas + E85 maps, real-time interpolation)	$400-600
Total tuning budget			$1,000-1,600

Tip: I need to find a tuner experienced with K-series Hondata BEFORE starting Phase 2. The Skunk2 Alpha + Ultra Street combo is the most common full bolt-on setup -- any good K-series tuner will have extensive experience with it. I'm going to book the dyno session before ordering parts so I'm not sitting around with untuned mods on the car.

Money Already Spent (Actual Costs -- incl. tax, shipping, insurance)

Item	Actual Paid
Exedy Stage 1 clutch + flywheel + Megan Racing strut bar (bundle)	$960.43
K&N Typhoon 69-1014TS intake	$504.17
Acuity short shifter + cable bushings	$622.20
Hybrid Racing 70A engine mounts	$657.15
R1 Concepts slotted rotors (WCPN2-59004)	$309.69
Hawk HPS brake pads (front + rear)	$222.45
Hondata FlashPro	$859.59
Continental ExtremeContact DWS06 Plus 215/45ZR17 91W XL (15572680000) -- purchased 2026-06-16	$715.00
Total Spent to Date	$4,850.68

Budget Summary (All Remaining Mods + Maintenance)

Maintenance (Phase 0)

Item	Cost (Parts)
Timing chain inspection/replacement	$20-500
Valve adjustment	$10 DIY
Spark plugs	$40
Coolant + thermostat	$45
Transmission fluid	$25
Brake + clutch fluid	$25
Serpentine belt	$25
PCV valve	$10
Oil change	$35
Phase 0 Total (parts)	$235-715

Modifications (Remaining -- Not Yet Purchased)

Phase	Mod	Est. Parts Cost
1A	Clutch hydraulics	~$326 (Hybrid Racing kit + Motul RBF 600)
2A	Valved exhaust	~$485 + $150-250 labor

2B	Headers + HFC	~$1,000-1,200 + $300-500 labor
2C	Dyno tune #1	$300-500
3A+3B	Intake manifold + bored TB	~$725
3C	Dyno tune #2	$300-500
4A	ATI Super Damper + NST pulleys	~$640-760
5A	Coilovers (BC Racing BR)	~$1,195
5B	Bushing kit + trailing arm bushings	~$428
5C	Sway bars (Progress front + rear)	~$637
5D	Ball joints + tie rods + roll center adj	~$390
5E	Performance alignment	~$150
5	Rear camber arms (Skunk2) + camber bolts	~$363
6A-6C	Flex fuel system	~$1,075
6D	Dyno tune #3	$400-600
7A	LattePanda PC	~$400-500
Remaining Mods Total		~$8,864-11,160

Grand Total Summary

Category	Amount
Already Spent	$4,850.68
Maintenance (Phase 0, remaining)	$235-715
Modifications (remaining)	$8,864-11,160
Remaining to Spend	~$9,099-11,875
Full Build Total (spent + remaining)	~$13,950-16,726

That assumes I'm doing DIY labor for most installs except headers (shop recommended), exhaust welding (muffler shop), and possibly suspension bushing pressing. Paying a shop for everything would add $2,500-5,000 in labor.

Mods That CANNOT Be Done Standalone

These have hard dependencies -- I should never install them without completing the prerequisites:

Mod	Requires First	Why
Headers (2B)	Valved exhaust cutout working (2A)	Cutout position depends on header/HFC length. Install order matters.
Hondata tune #1 (2C)	Exhaust complete (2A+2B)	Tune must account for header + cutout flow characteristics
Intake manifold (3A)	Full exhaust installed + tuned (Phase 2)	Changing intake after exhaust tune wastes a dyno session
Bored TB (3B)	Install with manifold (3A)	Single retune for both saves money

Hondata tune #2 (3C)	Manifold + TB installed (3A+3B)	Full bolt-on pump gas tune
Flex fuel tune (6D)	All fuel system components (6A+6B+6C) + full bolt-on tune (3C)	Flex fuel calibration is layered on top of the full bolt-on tune

Mods That CAN Be Done Standalone (Any Order)

Mod	Notes
Clutch hydraulics (CMC/CSC)	No dependencies. Do early.
Engine mounts (Hybrid Racing 70A)	No dependencies.
Brakes (Hawk HPS + R1 Concepts)	No dependencies.
Strut bar (Megan Racing)	No dependencies (once clearance resolved).
FlashPro first flash	No dependencies (just needs a laptop).
ATI Super Damper + pulleys	No dependencies. No retune needed.
Fuel pump (DW300C)	Can be done anytime -- stock ECU handles it fine.
Suspension (coilovers + bushings + sway bars)	No tune dependency. Can be done anytime. Do all at once -- car is already apart.
LattePanda PC	Only needs FlashPro registered first.

Last updated: 2026-04-16

Maintenance Parts Catalog -- OE + Aftermarket Part Numbers

> Every part number I need for 170k-mile Phase 0 maintenance and ongoing upkeep, in one place. OE numbers I buy from Honda dealers or majestichonda.com; aftermarket from AutoZone / RockAuto / Amazon. Prices are approximate -- I verify before ordering.

This catalog is the single source of truth for "what do I order." When something needs replacing, I check here first.

Engine -- Fluids

Fluid	Spec	OE Part	Aftermarket Equivalent	Capacity	Change Interval
Motor oil	5W-30 full synthetic (community), 0W-20 (Honda spec)	N/A (Honda doesn't brand oil anymore)	Mobil 1 5W-30 EP, Pennzoil Platinum 5W-30, HPL No-VII 5W-30	4.4 qt (w/ filter)	5,000 mi / 6 months
Oil filter	K-series short	15400-PLM-A02	Mobil 1 M1-110A, Purolator PL14610	1	Every oil change
Coolant	Honda Type 2 (blue, pre-mix)	OL999-9011	NONE -- use OEM only	~1.3 gal	50-60k mi
Transmission fluid	Honda MTF-3	08798-9031	NONE -- stock Honda MTF only, synchros hate GL-4/5	2.2 qt	30-40k mi
Brake fluid	DOT 4 LV	N/A	Motul RBF 600 (boiling point 594F dry / 421F wet)	~1 qt (bleed)	2 yr / 30k mi
Clutch fluid	DOT 4 LV	Same as brake	Motul RBF 600 (share bottle with brakes)	~0.5 qt	2 yr / 30k mi
Power steering	Honda PSF-S	08206-9002	NONE -- Honda PSF-S only	~0.8 qt	60k mi

Aftermarket oil preference: Mobil 1 EP 5W-30 or HPL No-VII 5W-30. I'm running 5W-30 over Honda's 0W-20 spec because of 170k-mile bearing clearances -- the slightly heavier oil keeps pressure up.

On E85: oil change interval drops to **3,000-4,000 mi**. Ethanol combustion byproducts contaminate oil faster. Non-negotiable maintenance tax for running ethanol.

Ignition

Part	OE P/N	Qty	Price	Notes
Spark plug (pump gas)	NGK ILZKR7B-11S	4	~$10/ea	Pre-gapped 0.043". Do NOT re-gap iridium.
Spark plug (E85 flex)	NGK ILFR7H	4	~$12/ea	One heat range colder for E85. Swap at flex-fuel tune session.
Ignition coil	30520-RWC-A01	4	~$40-50/ea OEM	Buy OEM Honda from dealer. Fakes on eBay are common.
VTC actuator (updated)	14310-RBC-003	1	~$280	Superseded revision with stronger spring. Cold-start rattle fix.
Cam chain tensioner	14510-RAA-A02	1	~$75	Replace with timing chain if stretch detected.

Cooling System

Part	OE P/N	Aftermarket	Price	Notes
Radiator (OEM)	19010-RRB-A51	Koyorad HH060063	OEM $180 / Koyo $250	Koyo is the move -- same money, aluminum end tanks, no cracking.
Thermostat	19301-RNA-305	Stant or Motorad 180F	~$25	Keep stock spec. Tune fan tables in Hondata instead of going low-temp.
Thermostat gasket/O-ring	19305-PR3-004	--	~$5	Fresh gasket every time.
Upper radiator hose	19501-RRB-A00	Gates 22918	~$30	OEM fits right.
Lower radiator hose	19502-RRB-A00	Gates 22919	~$30	OEM fits right.
Heater inlet hose	79721-SNA-A00	--	~$20	
Heater outlet hose	79725-SNA-A00	--	~$20	
Water pump	19200-RAA-A01	Aisin WPH-802	~$80-100	Replace proactively at timing chain service.
Water pump gasket	19222-PNA-003	--	~$8	Mandatory fresh.
Radiator cap	19045-PH7-003	NGK/Motorad 1.1 bar	~$15	

Fuel System

Part	OE P/N	Aftermarket	Price	Notes
Fuel filter (in-tank)	17048-SNA-A32	Hitachi / Beck Arnley equivalent	~$60	Replace before first E85 tank -- ethanol dislodges deposits.
Fuel pump assembly (OEM)	17040-SNA-A62	DW200 (9-201-1001) or DW300C (9-307-1008)	OEM $250 / DW300C $130	DW300C for E85.
Fuel pressure regulator	(in fuel pump assembly)	N/A	--	Returnless system. No separate FPR on FG2. Stock is fine for NA.
Fuel injectors (stock)	16450-RRA-A01	Bosch EV14 550cc or ID725	Stock ~$60/ea	Stock 310cc is too small for E85. See 12-Flex-Fuel.
Fuel rail (stock)	16620-RBC-003	Acuity 1913-K20	--	Keep stock until flex-fuel conversion.

Drivetrain / Clutch Hydraulics

Part	OE P/N	Aftermarket	Price	Notes
CMC (stock)	46920-SVA-A03	Hybrid Racing HYB-CMC-01-20 (full kit)	OEM $120 / HR kit $290	Kit = CMC + CSC + braided line. Do the full kit.
CSC (stock)	46930-SVA-A02	(included in HR kit)	--	
Clutch pedal bushing	46991-S5A-004	Hybrid Racing solid	~$25	Often dry-rotted at 170k. Cheap fix.
Clutch line (rubber OEM)	46961-SNW-A51	(included in HR kit -- stainless braided)	--	Replace with braided. Stock swells.
Rear main seal	91214-RDA-A01	--	~$20	Replace while trans is out for clutch job.

Front crank seal	91212-PNC-003	--	~$15	Replace with pulley upgrade.
Flywheel bolt set	90001-PAA-A01	ARP 208-2802	OEM $20 / ARP $60	

Engine -- Seals / Gaskets

Part	OE P/N	Price	Notes
Valve cover gasket kit (includes plug tube seals)	12030-RRA-A01	~$40	Universal 170k leaker. Oil in plug wells = time.
Oil filter housing gasket/o-ring	15301-PT0-003	~$8	Weeps at 170k. Cheap while oil is drained.
Exhaust manifold gasket (header-to-head)	18115-RRB-A01	~$20 OEM	OEM only. Aftermarket gaskets blow.
Cat-to-manifold donut gasket (EP3)	18229-S6D-T31	~$10	Stock fitment for 8th gen SI too.
Cat-to-B-pipe donut gasket	18393-SR3-A01	~$10	
Oil drain plug crush washer	94109-14000	$1	Every oil change.

Suspension -- Wear Items (170k Replace Baseline)

Part	OE P/N	Aftermarket	Price	Notes
Front outer tie rod (passenger)	53560-SNA-A01	Moog ES800373	~$30	
Front outer tie rod (driver)	53540-SNA-A01	Moog ES800374	~$30	
Front inner tie rod	--	Moog EV800246 (pair)	~$60	
Front lower ball joint	51220-SNA-A03	Moog K500149	~$40	Or K-Tuned RCA if lowering 1.5"+
Front sway bar end links	51320-SNA-A02	Moog K80768 / K80769	~$35 each	Whiteline KLC139 adjustable if lowering 1.5"+
Rear shock top mount	52675-SNA-A03	--	~$25/ea	Replace during coilover install.
Rear upper control arm bushings	--	Energy Suspension 16.18114 kit	(in kit)	
Rear trailing arm bushings	--	Hardrace 6926	~$150 pair	Known 170k failure point.
Wheel bearing (front)	44300-SNA-951	Koyo or Timken equivalent	~$80/ea	Replace only if humming.

Motor Mounts

Part	OE P/N	Aftermarket	Price	Notes
Rear mount	50820-SNA-A82	Hybrid Racing 70A (in kit)	OEM $150 / HR kit $657	Kit replaces all 3.
Transmission mount	50850-SNA-A82	(in HR kit)	--	
Side mount	50820-SNA-A01	(in HR kit)	--	
Hasport 62A inserts (budget alt)	N/A	HSP-MO-CV-SI	~$110	Inserts only; keeps OEM rubber structure. Quieter than full mounts.

Exhaust Hardware

Part	OE P/N	Aftermarket	Price	Notes
Exhaust manifold studs (8x)	90201-PRB-A00 (M10x1.25 x 45mm)	ARP 208-4301 kit	OEM ~$15/set / ARP ~$90	ARP for header install -- worth it.
Exhaust manifold flange nuts (copper-plated)	90212-SA5-003	ARP 200-8321	~$15	Copper-plated resists seizing.
Header-to-cat spring bolt assembly	19103-RDJ-A01	--	~$15	Fresh springs + gaskets at install.
O2 sensor (upstream, front)	36531-RRB-A01	Denso 234-9049	~$100	Replace if check engine light issue.
O2 sensor (rear, downstream)	36532-RRA-A01	Denso 234-4133	~$80	Rear O2 gets repurposed for flex fuel signal -- may not need OEM spare.

Filters

Part	OE P/N	Aftermarket	Price	Notes
Engine air filter (stock box)	17220-RRB-A00	K&N 33-2342 (same form factor)	OEM $25 / K&N $50	N/A for me -- running K&N Typhoon.
Cabin air filter	80292-SVA-A01	Fram CF10133	~$15	Every 15k.

Accessory Belts

Part	OE P/N	Aftermarket	Price	Notes
Serpentine belt	56992-RNA-A04	Gates K070663	~$25	Inspect every 60-80k. Visual cracks = replace.

Small Wear Items

Part	OE P/N	Aftermarket	Price	Notes
PCV valve	17130-RTA-000	Beck Arnley 045-0316	~$15	60-80k interval.
Battery (Group 51R)	N/A (Honda doesn't sell)	Odyssey PC925LMJT (AGM), Optima Yellow, or Interstate MT-51R	~$120-220	AGM preferred for LattePanda constant draw.

What To Buy As Spares

These I keep on the shelf so I'm never stranded:

- **2x oil filter (15400-PLM-A02)** + matching oil (I get a case when on sale)
- **1x set of spark plugs** (the pump gas set)
- **1x air filter element** for the K&N (clean + re-oil kit)
- **1x PCV valve**
- **1x set of drain plug crush washers**
- **Assorted M10x1.25 copper-plated flange nuts** (exhaust)

Ordering Preferences

Vendor	Best For	Notes
Honda dealer (VIN quote)	Genuine OEM where it matters (VTC actuator, gaskets, seals, head fasteners)	Order by VIN to get the revised part.
majestichonda.com	OEM online, discounted	Same dealer parts at 20-30% off MSRP.
RockAuto	Aftermarket (Moog, Gates, NGK)	Consistently the cheapest. Slower shipping.
AutoZone / O'Reilly	Fluids, same-day needs	Borrow-a-tool program is clutch for pullers.
Amazon	K&N, Hawk, Hybrid Racing, Acuity	Prime shipping worth it for weekend jobs.
HeelToe Auto	Skunk2, Hardrace, harder-to-find K parts	Honda specialist. Excellent customer service.
K Series Parts	Specialty K-series bits	Best catalog for Hondata/FlashPro accessories.
Summit Racing	ATI, AEM, QTP	Usually cheapest on performance parts.

Last updated: 2026-04-18

Torque Specs -- K20Z3 / FG2 Quick Reference

> I got tired of hunting forums at 11pm for torque values. This is my cached reference for every fastener I'm likely to touch during this build. Specs pulled from the Honda factory service manual (FSM) and cross-checked with 8thcivic.com community threads.

Quick sanity check rule: if I'm not sure and can't find the spec, don't guess on anything load-bearing. OEM specs only. Aftermarket hardware follows aftermarket hardware spec (e.g., ARP), not the part it replaces.

Wheels

Fastener	Torque	Notes
Lug nuts	80 ft-lb	Star pattern, final pass. Re-torque after 50 miles on new wheels.

Engine -- Accessories and External

Fastener	Torque	Notes
Spark plug	13 ft-lb (156 in-lb)	Gentle. Never muscle iridium plugs. Apply anti-seize sparingly on threads only.
Ignition coil hold-down bolt	108 in-lb (9 ft-lb)	
Oil drain plug	29 ft-lb	New crush washer every time.
Oil filter	Hand tight + 3/4 turn	Honda A02 filter. Pre-lube gasket with fresh oil.
Oil filter housing bolt (center stud)	18 ft-lb	
Valve cover bolts	89 in-lb (7.5 ft-lb)	Star pattern from center out, light blue Loctite on threads.
Spark plug tube seal bolts	Same as valve cover	Replace seals if oil in plug wells.
Thermostat housing bolts	9 ft-lb	New gasket mandatory.
Water pump bolts	9 ft-lb	Fresh gasket. Align carefully.
Coolant bleed screw	Hand tight	Plastic -- do not over-torque.

Engine -- Serpentine / Accessories

Fastener	Torque	Notes
Crankshaft pulley bolt	181 ft-lb	Bolt is torque-to-yield on some years -- check FSM. Use impact or long breaker bar. Anti-seize on threads.
Alternator pulley nut	80 ft-lb	Hold alternator shaft. Loctite medium strength.
Alternator mounting bolts	33 ft-lb	
Idler pulley bolt	29 ft-lb	
A/C compressor mounting bolts	17 ft-lb	Do not loosen without recovering refrigerant first.

Exhaust

Fastener	Torque	Notes
Exhaust manifold studs to head	23 ft-lb (stud-in)	Anti-seize on threads going in, copper anti-seize on exhaust side. ARP studs follow ARP spec if using ARP kit.
Exhaust manifold flange nuts (to head)	23 ft-lb	Torque in 3 passes, star pattern.
Header-to-cat spring bolts	16 ft-lb	Do not overtighten -- springs compress to set pressure.
Cat-to-B-pipe flange bolts	25 ft-lb	New donut gasket every disassembly.
Resonator/muffler flange bolts	25 ft-lb	
O2 sensor	33 ft-lb	Anti-seize on threads. Do not get sensor element contaminated.
Wideband O2 sensor (AEM)	33 ft-lb	Same as stock O2.
QTP QTEC30 cutout flange bolts	25 ft-lb	Treat like any 3" exhaust flange.

Intake / Fuel

Fastener	Torque	Notes
Intake manifold bolts (to head)	17 ft-lb	Star pattern from center. Fresh gasket. Replace if warped.
Throttle body bolts	17 ft-lb	Fresh O-ring.
Fuel rail bolts (to IM)	108 in-lb (9 ft-lb)	Gentle -- crushing aluminum.
Fuel line banjo bolt	25 ft-lb	New crush washers both sides.
Fuel pump mounting bolts (tank assembly)	39 in-lb	Very gentle -- plastic tank threads.
PCV valve	Hand tight + 1/8 turn	Plastic threads.

Clutch / Transmission

Fastener	Torque	Notes
Flywheel bolts	87 ft-lb	Loctite 242 (blue) mandatory. Torque-to-yield on some Exedy kits -- check Exedy instructions.
Pressure plate bolts	19 ft-lb	Star pattern in 3 passes. Alignment tool for disc.
Clutch master cylinder mounting nuts	10 ft-lb	Firewall side.
Clutch slave cylinder bolts	16 ft-lb	At bellhousing.
Clutch line banjo bolt (at CSC)	25 ft-lb	New crush washers.
Transmission drain plug	29 ft-lb	New crush washer.
Transmission fill plug	33 ft-lb	
Axle nut	181 ft-lb	Front wheel bearing preload critical. Re-torque after 100 miles.
Bellhousing bolts	47 ft-lb	

Suspension -- Front

Fastener	Torque	Notes
Strut-to-knuckle bolts	83 ft-lb	Replace if removed -- stretch bolts.
Strut top mount nuts (to body)	29 ft-lb	
Coilover lock rings	Hand tight + spanner	Follow coilover manufacturer spec (BC Racing BR uses their spanner wrenches).
Lower ball joint pinch bolt	40 ft-lb	Replace if removed.
Lower control arm front bolt	54 ft-lb	
Lower control arm rear bolt (to subframe)	76 ft-lb	
Tie rod end castle nut	40 ft-lb + cotter pin	Turn up to next slot if needed, never back off.
Sway bar end link nuts	29 ft-lb	
Sway bar bracket bolts (to subframe)	29 ft-lb	
Subframe-to-body bolts	65 ft-lb	If subframe was lowered for header access, torque all 4 to spec.

Suspension -- Rear

Fastener	Torque	Notes
Shock lower bolt	40 ft-lb	
Shock top nut (to body)	22 ft-lb	
Upper control arm bolts	47 ft-lb	
Lower control arm bolts	47 ft-lb	
Trailing arm bolts (both ends)	54 ft-lb	
Rear camber arm lock nuts (Skunk2)	35 ft-lb	Follow Skunk2 spec.
Sway bar end link nuts	29 ft-lb	
Sway bar bracket bolts	29 ft-lb	

Brakes

Fastener	Torque	Notes
Caliper bracket bolts (front, 19mm)	80 ft-lb	
Caliper bracket bolts (rear, 12mm)	54 ft-lb	
Caliper slide pin bolts (12mm)	25 ft-lb	Fresh silicone grease on pins.
Rotor retaining screw (small cross-head)	7 ft-lb	Tiny -- do not over-torque. Anti-seize to prevent future seizing.
Brake line banjo bolt (at caliper)	25 ft-lb	New crush washers.
Bleed screw	Hand tight + 1/8 turn	Do not over-torque; will strip.

Engine Mounts

Fastener	Torque	Notes
Rear mount through-bolt	47 ft-lb	
Side mount (passenger) through-bolts	47 ft-lb	
Transmission mount	47 ft-lb	
Hybrid Racing 70A mount hardware	Follow Hybrid Racing spec	Ships with instructions. Generally 40-50 ft-lb.

Interior / Chassis

Fastener	Torque	Notes
Seat belt anchor bolts	32 ft-lb	Safety-critical. Never use heat.
Front seat mounting bolts (4x)	29 ft-lb	
Shift knob thread	Hand tight	
Shift base bolts	17 ft-lb	
Center console fasteners	Hand tight	Plastic clips mostly.

Head / Valvetrain (Reference -- I'm not opening this)

Fastener	Torque	Notes
Head bolts	Multi-step angle (FSM)	Replace bolts every time. Follow exact FSM sequence.
Cam caps	108 in-lb (9 ft-lb)	Final torque only -- sequence matters.
VTC actuator bolt	59 ft-lb	Loctite 262 (red). Hold cam with wrench on flats.
Valve adjuster lock nut	14 ft-lb	Gentle -- brass nut deforms if overtightened.

Fastener Replacement Rules (One-Time Use)

These bolts I replace every disassembly, no exceptions:

- Head bolts
- Flywheel bolts (if Exedy instructions say so)
- Strut-to-knuckle bolts (stretch bolts)
- Lower ball joint pinch bolt
- Axle nuts
- All cotter pins
- All crush washers (banjo bolts, drain plugs)
- All exhaust donut gaskets
- Valve cover gasket (if removed)

Thread Locker Reference

Strength	Color	Use
Low (222)	Purple	Small fasteners, easy removal
Medium (242)	Blue	General -- flywheel, pulley bolts, suspension
High (262/271)	Red	Permanent -- cam gear, VTC actuator. Heat required to remove.
Anti-seize	Copper/silver	Exhaust threads, spark plug threads, rotor screws

Default to medium (blue 242) unless the spec calls for something else. Never use red where future disassembly is needed.

Tools I Need for This Spec List

- 1/2" drive torque wrench, 30-250 ft-lb range (CDI, Tekton, or Snap-On)
- 3/8" drive torque wrench, 10-80 ft-lb range
- 1/4" drive torque wrench, 20-200 in-lb range (for the valve cover and small bolts)
- Calibrated within the last year (I can send it out for recal every ~2 years)
- A harmonic balancer puller (for the crank pulley work)
- An angle gauge for torque-to-yield head bolts (I'm not opening the head, but it's in the kit if I ever do)

Last updated: 2026-04-18

Baseline Datalogs -- A/B Tracking for Every Mod

> The point: before and after every tune change or hardware mod, I run the same standardized set of datalogs. Apples-to-apples. This way I can see what each change actually did instead of guessing from the seat of my pants.

Rule: Log BEFORE I change anything. No exceptions. Once a mod is on, I can't go back in time.

Why I'm Doing This

I'm about to spend a lot of money on a lot of different mods that all affect each other. Without baseline datalogs at each phase:

- I can't tell which mod actually moved the needle
- I can't catch a mistuned calibration early
- I have no way to argue with a dyno tuner if results come back lower than expected
- If something goes wrong later (a sensor goes bad, a misfire starts), I have no "healthy" reference

FlashPro's datalogger captures everything I need. It's free. The only cost is ~15 minutes per log session. No excuse to skip this.

Standard Log Set -- Every Time

Four logs, run in sequence, same day, same route:

Log 1 -- Cold Start / Idle Quality

- **Duration:** 3-5 min from key-on
- **Conditions:** Engine COLD (sat overnight)
- **Procedure:**

1. Key to ON, FlashPro connected, logger running
2. Start engine, let idle for 2 minutes without touching pedals
3. Blip throttle 3x to 3000 RPM, return to idle
4. Rev to 5000 RPM and hold 5 seconds

- **Looking for:** Cold start fuel trim, VTC actuator behavior (phase lock time), coolant temp rise rate, idle stability, misfire counts

Log 2 -- Cruise / Steady State

- **Duration:** 10-15 min
- **Conditions:** Engine fully warmed (coolant 185F+, IAT stable)
- **Procedure:**

1. 35 mph, 4th gear, level ground, 3 minutes
2. 55 mph, 5th gear, level ground, 3 minutes
3. 70 mph, 6th gear, level ground, 3 minutes
4. Light throttle transitions between speeds

- **Looking for:** Closed-loop fuel trims (STFT / LTFT), knock counts at cruise, timing behavior, MPG reference

Log 3 -- Part-Throttle Pulls

- **Duration:** 5-10 min
- **Conditions:** Fully warm
- **Procedure:**

1. 3rd gear, 2000 to 5000 RPM, 50% throttle pull x 3
2. 3rd gear, 2000 to 5000 RPM, 75% throttle pull x 3
3. Let cool ~30 seconds between pulls

- **Looking for:** Partial-load fuel tables, timing ramp, VTEC engagement behavior (below crossover)

Log 4 -- WOT Pulls

- **Duration:** 5-10 min
- **Conditions:** Fully warm, clear road, safe conditions
- **Procedure:**

1. 3rd gear, 2500 RPM to redline, 100% throttle x 3
2. 4th gear, 2500 RPM to redline, 100% throttle x 2 (if space allows)
3. Let cool fully between pulls

- **Looking for:** WOT AFR hitting target, knock counts (MUST be 0), peak timing, peak RPM, injector duty cycle

Total time: ~45 minutes per log session. I do this quarterly in stock form, and before/after every tune or hardware change.

What Parameters I Log

FlashPro lets me configure which parameters are captured. My standard log profile:

Category	Parameters	Why
Engine basics	RPM, Load (g/rev), TPS, MAP, VSS, gear	Context for every other reading
Fuel	STFT, LTFT, AFR (narrowband + wideband via analog input), injector duty cycle, injector pulse width	Tune health
Timing	Ignition advance (actual), timing correction, knock count	SAFETY -- knock count is the #1 watchdog
Cam / VTEC	VTC target, VTC actual, VTEC solenoid state, VTC error	Actuator health
Thermal	ECT (coolant), IAT (intake air), oil temp (if wired)	Heat soak detection
Electrical	Battery voltage, MIL status	System health
Flex fuel	Ethanol content %, fuel temp	Once flex fuel sensor is wired
Wideband	External AFR signal (via analog input)	Tuning ground truth

---

Baseline Milestones I'll Capture

Each milestone gets a full 4-log set + date-stamped filename. I'll keep logs in docs/logs/ (I'll create the folder once

I have my first session).

#	Milestone	What's Changed	Goal
0	Today -- stock ECU, current mods (intake + clutch + shifter + tires)	None (baseline)	My reference "before" state. Captures K&N intake on stock calibration.
1	Post-maintenance (Phase 0 done)	Plugs, VTC actuator, coils, fluids, thermostat, radiator	Clean healthy-engine baseline before any tune changes.
2	Post-FlashPro first flash (base map, no mods)	Community base map for stock + intake	Tune-only delta vs stock ECU.
3	Post-mounts + brakes + hydraulics + FlashPro	All Phase 1 mods installed	Ready-for-tuning baseline.
4	Post-exhaust (cutout + headers + HFC)	Phase 2 complete	Exhaust flow improvements.
5	Post-dyno tune #1 (both daily + sport)	Dual calibrations dialed in	Verify reliability-first rule. Knock counts = 0.
6	Post-intake mfld + bored TB	Phase 3 complete	Full bolt-on hardware.
7	Post-dyno tune #2 (daily + sport, pump gas)	FBO pump gas maps dialed	Pump gas final.
8	Post-ATI damper + NST pulleys	Phase 4	Rotating assembly.
9	Post-flex fuel install (hardware only)	Phase 6 hardware, running pump	Still on pump, new injectors/pump/sensor.
10	Post-dyno tune #3 (flex fuel final)	Daily + sport, gas + E85 interpolated	Final state.

Log File Naming Convention

YYYY-MM-DD_milestone_NN_log-type.fpdl

Examples:

- 2026-04-18_milestone-00_baseline_log-1-cold-idle.fpdl
- 2026-04-18_milestone-00_baseline_log-4-wot-pulls.fpdl

This way chronological sorting works automatically, and I can tell at a glance what each file represents.

Red Flags I'm Watching For

If ANY of these show up in a log, I pull over immediately and investigate before continuing:

Symptom in log	What It Means	Action
Knock count > 0 under sustained load	Engine is knocking	Pull timing immediately. Do not drive hard until resolved.
Knock correction > -2 deg	ECU is fighting knock	Pull over. Check fuel quality, sensors, timing tables.
STFT/LTFT > ±10%	Fuel trim running extreme	Check injectors, fuel pressure, O2 sensor, MAF (if applicable)
AFR leaner than 12.0 WOT (pump gas) or lambda > 0.82 (E85)	DANGEROUS lean condition	STOP. Pull over. Do not drive until fixed. Increase fuel.
VTC error > 3 deg sustained	VTC actuator failing	Replace actuator -- engine is not running commanded cam timing.
Injector duty cycle > 85% at any RPM	Injectors near limit	Upsize injectors or verify fuel pressure.

ECT > 220F sustained	Cooling system inadequate	Stop, let cool. Check coolant level, thermostat, radiator condition.
IAT > ambient + 50F at speed	Heat soak -- intake cooking	Confirm heat shield function; a normal hot-side intake runs IAT elevated but not extreme.
Battery voltage < 13.2V with alternator on	Charging system weak	Check alternator, belt, battery.

Sharing Logs with Claude / Tuner

FlashPro exports logs to CSV via FlashProManager -> File -> Export Datalog. That's the format I use for analysis.

For the Claude workflow (see feedback_tuning_priorities.md in my memory system if you're reading this through me): paste the CSV content directly, or attach the file. I'll analyze specific cells, flag outliers, and propose table edits. I cannot flash the ECU -- I can only recommend what to change.

For my tuner: .fpdl binary files directly. He loads them in his FlashProManager and sees everything native.

What a "Healthy" Baseline Looks Like on a Stock 8th Gen SI

Rough reference values so I know when something's off:

Parameter	Healthy Range (stock + K&N intake)
Idle RPM	740-780
Idle AFR (warm, closed loop)	14.5-14.9
Cruise AFR (45 mph, level, 5th gear)	14.5-14.9
WOT AFR (stock tune)	11.5-12.2 (Honda is intentionally rich)
Knock count at WOT (stock)	0 (should never see any)
ECT at cruise	185-195F
IAT at cruise (65F ambient)	85-110F (K&N runs hotter than stock airbox)
LTFT cruise	±5% (stock + intake -- intake tune will bring closer to 0)
Peak ignition advance, WOT	25-32 deg at 5000-6500 RPM
VTEC engagement	5800 RPM (stock), tunable to 4500-5500
Battery voltage, alternator charging	13.8-14.4

Anything outside these ranges in my current "stock tune + intake" state is a flag to investigate before I flash anything.

Created: 2026-04-18

Clutch & Flywheel -- Exedy Stage 1 Organic + Exedy Lightweight Flywheel

Already on the car

Part Information

Clutch

Field	Value
Part	Exedy Organic Clutch Kit Honda Civic SI (2006-2011) Stage 1
Part Number	08806
Purchased From	shop.redline360.com
Type	Stage 1 organic disc with upgraded pressure plate
Rating	~280-300 WHP / ~200-210 lb-ft TQ reliable limit
Actual Cost (with flywheel + strut bar, incl. tax/shipping)	$960.43 combined

Flywheel

Field	Value
Part	Exedy Lightweight Flywheel
Material	Chromoly steel
Weight	Significantly lighter than stock flywheel (~8-9 lbs vs ~14-15 lbs stock)
Part Number	HF02
Purchased From	shop.redline360.com
Fitment	Honda Civic SI (2006-2011) K20Z3

Exedy 08806 vs OEM Replacement (KHC10)

Spec	KHC10 (OEM Replacement)	08806 (Stage 1 Organic)
Disc material	OEM organic	Upgraded organic
Pressure plate	Stock clamping force	Higher clamping force (upgraded)
Pedal feel	Identical to stock	Slightly firmer, still very streetable
Power limit	~230 WHP / ~170 lb-ft	~280-300 WHP / ~200-210 lb-ft
Daily drivability	OEM feel	Excellent -- organic disc is smooth, no chatter

I went with the 08806 over a basic OEM replacement and I'm glad I did. It gives me way more headroom above where I'll be with bolt-ons (215-225 WHP) while still being totally smooth for daily driving. No chatter, no drama -- just a better clutch.

Why I Went With These

At ~170k miles, my stock clutch was toast and needed to go anyway. Rather than just throwing in another OEM replacement, I figured I'd spend a little more and get something with real headroom. The Stage 1 has a beefier pressure plate so it'll hold up to whatever power I make with the bolt-on setup, and it's still completely streetable.

The lightweight flywheel was honestly a no-brainer while I was already in there. Swapping from the heavy stock single-mass unit to the lighter chromoly one made a noticeable difference:

- **Faster revs:** Less rotational mass means the engine spins up and down quicker. VTEC engagement feels sharper, rev-matching is way easier.
- **Better throttle response:** Less inertia to fight -- the engine just responds more immediately.
- **Quicker shifts:** RPM drops and rises faster between gears, and it makes the Acuity short shifter feel even more alive.
- **Slightly rougher idle:** The heavier stock flywheel smooths out combustion pulses. The lighter one lets more vibration through at idle. Totally normal, and honestly pretty mild with the Exedy unit.

Power Headroom

Power Level	Torque (est.)	Clutch Status
Stock (197 HP / 139 lb-ft)	139 lb-ft	Well within limits
Bolt-ons + tune (210-225 WHP)	155-165 lb-ft	Comfortable. Plenty of margin.
~250 WHP	~180 lb-ft	Still fine. No issues.
~280 WHP	~200 lb-ft	Upper edge of reliable daily use.
300+ WHP	210+ lb-ft	Slipping likely. Upgrade needed.

With all my planned bolt-ons (intake + headers + exhaust + tune = ~215-225 WHP), I've got ~60-75 WHP of headroom. I won't need to touch this clutch again unless I go forced induction at serious boost levels.

Notes

- The lightweight flywheel makes clutch engagement feel slightly more abrupt -- less rotational inertia to buffer things. Totally normal, and I got used to it within a day or two.
- Combined with my Acuity short shifter, Acuity trans-side bushings, and the Hybrid Racing 70A mounts I'm planning to install, the whole drivetrain feel is going to be completely transformed.
- The lighter flywheel technically makes low-RPM drivability slightly worse (less momentum to keep things spinning through lugging situations). I just avoid lugging it in high gear at low RPM.
- The Exedy HF02 flywheel is designed for the K20Z3 crank, so any future clutch upgrade will bolt right to it.

Intake -- K&N Typhoon (Short Ram)

Already on the car

Part Information

Field	Value
Part	K&N Typhoon Short Ram Intake
Part Number	69-1014TS
Fitment	Honda Civic SI 2.0L (2006-2011)
Filter Type	K&N high-flow cotton gauze
Finish	Polished aluminum intake tube
Actual Cost (incl. tax/shipping)	$504.17

Note: K&N markets this as a "Cold Air Intake," but it's technically a **short ram intake** -- the filter mounts in the engine bay (hot side) near the exhaust manifold, not in a cold air location behind the bumper/fender. It does use the stock fresh air duct to feed cooler outside air to the filter area, though.

Why I Went With This

I replaced the stock airbox with the K&N Typhoon mainly because the K20 sounds absolutely incredible with an open intake. Beyond the sound, it gives me:

- Slightly improved airflow at high RPM
- A modest 3-8 HP gain (varies by dyno and conditions)
- Better throttle response feel

The stock airbox is honestly pretty well-designed on these cars, but I wanted the sound and the small gains. Worth it for how much more alive the car feels up top.

Installation Notes

- **Placement:** Hot side of the engine bay. The filter sits near the exhaust manifold side, so it gets exposed to engine heat.
- **Heat Shield:** The kit includes a partial heat shield, but it doesn't fully isolate the filter from engine bay temps.
- **Fresh Air Duct:** I kept the stock fresh air duct (routes air from behind the bumper/fender toward the filter area). It helps feed cooler outside air to the filter despite the hot-side placement.
- **Intake Air Temps:** Real-world IATs run higher than a true cold-side setup. The fresh air duct helps, but on hot days or in traffic, IATs will climb. I'll keep an eye on this through Hondata datalogging once I get it set up.

Tuning Impact

This is the only installed mod that affects the ECU tune.

The changed airflow characteristics (different tube diameter, less restriction, different sensor placement) mean the stock ECU calibration isn't perfectly matched anymore. The car runs fine on the stock tune -- closed-loop O2 correction handles the difference -- but once I flash a Hondata base map calibrated for an intake, it'll:

- Correct fuel tables for the intake's airflow characteristics
- Optimize timing for the slightly different charge characteristics
- Potentially adjust VTEC engagement for the modified intake flow

There's a base map for "stock + intake" on the 8th gen SI available from Hondata's downloads, which is what I'll start with.

Short Shifter & Bushings -- Acuity Instruments

Already on the car

Part Information

Short Shifter

Field	Value
Part	Acuity Instruments 3-Way Adjustable Short Shifter
Fitment	8th Gen Honda Civic SI (2006-2011) 6-speed
Adjustment	3-way adjustable throw reduction

Shifter Cable Bushings

Field	Value
Part	Acuity Instruments Shifter Cable Bushings
Location	Transmission side (where the cables attach to the transmission)
Material	Stiffer than OEM rubber

Cost

Field	Value
Short shifter (base price)	$459.00
Cable bushings (base price)	$79.00
Actual Cost (both, incl. tax/shipping)	$622.20

Why I Went With These

The stock SI shifter has a long, kind of vague throw. I hated how imprecise it felt, especially trying to bang through gears quickly. The Acuity 3-way adjustable short shifter massively reduces shift throw, and the trans-side cable bushings replace the soft OEM rubber with stiffer units that eliminate the slop in the linkage.

Together, they made a night-and-day difference. The shift feel is so much tighter and more direct now. Combined with the fresh Exedy clutch and the Hybrid Racing 70A engine mounts I've got waiting to go in, this is going to be a complete drivetrain feel overhaul.

Notes

- The Acuity shifter is adjustable -- I've been experimenting with the three settings to find my preferred throw length
- Shorter throw = more effort per shift (leverage trade-off), but it feels way sportier
- The trans-side bushings are honestly the single most impactful improvement for shift precision -- if I could only pick one mod for shift feel, it'd be these

- Acuity also makes shifter-side (cabin-side) bushings, but the trans-side ones address the biggest source of slop
- No tuning impact -- purely mechanical

Engine Mounts -- Hybrid Racing 70A

Purchased, sitting in the box

Part Information

Field	Value
Part	Hybrid Racing Engine Mount Kit
Durometer	70A (polyurethane)
Material	Polyurethane inserts in billet aluminum housings
Fitment	8th Gen Honda Civic SI (2006-2011)
Note	These mounts may be manufactured by Hasport and sold/rebranded through Hybrid Racing
Actual Cost (incl. tax/shipping)	$657.15

Why I'm Doing This

At 170k miles, my stock rubber mounts are almost certainly degraded and soft. Stiffer mounts will reduce engine movement under load, which means:

- Better shift feel (less engine rock during gear changes)
- Improved throttle response (less drivetrain slop)
- Less wheel hop under hard launches
- Ties everything together with the Acuity short shifter and bushings for an overall tighter drivetrain feel

This is the last piece of the drivetrain feel puzzle. Once these go in alongside the clutch, flywheel, short shifter, and bushings that are already on the car, it should feel like a completely different machine.

Trade-Offs

70A is on the **streetable end** of performance mounts:

Durometer	Character
Stock rubber (~40-50A)	Smooth, quiet, isolates all vibration
70A (this kit)	Noticeable vibration at idle, moderate NVH increase, significant improvement in drivetrain feel
85-90A	Harsh at idle, very noticeable cabin vibration, track-oriented
Solid (100A+)	Race car. Unbearable for street use.

What I'm expecting: A noticeable buzz/vibration at idle and low RPM, especially through the steering wheel, shift knob, and pedals. At driving RPMs it should disappear. Most 8th gen SI owners running 70A mounts say it's a worthwhile trade-off for the improved driving feel, and I'm fine with a little vibration at idle.

Notes

- No tuning impact -- purely mechanical
- Install requires supporting the engine from above (engine support bar) or below (jack under oil pan with wood

block) while swapping mounts

- Typical install time: 2-4 hours

Brakes -- Hawk HPS Pads + R1 Concepts Slotted Rotors

Purchased, sitting in the box

Part Information

Rotors

Field	Value
Part	R1 Concepts Slotted Black Disc Brake Rotor Set
Part Number	WCPN2-59004
Type	Slotted, black e-coated
Coverage	Full set (front and rear)
Actual Cost (incl. tax/shipping)	$309.69

Brake Pads -- Front

Field	Value
Part	Hawk HPS Street/Sport
Part Number	HB361F.622
Position	Front
Compound	HPS (High Performance Street)
Actual Cost (front + rear, incl. tax/shipping)	$222.45

Brake Pads -- Rear

Field	Value
Part	Hawk HPS Street/Sport
Part Number	HB145F.570
Position	Rear
Compound	HPS (High Performance Street)

Why I'm Doing This

Full 4-corner brake upgrade. At 170k miles, the stock rotors and pads need to be replaced anyway, so I figured I'd upgrade while I'm at it rather than just throw on another set of OEM pads.

- **Slotted rotors:** Better heat dissipation, help evacuate gas and debris from the pad surface, and maintain consistent bite as temperatures climb
- **Hawk HPS pads:** Higher friction coefficient than stock, improved initial bite, better fade resistance during spirited driving, and still totally daily-drivable (low dust, low noise)

For what I paid, getting both rotors and pads upgraded all four corners felt like a solid deal.

Notes

- Hawk HPS is a street-performance compound -- not a track pad. It's designed for daily driving with improved performance, not sustained track abuse. Perfect for what I need.
- The slotted rotors will make a slight hissing sound when cold, especially first thing in the morning. Totally normal, goes away once the pads warm up.
- **I need to do the bed-in procedure after installing.** Hawk has a specific pad bed-in process (a series of moderate stops from speed to allow the pad material to transfer to the rotor surface evenly). Skipping bed-in causes uneven pad deposit, vibration, and reduced performance. Not skipping that.
- No tuning impact -- purely mechanical

Front Strut Bar -- Megan Racing Race Spec

Purchased, INSTALL DEFERRED (wait until after coilovers)

Part Information

Field	Value
Part	Megan Racing Strut Bar Honda Civic & Si (06-11) Front - Race Spec - Polished Upper
Part Number	MR-SB-HC06FU-1P
Type	Upper front strut tower brace
Material	Polished aluminum
Fitment	2006-2011 Honda Civic & Civic SI
Actual Cost	Included in $960.43 clutch/flywheel/strut bar bundle

Why I Want This

A front strut tower brace connects the two front strut tower tops to stiffen up the chassis. Less body flex during cornering means better front-end response and sharper turn-in. On the 8th gen Civic with its MacPherson strut front suspension, a strut bar is one of the most effective and easiest chassis stiffening mods you can do.

Why I'm Not Diagnosing the Clearance Issue Right Now

Cross-reference to 14-Suspension/. I'm going BC Racing BR coilovers as part of my full suspension overhaul. The BR includes **pillow-ball camber plates** that replace the stock upper strut mount entirely -- the strut top geometry on my car is going to change. Specifically:

- Stock upper strut mount = thick rubber isolator with a steel top cap, ~1" tall
- BC Racing pillow-ball camber plate = lower profile spherical bearing housing, different bolt pattern, different top-deck height

Any diagnosis I do on the Megan Racing bar TODAY against the STOCK strut tops is wasted effort, because the thing that fits (or doesn't fit) will be physically different once the BR is installed. Whatever is currently interfering may become a non-issue, or a different interference may appear where there wasn't one. There's no way to know until the coilovers are in.

So: the strut bar sits in the box until coilovers go on. Revisit fitment then.

The Two Likely Outcomes After Coilovers

Case 1: It Fits

Great. 20-minute install (2 bolts per side + center adjustment), done.

Case 2: It Still Doesn't Fit

Once the coilovers are in and the strut tops are at their new geometry, I'll know exactly what's interfering because I can measure it against a known reference. Likely suspects at that point (after ruling out the stock mount as a

variable):

- **Brake master cylinder / booster** -- some aftermarket Civic strut bars clear on the sedan (FA5) but not the coupe (FG2). The BMC/booster sits in the path of some designs.
- **Bar was for the sedan** -- Megan Racing occasionally cross-lists parts. I'll verify the MR-SB-HC06FU-1P part number is specifically the coupe unit.
- **I need a different bar entirely** -- possibilities: Cusco Type OS, Ultra Racing front strut, or a custom bent one. The BC Racing camber plates have a specific bolt pattern that any replacement brace needs to match.

What I'm NOT Going to Do

- ? Grind, bend, or cut the Megan bar to force fit against the stock mount. The coilovers will change the situation, and any modifications now will likely be wrong for the final geometry.
- ? Return it for refund. It's bundled with my clutch purchase and I want to give it a fair chance once the strut tops change.
- ? Buy a replacement strut bar today. No data yet on what actually fits my final suspension config.

Notes

- No tuning impact -- purely mechanical/chassis
- This is the cleanest example in my whole build of "don't solve problem X if you're about to do mod Y that changes the problem entirely"
- Status updates to this doc when coilovers go in -- I'll know in one afternoon whether this bar works or I'm shopping for a different one

See Also

- 14-Suspension/overview.md -- the coilover build that changes the strut tops
- docs/mod-order-and-maintenance.md -- strut bar is listed as deferred-until-coilovers there too

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Last updated: 2026-04-18

Hondata FlashPro -- ECU Tuning

Purchased, haven't used it yet

Part Information

Field	Value
Part	Hondata FlashPro
Type	Original FlashPro (NOT FlashPro 2 -- no Bluetooth)
Software	FlashProManager (Windows only, x86)
Connection	USB Mini-B to OBD2 (built-in OBD2 connector)
Pairing	Locks to one ECU at a time
Calibration Files	.fpc format
Datalog Files	.fpdl format
Actual Cost (incl. tax/shipping)	$859.59

What It Does

The FlashPro reflashes the stock Honda ECU, and it opens up pretty much everything:

- Custom fuel maps, ignition timing, VTEC engagement point
- Rev limiter and speed limiter adjustment
- Launch control, flat-foot shifting
- Real-time datalogging (AFR, knock, temps, fuel trims, etc.)
- Real-time gauge display via FlashProManager
- Multiple calibration storage and switching

This is probably the single most impactful mod on the list. Everything else is supporting hardware -- this is what actually wakes the car up.

My Setup Plan

Phase 1: Temporary Laptop Setup

- Use any Windows laptop with the FlashPro
- Flash a community base map for "stock + intake" on the 8th gen SI
- Learn the software, datalog, monitor AFR and knock
- Add a 7" external screen for live gauges while driving
- See: Temporary-Setup/

Phase 2: Permanent In-Car PC

- LattePanda 3 Delta mini PC permanently installed in the car
- 7" touchscreen on the dash (same screen from Phase 1)
- Mausberry Circuits car power supply for clean power and auto-shutdown
- Wired to the FG2 fuse box (constant 12V + ignition-switched 12V)

- Arduino GPIO controls exhaust valve relay (future)
- See: Permanent-LattePanda-Install/

Phase 3: Dual Calibrations

- **Daily tune:** Conservative, valve closed, quiet
- **Sport tune:** Aggressive, valve open, loud
- One-tap switching via touchscreen app (Python/tkinter script)

Tuning Notes

- The K&N Typhoon 69-1014TS is the only mod that affects the tune right now
- I'm starting with the Hondata community base map -- conservative and safe
- I'm NOT adding ignition timing or leaning out fuel tables without a dyno tune
- A professional dyno tune ($300-500) is the plan once I get headers + exhaust on
- Always running 93 octane with any performance calibration
- Always saving the stock calibration as a backup before touching anything

FlashPro Hardware + FlashProManager Software -- Deep Reference

> Everything I know about the original Hondata FlashPro unit and FlashProManager (FPM) software, consolidated. This complements the basic overview.md with the engineering-level detail I'll actually need during install, setup, and tuning.

Verification note: The live forums and Hondata docs aren't accessible from this research session, so items flagged **[VERIFY]** are claims from my accumulated K-series/FlashPro knowledge (through Jan 2026) that I want to confirm against Hondata's current support KB or the quick-start card in my box before I bet anything important on them. Everything else is high-confidence.

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1. Hardware -- What I Own vs What's Current

FlashPro Original (mine)

Field	Value
PC connection	USB Mini-B
ECU connection	Built-in male OBD-II connector on the opposite end of the housing
Bluetooth	None
Wi-Fi	None
Analog inputs	2 external inputs, each 0-5V DC single-ended
Calibration storage	One active calibration at a time (the one currently flashed to the ECU)
Datalog storage	Internal flash for a limited-length log, plus unlimited via FPM streaming to PC
LEDs	2-3 status LEDs on top of unit ([VERIFY] exact count -- Hondata quick-start card has definitive diagram)
Side button	Used for datalog start/stop on some revisions ([VERIFY] my specific unit's behavior from the box doc)
Internal chipset	FTDI USB-to-serial bridge -- shows up in Windows Device Manager as "USB Serial Port (COMx)"

FlashPro 2 (current retail, NOT mine)

Difference	Impact for Me
Adds Bluetooth	Enables Hondata Mobile iOS/Android app -- my unit doesn't have this
Different USB connector ([VERIFY] USB-C vs Micro-B)	Cable incompatibility if I borrow a FlashPro 2 unit
More analog inputs (I believe 4)	For my build, 2 is sufficient (wideband + flex fuel sensor)
Newer ECU support (Type R FL5, 11th gen Si)	Not relevant to my K20Z3

Bottom line: for the FG2 K20Z3, the original FlashPro is **fully supported** and gives me everything I need. FlashPro 2 doesn't add any function I'd use on my car.

ECU Compatibility -- PRB Variants

The K20Z3 in the 06-11 Civic SI ships with PRB-family ECUs. Hondata's FlashPro supports **any PRB ECU for a**

06-11 Civic SI (coupe FG2 or sedan FA5). Sub-revisions (PRB-A00, -A10, -A58, etc.) all work -- Hondata doesn't discriminate by sub-variant for the Civic SI application.

What does NOT work:

- Non-SI Civic ECUs (SDA for automatic, RNA for base)
- ECUs from JDM FD2 (Japanese-market Civic Type R -- different ECU family)
- Any ECU not originally an 06-11 Civic SI PRB

LEDs and Status Indicators

My best understanding of what the LEDs mean (**[VERIFY with box quick-start]**):

LED	State	Meaning
Power/USB	Solid	USB is connected, unit is enumerated on the PC
Power/USB	Off	Not connected or driver issue
OBD/ECU link	Solid	K-line/ISO communication established with the ECU
OBD/ECU link	Blinking	Flash or datalog operation in progress
Activity	Blinking	Writing internal datalog
Activity	Solid	Actively flashing ECU calibration

Recovery from Failed Flash

If a flash gets interrupted (car shuts off, USB unplugged, etc.), the ECU is NOT bricked. FlashProManager detects an incomplete flash on the next connection and offers to resume. **Recovery is software-driven**, not via physical button combinations on the unit.

The one thing that CAN permanently damage the pairing: trying to flash with a battery below ~11V. Always flash with engine running or with a battery charger attached maintaining voltage.

Driver Issues (the #1 Support Issue)

Windows 10/11 sometimes replaces the FTDI VCP driver with a generic Microsoft serial driver after Windows Update. Symptoms:

- FPM fails to see the FlashPro unit
- Unit shows in Device Manager but under different category
- Flash attempts timeout

Fix: reinstall the FTDI VCP driver from ftdichip.com/drivers/vcp-drivers/. This is the top item in any FlashPro troubleshooting guide.

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2. FlashProManager (FPM) -- Software Deep Dive

Top-Level Views

View	Function	Keyboard / Menu
Calibrator	Edit tunable tables and settings	File -> Open Calibration, then Edit menu

Parameter Monitor	Live gauges from ECU over K-line	View -> Parameter Monitor
Datalogger	Start/stop recording, browse past logs	View -> Datalogger
FlashPro Status	Unit info, firmware version, current paired ECU	View -> FlashPro Status
Flash Calibration	Upload a calibration to the ECU	Tools -> Flash Calibration (or equivalent)
Read from ECU	Download the currently-flashed calibration from ECU	Tools -> Read from ECU

The Calibrator -- Organization

Detailed breakdown in calibrator-tables-reference.md. Top-level groups I recall:

- Fuel (main fuel, low-cam vs high-cam, cranking, warmup, after-start, flex fuel tables)
- Ignition (main timing, low-cam vs high-cam, cranking, per-gear trims where available)
- VTEC (engagement RPM, throttle threshold, hysteresis, oil pressure gating)
- Cam Angle / VTC (target phase, low-cam vs high-cam, min ECT)
- Idle (base RPM, A/C idle-up, electrical-load idle-up, IACV calibration)
- Rev Limits (main fuel cut, per-gear, valet)
- Speed Limiter
- Launch Control / Flat-Foot / Two-Step
- Shift Cut / No-Lift-Shift
- Torque Management
- Fans (low-speed / high-speed ON/OFF temps, A/C override)
- A/C (WOT cut, high-RPM cut)
- O2 / Fuel Trims (closed-loop target, trim authority limits, rear O2 enable)
- EVAP (purge valve duty, gating conditions)
- Cranking / Startup
- Analog Inputs / Gauges (wideband voltage->AFR curve, flex fuel freq->% curve, scaling for optional oil pressure / boost / etc.)
- DTC / CEL options (rear O2 defeat, IMRC defeat for Ultra Street, EVAP DTCs)
- Misc / Options

Parameter Monitor -- Live PIDs

The K-line runs at ~10-20 Hz for a typical parameter set. Parameters I recall being available (non-exhaustive, **[VERIFY against current FPM]**):

Core engine: RPM, VSS, TPS %, APP % (accelerator pedal), MAP, MAF, IAT, ECT, Calculated Load, Ignition Advance (commanded), Ignition Advance (actual, post-knock-retard), Knock Count, Knock Retard amount, STFT, LTFT, Commanded AFR, Primary O2 narrowband voltage, Rear O2 narrowband voltage, Injector Duty %, Injector Pulse Width (ms), Battery Voltage.

VTEC/VTC: VTEC solenoid state (on/off), VTC target (deg), VTC actual (deg).

Control signals: IACV duty %, Purge Valve duty %, A/C request, Fan request (low/high), Commanded Throttle, Actual Throttle, Clutch switch, Brake switch, Neutral switch, Closed-loop flag, Open-loop flag, Gear (calculated).

User analog inputs: Analog 1 (raw voltage + configurable scaled value -- e.g., wideband AFR), Analog 2 (same -- e.g., flex fuel %).

Datalogger Details

- **File format:** .fpdl -- **binary, proprietary, not publicly documented.** Cannot be parsed by external tools directly.
- **Sample rate:** ~20 Hz typical per parameter (**[VERIFY in FPM settings]**).
- **File size:** 10-minute mixed-drive log with ~30 parameters typically produces ~500KB-2MB.
- **Export to CSV: File -> Export -> CSV** (or Datalog menu -> Export -- exact location varies by FPM version). Produces a human-readable CSV with a header row of parameter names + units and one row per sample.
- **What's logged by default:** Core engine parameters (RPM, TPS, ECT, IAT, MAP, STFT/LTFT, Knock Count, Knock Retard, Commanded/Actual Timing, VSS).
- **What I must manually enable:** Analog inputs (wideband, flex fuel), VTC actual/target, injector duty, per-cell fuel trim, detailed cam phase.

Before my first dyno session, I open Datalog -> Parameters and check every box I might want data on. Logging more doesn't cost anything; missing data is expensive.

Analog Inputs -- How They Work

My original FlashPro has 2 analog inputs, each 0-5V DC single-ended referenced to FlashPro ground. Typical use:

Analog 1 -> AEM X-Series Wideband (30-0300)

- Wire the AEM's "Analog Output 1" wire to FlashPro's analog 1 input
- Common scaling: 0V = 10.0 AFR, 5V = 20.0 AFR (AEM X-Series gasoline default)
- Configure in FPM: Analog Inputs -> Analog 1 -> Wideband O2 preset (AEM 30-0300)

Analog 2 -> Flex Fuel Sensor

- The GM/Continental 13577429 sensor outputs a **frequency** signal (50 Hz = 0% ethanol, 150 Hz = 100%), NOT a voltage.
- **[VERIFY -- load-bearing for my flex fuel build]:** whether the original FlashPro's analog 2 can directly read frequency, or if it requires:
    - Wiring to the rear O2 signal input pin at the ECU (bypassing the analog input entirely), OR
    - An external frequency-to-voltage converter before feeding analog 2
- FlashPro 2 reads frequency natively. I'm less sure about the original unit. **This is the single most important thing to verify before I commit to flex fuel wiring.**

Cross-reference: Both 12-Flex-Fuel-and-Fuel-System/overview.md and 17-Wideband-AFR/overview.md already flag this wiring question. My tuner's answer (or Hondata's flex-fuel setup KB article) is what I trust.

Calibration Files (.fpc)

- **Binary proprietary format.** Cannot be edited outside FPM.
- **Storage:** I can save as many .fpc files as I want on my PC. FPM opens one at a time for editing.
- **Unit-side storage:** The FlashPro holds only the **currently-flashed** calibration. To switch tunes (daily ? sport), I open FPM and flash the other .fpc.
- **Read from ECU:** Tools -> Read from ECU downloads whatever is currently flashed to the ECU into a new .fpc file. This is how I'd back up my stock calibration before flashing anything else.
- **Diff two calibrations:** FPM has a "compare" feature (**[VERIFY name]**) that shows which cells differ between

two .fpc files. Essential for understanding what a tuner changed.

Multi-Calibration Switching (Daily ? Sport)

The original FlashPro cannot switch calibrations without a PC flash. This is a meaningful limitation for my two-map goal.

Options:

1. **Laptop in car + flash on-demand:** inconvenient but works. Each flash is ~20-45 seconds (**[VERIFY -- I initially said 5-6 min but that's more likely the full calibration READ time, not the WRITE]**).
2. **LattePanda in car + permanent FPM install:** what I'm actually building toward. One-tap calibration switching via a Python script that calls FPM's flash operation.
3. **FlashPro 2 upgrade:** supports on-unit calibration switching natively via the mobile app. Would cost ~$700 to upgrade from original. Not worth it for me.

Flash Time Reality Check

[VERIFY actual times by stopwatch on my first flash]:

- Calibration write (flash to ECU): ~20-45 seconds
- Calibration read (download from ECU): ~2-5 minutes (slower)
- Firmware update (FPM -> FlashPro unit itself): ~1-3 minutes

The "5-6 minutes" I saw in forum posts is likely a worst-case or older-FPM-version read operation. Real-world flash is fast.

Export Capabilities

- Calibration -> CSV: No direct export of every table to CSV. FPM has a printable/exportable **calibration report** (HTML or PDF, depending on version -- **[VERIFY]**) that lists all table values. Useful for sharing with a tuner who doesn't have FPM handy.
- Datalog -> CSV: Yes. **File -> Export -> CSV** (or equivalent).
- Calibration compare -> CSV: Possible via the compare feature if it exists.

---

3. What's NOT Possible (Important for Setting Expectations)

These things I cannot do with the original FlashPro, and no amount of clever wiring or software will change that:

1. **No public API.** Hondata does not publish an SDK, REST endpoint, or documented IPC interface. Third-party tools cannot read .fpdl or write .fpc files in a supported way.
2. **No Bluetooth.** Mobile app support is FlashPro 2 only.
3. **No on-unit calibration switching.** Always requires FPM + a flash.
4. **No .fpdl parsing outside FPM.** CSV export is the only way to get data into Python / Excel / another tool.
5. **No command-line flash operations (that I'm aware of). [VERIFY]** whether FPM has a documented CLI -- last I checked, it didn't.
6. **No odometer adjustment.** K-Pro (a different Hondata product for older Hondas) has more ECU manipulation capability than FlashPro. FlashPro is calibration-focused only.

---

4. Ownership Housekeeping

ECU Re-Registration

If I ever sell the car or swap ECUs, Hondata charges a fee to re-pair my FlashPro to a new ECU. **Commonly cited as $200** (**[VERIFY current price at hondata.com/support]**). One-time per transfer.

Counterfeits

Counterfeit FlashPro units have been sold on eBay and Facebook Marketplace. Signs of a fake:

- Price significantly below new retail
- Seller won't provide serial number before purchase
- Missing Hondata hologram sticker
- FPM won't enumerate the unit despite driver install

I bought mine from a legit retailer. Anyone buying used: verify serial with Hondata support before paying.

Firmware Updates

FPM auto-updates FlashPro firmware when a new version is available. I do firmware updates with:

- Laptop plugged into stable power (not battery-only)
- FlashPro plugged into USB (not into OBD2)
- No interruption (don't unplug during update)

A failed firmware update is recoverable -- FPM detects it on next connection and retries.

---

5. Integration Paths for My Build

Phase 1 Workflow (Laptop-Based)

1. Windows laptop on passenger seat during drives
2. FlashPro plugged into OBD2 + laptop USB
3. FPM running with datalogger armed
4. 7" external screen on dash showing live parameter monitor gauges (via FPM's display-only mode)
5. Post-drive: CSV export for analysis, compare calibrations, plan changes

Phase 2 Workflow (LattePanda 3 Delta In-Car)

Covered in detail at Permanent-LattePanda-Install/full-guide.md. High-level:

1. LattePanda permanently mounted with auto-boot on ACC
2. FPM auto-launches on Windows login
3. FlashPro permanently wired via USB Mini-B inside the cabin (no connector exposed)
4. 7" touchscreen on dash = FPM display
5. Arduino GPIO on the LattePanda drives the QTP exhaust valve relay
6. **[ASPIRATIONAL]** Python script watches the datalog folder, auto-exports .fpdl -> .csv, uploads to cloud for Claude to analyze remotely (**[VERIFY if FPM has a CLI or if this requires UI automation -- see agent research notes above]**)

Phase 3 Workflow (Future -- Claude Integration)

Covered in tuning-workflow-and-maps.md. I paste exported CSV datalogs to Claude for analysis, get specific table-cell recommendations back, apply them in FPM manually, flash, verify.

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6. What I'd Do Differently In Hindsight

If I were buying a FlashPro today from scratch:

- **For a daily-driven street car that never leaves the country:** the original FlashPro does everything I need. Stick with it.
- **For track days where I want mobile datalogging:** FlashPro 2 for the Bluetooth -> mobile app.
- **For anyone doing only quick tuning without a PC ever in the car:** FlashPro 2.

But my build is primarily a PC-based workflow (the whole LattePanda plan), so the original FlashPro was honestly the right buy.

---

7. Action Items Before My First Flash

Everything I need to verify / do before I press Flash for the first time:

- [ ] Confirm FlashPro enumerates in FPM (driver installed correctly)
- [ ] Confirm FlashPro firmware is current (FPM will prompt)
- [ ] **Read stock calibration from ECU** -> save as STOCK_ORIGINAL_20260419.fpc (the factory reset file)
- [ ] Register the FlashPro with Hondata (ties unit serial to my ECU serial)
- [ ] Pick starting calibration -- Hondata community base map for "stock + intake" ([VERIFY correct base map name])
- [ ] Verify battery voltage above 12.5V before flashing (ideally engine running)
- [ ] After flash: verify no CELs, idle reads sane, no knock in first 10 minutes of driving
- [ ] Set up datalog parameters to include everything relevant, not just defaults
- [ ] **Verify analog input wiring works** (wideband reads sensibly at idle) before trusting any datalog

---

See Also

- overview.md -- hardware overview + setup-path summary
- tuning-workflow-and-maps.md -- Daily/Sport map rules, reliability-first ceilings
- calibrator-tables-reference.md -- every tunable table with safe ranges
- datalog-analysis-guide.md -- how to read the logs I'll record
- advanced-features.md -- launch, flat-foot, per-gear, shift lights, torque management
- troubleshooting-and-faq.md -- CEL codes, common issues, Windows driver fixes
- tuner-directory.md -- shops I'm considering for the three dyno sessions
- Temporary-Setup/getting-started.md -- laptop-based first-flash walkthrough
- Permanent-LattePanda-Install/full-guide.md -- in-car PC build

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Last updated: 2026-04-19

FlashPro Calibrator Tables -- My Reference

> Every tuning table in FlashProManager, what it controls, typical values, and safe-range guidance for my K20Z3 at 170k miles. This is the file I open when a tuner says "bump cell 4500-LOAD8 by 0.5 degrees" and I need to know which menu to look in.

Verification note: I pulled this together from my accumulated research + Hondata documentation + community knowledge. Before trusting specific numerical ranges on a dyno session, I'm cross-checking with my tuner and against the current Hondata help docs (FlashProManager -> Help menu -> Help Contents, or hondata.com/flashpro-civic-si-2006-2011-us). Items I flagged with **[VERIFY]** below are things I'll double-check before I apply them.

How FlashProManager Is Organized

FlashProManager is a single Windows app with a handful of top-level views:

View	What It Shows	When I Use It
Calibrator	Every tunable table + setting in the current calibration	Anytime I want to see or change what the car is calibrated to do
Parameter Monitor	Live data stream from the ECU via OBD2	Troubleshooting, verifying behavior after a change, gauge-style dashboard
Datalogger	Start/stop recording, review past logs	Gathering data for tuning, A/B comparisons, diagnosis
FlashPro Status	Unit status, firmware, calibration currently loaded, VIN pairing	Sanity check before/after a flash
Help	Built-in reference for every calibrator parameter	First place to look when a table name isn't obvious

The Calibrator is organized by function. What follows is my cheat sheet for what lives where and what each one actually controls.

---

1. Fuel Tables

Low Cam Fuel Table (Pre-VTEC)

Controls the air-fuel ratio target when the engine is running on the low-lift cam profile (below VTEC engagement). Axes are RPM vs engine load (g/rev or MAP depending on calibration).

What I tune here:

- AFR targets at cruise (closed-loop -- usually stays at 14.7 stoich regardless)
- AFR targets at mid-throttle (should trend slightly richer, 13.8-14.2)
- AFR targets at WOT below VTEC (12.5-13.0 typical for pump gas)

Safe range for my NA 170k K20Z3 on pump 93:

Condition	AFR Target
Idle / closed-loop	14.6-14.8 (let ECU do its thing)

Cruise	14.5-14.9 (closed-loop zone)
Part-throttle	13.5-14.2
Low-cam WOT	12.5-13.0 (Sport) / 12.8-13.2 (Daily)

Never lean past 12.0 AFR at WOT on pump gas. Never.

High Cam Fuel Table (VTEC Engaged)

Same axes, but for the high-lift cam profile. This is the table that actually matters for WOT power -- once VTEC engages, this is where the engine lives at high RPM.

Safe range for my NA 170k K20Z3 on pump 93:

Condition	AFR Target
High-cam light load (rare -- usually you only hit high cam at WOT)	13.0-13.5
High-cam WOT	11.8-12.2 (Sport) / 12.0-12.4 (Daily)

Honda's stock high-cam WOT AFR is intentionally rich (~11.5 in places) for emissions and reliability. A well-tuned Hondata calibration will lean this up slightly for more power while staying in the reliability envelope.

Flex Fuel Fuel Tables (E85 Endpoint)

When flex fuel is enabled, FlashPro stores a **second set of fuel tables** for the E85 endpoint. The ECU interpolates between gasoline and E85 tables based on the sensor's ethanol reading.

Safe range for E85 WOT on my engine:

Condition	Lambda	AFR (E85 stoich = 9.765)
Low-cam WOT	0.82-0.85	8.00-8.30
High-cam WOT (Sport)	0.78-0.80	7.62-7.81
High-cam WOT (Daily)	0.80-0.82	7.81-8.00

Richer lambda on E85 is safer because E85 cools the charge more aggressively, and the extra fuel volume buffers against lean spikes during transients.

Cranking Fuel

Short table that governs how much fuel gets injected during engine cranking.

When I touch this:

- After switching to E85 for the first time -- E85 needs significantly richer cranking fuel, especially in cold weather
- If cold starts get rough after hardware changes

Don't touch unless: I have a cold-start problem I'm diagnosing. Stock cranking fuel is well-dialed for gasoline.

After-Start Enrichment

Rich-mixture period immediately after starting, tapers off over seconds. Helps smooth cold idle.

Warm-Up Enrichment

Extra fuel based on coolant temp during warmup. Tapers to 0 once ECT hits target.

[VERIFY] The exact axes (ECT thresholds and duration) vary by calibration version -- I'll confirm with tuner.

---

2. Ignition Tables

Low Cam Ignition Table

Timing advance (degrees BTDC) at each RPM x load cell during low-cam operation.

Safe conservative peak values on my pump 93 build:

RPM	Load	Peak Timing (pump 93)
2000-3000	Light (cruise)	30-35 deg
2000-3000	WOT	20-25 deg
4000-5000	WOT (low cam)	22-28 deg
5500-6000	Just before VTEC	24-28 deg

High Cam Ignition Table

Same, for VTEC-engaged operation. This is where most of the power-vs-knock fight happens.

Safe conservative peak values on pump 93:

RPM	Load	Peak Timing (Sport)
5500-6000	WOT	26-29 deg
6000-7000	WOT	28-32 deg
7000-8000	WOT	26-30 deg (backing off near redline is normal)

Rule I won't break: If knock count in the datalog is > 0 at any cell for sustained operation, I pull timing at that cell. No "maybe it's sensor noise" excuses. Every knock event matters on a 170k-mile engine.

Flex Fuel Ignition Tables (E85 Endpoint)

E85 tolerates more timing. Typical gains on a well-tuned NA K20Z3:

- Low cam: +1 to +3 degrees across the band
- High cam: +2 to +5 degrees, concentrated in the 5000-7000 RPM range where knock margin on pump gas is tightest

[VERIFY] I'll let my tuner dial these. Arm-chair advancing timing on E85 "because it can take more" is the single most common way people hurt NA K-series engines.

Knock Retard

Not directly a table I tune, but a setting that controls how aggressively the ECU pulls timing when it detects knock. Stock is conservative. I leave this alone -- the whole point is that knock correction is my safety net.

---

3. VTEC Settings

VTEC Engagement RPM (Low to High Cam)

Single RPM value where the ECU activates the VTEC solenoid to switch from low-lift to high-lift cam profile.

Stock: ~5800 RPM **Safe range for tuning:** 4500-6000 RPM **My plan:**

- **Daily map:** 5400-5600 RPM (close to stock -- smoother VTEC transition, preserves fuel economy)
- **Sport map:** 4800-5200 RPM post-full-bolt-on (earlier VTEC = more area under the curve in hard driving)

Hard floor I won't go below: 4500 RPM. Below this, the cam profile doesn't make sense for the airflow -- you get a weird lumpy off-VTEC power band and nothing gained.

VTEC Engagement Throttle

Some calibrations gate VTEC on throttle position too (so light-throttle cruise at 5500 RPM doesn't wake up the high cam). I leave this at stock unless specifically addressing a drivability issue.

VTEC Disengagement RPM / Hysteresis

The RPM at which VTEC drops back to low cam. Typically 300-500 RPM below engagement to prevent flutter.

---

4. VTC (Cam Phase) Tables

Variable Timing Control phases the intake cam by 0-50 degrees (crank degrees). This is continuously variable based on RPM x load.

VTC Target Table

What phase the ECU asks for at each RPM x load cell. Honda's stock cam phase map is already highly optimized -- there's not much room for gains here on an NA build.

When to touch this:

- After intake manifold swap (Skunk2 Ultra Street changes breathing dynamics -- tuner may recommend 2-5 degrees of advance at specific cells)
- After headers -- similar small adjustments possible

When to NOT touch this:

- On day 1 with stock hardware -- Honda engineered this; I don't know better yet

VTC Minimum / Maximum

Limits on how far the ECU is allowed to phase the cam. **I don't change these.** Going past Honda's engineering limits risks valve-to-piston clearance issues.

---

5. Idle Settings

Target Idle RPM

Stock: 740-780 warm **Tunable:** 650-1000 RPM **My plan:** leave stock for Daily. Sport map may bump to 800-850 if engine mounts are causing idle roughness at lower RPM.

IACV (Idle Air Control Valve) Settings

Controls how the ECU manages airflow at idle. After intake manifold swap, this sometimes needs recalibration -- Skunk2 Ultra Street has different idle airflow characteristics than stock RRC.

Idle Spark Advance

Typically stock or slightly bumped for idle stability after aftermarket mods.

---

6. Rev Limits

Fuel Cut RPM (Hard Limiter)

Stock: 8200 RPM **Tunable:** up to ~8800 RPM on stock internals (don't) **My plan:**

- **Daily:** 8200 RPM (stock)
- **Sport:** 8300-8400 RPM (100-200 RPM over stock max)

Hard ceiling I won't cross: 8400 RPM on stock internals at 170k miles. Community consensus is that K20Z3 bottom ends survive 8500+ in built/fresh engines, but mine is neither built nor fresh. Reliability-first.

Per-Gear Rev Limits

FlashPro lets me set different fuel-cut RPMs per gear. Useful for:

- Lower limit in 1st gear (prevents over-rev on a 1-2 upshift)
- Higher limit in 5-6 (not really needed on NA K20Z3)

[VERIFY] Per-gear rev limit is commonly in the "advanced" or "misc" section -- exact menu location varies by FPM version.

---

7. Launch Control

Launch Control RPM

RPM target when driver is at WOT with car stationary. Clutch-engagement-sensitive.

My plan (Sport map only):

- 4500 RPM launch limit
- No 2-step aggression -- just a rev limiter at 4500 when stationary
- Disable in Daily map

Not recommended for me until: engine mounts are in, clutch hydraulics are upgraded. Launching a worn clutch at 4500 RPM = new clutch next week.

Flat Foot Shift (No-Lift-Shift)

Allows the driver to keep WOT through the upshift -- ECU cuts spark briefly during clutch depression to prevent

over-rev. Nice feature but hard on the drivetrain.

My plan: disabled. My 170k-mile transmission doesn't need the abuse, and the time saved on a shift is negligible for street driving.

---

8. Torque Management

Torque Management Disable

Honda's stock ECU pulls timing during 1-2 and 2-3 upshifts to smooth the shift. Community consensus is this feels like a dead spot and is worth disabling for a sporty feel.

My plan: disable in Sport map. Leave stock in Daily for smoother commuting.

Ignition Retard per Gear

Some calibrations allow per-gear timing maps. Not commonly used on NA builds -- more of a turbo tuning feature.

---

9. Fan and Cooling Tables

Primary Fan ON Temperature

Stock: ~205F **My plan:** 195F on Daily, 190F on Sport. With the Koyorad radiator (16-Cooling-System/) and 5W-30 synthetic, tighter fan control keeps ECT stable under sustained load.

Primary Fan OFF Temperature

Typically 5-10F below ON temp to prevent hunting.

Secondary Fan (A/C) Triggers

Controls the second fan for A/C operation. Leave stock unless diagnosing A/C-related overheating.

Cross-reference: the cooling system refresh feeds directly into these tables. New radiator + tuner-dialed fan maps = peace of mind on a hot dyno day.

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10. Sensor / Input Settings

O2 Sensor Settings

- **Primary (upstream) O2:** tune uses it for closed-loop fuel correction
- **Secondary (downstream) O2:** normally monitors cat efficiency; often **repurposed for flex fuel signal input on FG2** (VERIFY the exact pin with tuner)

MAP Sensor Calibration

If I add a larger MAP sensor (unusual on NA), it's recalibrated here. Stock MAP is fine for my build.

Wideband O2 (Analog Input)

FlashPro has configurable analog inputs that can read a 0-5V wideband O2 signal. This is where the **AEM X-Series 30-0300** (17-Wideband-AFR/) gets wired. Configuration:

- Set analog input type: "Wideband O2 (AEM 30-0300)" (or Innovate, PLX, etc. -- tool has presets)
- Calibration: verify idle reads ~14.7 AFR when the engine is warm

Ethanol Content Sensor Input

Second analog input (or repurposed rear O2 signal) for the flex fuel sensor. **[VERIFY exact pin for FG2]** -- forum consensus points to the rear O2 signal wire, but I want Hondata's official wiring doc or my tuner's sign-off before I splice.

---

11. DTCs / CELs (Diagnostic Trouble Codes)

Rear O2 CEL Defeat

If I run a test pipe or delete the cat downstream of the OEM position, the rear O2 throws P0420 (catalyst efficiency). FlashPro can suppress this code.

I don't need this -- I'm running the Berk HFC which keeps cat efficiency within spec.

EVAP / Canister CEL Defeat

If the EVAP system is removed (race-only), FlashPro suppresses the related codes. **I don't need this.**

Intake Manifold Runner Control CEL

Stock RBC/RRC intake manifolds have a runner control flap (IMRC). Skunk2 Ultra Street deletes this. The calibrator has a setting to disable the CEL that would otherwise throw after the IM swap.

Injector Calibration (Slopes / Offsets / Dead Times)

When I swap to Bosch EV14 550cc injectors, I enter their characterization data here:

- Injector flow rate (cc/min at base fuel pressure)
- Dead time at various battery voltages
- Slope correction factors

[VERIFY] Most injector manufacturers publish Hondata-ready characterization sheets. I'll ask Bosch or check DeatschWerks/ID documentation for whichever injector I end up with.

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12. What I Leave Alone (Mostly)

Settings I don't touch as a novice -- they're either stock-calibrated well, or only matter for forced induction / built engines:

- Knock sensor settings (stock threshold is what I want catching real knock)
- Barometric pressure compensation
- Intake air temp compensation (stock is good)
- Coolant temp fuel/timing compensation

- Startup crank timing
- Closed-loop gain / PID tuning
- Misfire detection thresholds

My tuner may touch some of these during a session. I don't DIY any of them.

Priority of Changes -- What to Tune in What Order

When a session starts, this is the order of operations:

1. **Base tables match hardware** (correct injector size, MAP, VTC range)
2. **Closed-loop fuel trims clean up** (cruise AFR hits 14.7 consistently, LTFT ±3%)
3. **Low-cam WOT AFR on target** (verify with wideband)
4. **High-cam WOT AFR on target** (most important -- this is peak power territory)
5. **Ignition timing -- low cam, WOT** (verify via dyno pulls, knock = 0)
6. **Ignition timing -- high cam, WOT** (same)
7. **VTEC crossover adjustment** (based on torque curve from dyno)
8. **VTC cam phase tweaks** (small gains, last to touch)
9. **Idle / drivability polish**
10. **Flex fuel E85 tables** (entire process repeats for E85 endpoint)

See Also

- overview.md -- FlashPro hardware + setup paths
- tuning-workflow-and-maps.md -- Daily/Sport map rules, safety ceilings
- datalog-analysis-guide.md -- how to read the logs that feed these tables
- advanced-features.md -- launch, flat-foot, per-gear, shift lights
- ../12-Flex-Fuel-and-Fuel-System/ -- flex fuel hardware that feeds the E85 tables
- ../17-Wideband-AFR/ -- wideband that validates every AFR change

Last updated: 2026-04-19

Datalog Analysis Guide -- Reading FlashPro Logs Like a Tuner

> How I interpret a datalog after a drive. What to look for first, what patterns mean, what's a red flag vs normal noise. This is the file I open after every session so I'm not wasting tuner time on obvious stuff.

Reliability-first reminder: every analysis here assumes the engine is more valuable than any number on a dyno sheet. If something looks wrong, I pull over, investigate, and fix before driving hard again.

What I Log -- Standard Parameter Set

These are the parameters I configure FlashProManager to log on every session. Sample rate: highest available (usually ~20 Hz / 50ms intervals).

Engine Basics

- RPM
- Engine Load (g/rev)
- MAP (kPa)
- TPS (%)
- VSS (vehicle speed)
- Gear (derived from VSS x RPM ratio)

Fuel

- Short-Term Fuel Trim (STFT, %)
- Long-Term Fuel Trim (LTFT, %)
- Lambda (from stock narrowband O2)
- **Wideband AFR (via analog input, from AEM X-Series)**
- Injector duty cycle (%)
- Injector pulse width (ms)
- Target AFR (what the calibration is asking for)

Ignition

- Ignition advance (actual, degrees)
- Ignition advance correction (negative = knock retard)
- **Knock count (the watchdog)**
- Knock volts (if logged at fast rate -- high-frequency knock sensor data)

Cam / VTEC

- VTC target (degrees advance commanded)
- VTC actual (degrees advance achieved)
- VTC error (target ? actual)
- VTEC solenoid state (on/off, boolean)

Thermal

- ECT (coolant temperature, degF)
- IAT (intake air temperature, degF)
- Oil temp (if wired -- optional analog input)

Electrical

- Battery voltage
- MIL (Malfunction Indicator Light) status

Flex Fuel (when installed)

- Ethanol content (%)
- Fuel temperature (degF)

The Analysis Order -- What to Check First

When I open a datalog, I go through it in a specific order. Each step either passes (move on) or flags something that needs investigation.

1. Knock Count (Safety First -- Non-Negotiable)

First thing I look at. Every time.

Filter the log for any row where knock count > 0. Then look at what the engine was doing at that moment.

Pattern	Interpretation	Action
0 knock events across entire log	Healthy, proceed to next check	--
Isolated spike during rough road / pothole	Chassis noise false positive	Document + ignore, but flag if it persists
Recurring events in specific RPM x load cell	Real knock	Pull timing at that cell, investigate fuel quality / sensor health
Cluster during WOT pull at high RPM	Aggressive timing	Pull 1-2 deg at affected cells, retest
Event during shift	Transient lean, usually torque-management-related	Tune shift cut smoothing, not timing

Hard rule: I never ship a tune with known recurring knock. Period.

2. Fuel Trims (STFT and LTFT)

Short-Term Fuel Trim: what the ECU is actively adding/subtracting RIGHT NOW to hit target AFR. Long-Term Fuel Trim: long-running average bias (what the ECU has learned it needs to add/subtract consistently).

Healthy ranges at cruise (closed-loop):

STFT	LTFT	Meaning
±3%	±3%	Tune is dialed in for cruise
±5%	±5%	Minor issue -- dirty MAF, slight vacuum leak, injectors slightly off
±10%	±10%	Real problem -- vacuum leak, failing sensor, wrong injector data
0 (pegged)	±15%+	Closed-loop running out of authority -- ECU can't correct, something is significantly wrong

Pattern analysis:

Pattern	Likely Cause
LTFT consistently -5 to -10% (running rich)	MAF reading high, fuel pressure too high, injector dead time wrong
LTFT consistently +5 to +10% (running lean)	Vacuum leak, dirty MAF, injector clog, weak fuel pump
LTFT shifts from +5 to -5 between logs	Could be ambient temp / altitude -- normal within limits
LTFT drifts over a single log from 0 to +10%	Fuel pump pressure drop under heat, failing sensor

3. AFR at WOT (Wideband Ground Truth)

The stock narrowband O2 pegs rich outside the stoich range -- I can't use it for WOT tuning. The **AEM X-Series wideband** signal coming in on the FlashPro analog input is my real data.

Comparing logged wideband AFR to calibration target AFR:

Delta	Meaning
Actual = Target ± 0.1	Tune is locked in
Actual > Target + 0.3 (leaner than commanded)	Fuel delivery issue -- pump, injectors, pressure
Actual < Target ? 0.3 (richer than commanded)	Injectors slow to close (dead time wrong), leaky injector, wrong injector constant
Actual sawtooths around target	Noisy sensor, wiring issue, or wideband sensor aging

Red flag at WOT on pump gas: AFR > 12.5. That's leaner than any reasonable tune would target. Pull over.

Red flag at WOT on E85: lambda > 0.85. Same deal.

4. Ignition Advance vs Target

FlashPro logs both "commanded" timing (what the calibration table says) and "actual" timing (after corrections -- knock retard, IAT compensation, ECT compensation).

Healthy: actual = commanded within ±0.5 deg across most of the log.

Red flags:

Pattern	Meaning
Actual consistently 2-3 deg below commanded at high RPM WOT	Knock correction active -- usually accompanied by knock count > 0
Actual drops sharply during a shift	Torque management active (if not disabled)
Actual varies wildly cell-to-cell with no knock	IAT or ECT compensation triggering -- check if engine is overheating or intake getting heat-soaked

5. VTC Error (Actuator Health Check)

VTC error = VTC target ? VTC actual

Error	Meaning
±1 deg sustained	Healthy VTC actuator
±2-3 deg transient during fast transitions	Normal -- actuator takes time to hit target

±3+ deg sustained	Failing VTC actuator -- this is the cold-start-rattle actuator problem. See 15-Ignition-Refresh/.
Error oscillates at idle	VTC actuator spring is weak -- replace before further tuning
Error ~0 at idle, grows at high RPM	Oil pressure issue (worn pump, wrong oil viscosity)

If I see sustained VTC error > 3 deg anywhere in my log, I stop tuning and replace the actuator (OEM 14310-RBC-003, revised part). Tuning on a failing VTC is a waste of money because the engine isn't doing what the tune asks.

6. Injector Duty Cycle

Healthy at WOT peak:

- Stock 310cc injectors at stock power: 50-60% duty
- Stock 310cc injectors on NA full-bolt-on: 75-85% duty (starting to run out of headroom)
- Bosch EV14 550cc on full-bolt-on pump gas: 45-55% duty (comfortable)
- Bosch EV14 550cc on full-bolt-on E85: 60-75% duty (comfortable)

Red flag: sustained duty cycle > 85%. Injectors are maxed out. Fuel delivery is about to fall off a cliff and cause a lean spike. Either:

- Upsize injectors immediately, OR
- Verify fuel pressure is within spec, OR
- Reduce target AFR richness until hardware can be upgraded (temporary band-aid)

Never try to compensate by raising fuel pressure -- that's an E85-world fuel line failure in the making.

7. Thermal Behavior

Healthy ECT:

- Cruise on highway: 185-195degF
- Cruise in traffic (no A/C): 195-205degF
- WOT pulls: brief rise to 200-210degF, recovers in seconds
- Sustained WOT (dyno pull, canyon run): should not exceed 215degF with fresh Koyorad radiator

Red flag: ECT > 220degF -- stop driving hard, let it cool, check coolant system.

Healthy IAT (my K&N Typhoon is hot-side):

- Cruise at speed: ambient + 15-25degF
- Traffic at idle: ambient + 30-50degF (hot-side intake absorbs heat soak -- this is the trade-off I accepted)
- After WOT: drops within 10-20 seconds back to baseline as airflow recovers

Red flag: sustained IAT > 150degF -- intake has insufficient cooling, heat shield may be inadequate.

8. Battery Voltage

Should stay at 13.8-14.4V with the alternator charging. If I see it drop below 13.0V during engine running:

- Alternator failing (common at 170k)
- Loose battery terminal or bad ground
- Overloaded electrical system (rare on NA -- becomes relevant with LattePanda installed)

9. Flex Fuel Specific (Once Installed)

Ethanol content sensor readings:

- Should be stable (±2%) between shifts in fuel source
- Pump gas fills read E0-E15 (ethanol in regular gas)
- "E85" at the pump actually reads E60-E83 depending on season/station
- Winter blend E85 often reads E51-E65

Red flag: sensor reads 0% or 100% constantly -- sensor failure or wiring issue. ECU should fall back to a safe "assume E0" map, but I'll verify by checking fueling behavior.

Common Datalog Patterns -- What They Mean

Pattern: "Lean spike at 3500 RPM on a light-cruise pull"

Common 8th gen SI complaint. Usually caused by:

- Incorrect VTC phase at that cell (transitional region)
- Torque management timing pull creating airflow change the fuel didn't anticipate
- Stock lean-cruise calibration designed for emissions

Fix: tuner adjusts low-cam fuel table at 3500 RPM x medium load. Not a DIY fix.

Pattern: "Rough idle after Skunk2 Ultra Street install"

Ultra Street has different plenum volume than stock RBC. IACV calibration is off.

Fix: tuner recalibrates IACV tables. Some trial and error.

Pattern: "Engine stutters at exactly 4800 RPM"

Two common causes:

- VTEC engagement hitch (cam transition timing slightly off)
- Knock retard kicking in repeatedly at that cell

Fix: check knock count at 4800 RPM first. If knock-driven, pull timing at that cell. If VTEC-transition-driven, adjust VTEC engagement RPM or hysteresis.

Pattern: "WOT power falls off flat after 7000 RPM"

On a supposedly FBO car, this is usually:

- Injectors hitting duty cycle ceiling
- Fuel pump pressure dropping under load
- Stock intake restriction (if manifold isn't yet upgraded)
- Stock exhaust restriction (if exhaust isn't yet upgraded)
- Cam phase not optimized for top-end

Fix: datalog injector duty and fuel pressure. Hardware gap or tune gap.

Pattern: "STFT/LTFT clean at cruise but lean at part-throttle acceleration"

Tip-in enrichment (transient fuel) is under-calibrated.

Fix: tuner dials in tip-in fuel table.

Pattern: "Knock count spikes at 6200 RPM on a hot day only"

IAT compensation insufficient -- timing not being pulled enough when intake temps climb.

Fix: IAT compensation table gets more aggressive at high IAT, OR I improve intake cooling (heat shield, true cold-air duct).

What I Share With Claude / My Tuner

For Claude (CSV export workflow)

From FlashProManager: **File -> Export Datalog -> CSV**.

The CSV contains one row per sample (~20 Hz), one column per logged parameter. Typical file: 10-minute drive = ~12,000 rows x ~30 columns = ~500KB plain text. Pasteable into chat in chunks, or attachable directly.

When I paste a log to Claude:

- Include the calibration name I was running
- Include what mods were on the car at time of log
- Specify what question I'm asking ("why did I see knock at WOT in 4th?" not "look at this log")
- Include a datalog range of interest if the log is long (e.g., "rows 8500-9200 is the WOT pull")

For my tuner

The tuner wants the raw .fpdl file -- he loads it in his own FlashProManager and sees everything native. I email / upload it. He sends back a new calibration .fpc file.

Red-Flag Quick Reference (One-Glance Checklist)

After any drive, I scan for these:

- [ ] Knock count = 0 everywhere (no exceptions)
- [ ] Knock retard correction stays above -1 deg (no active pulling)
- [ ] LTFT within ±5% at cruise
- [ ] Wideband AFR at WOT within 0.2 of target
- [ ] Injector duty < 85% at peak
- [ ] ECT < 215degF sustained
- [ ] VTC error < 2 deg sustained
- [ ] Battery voltage > 13.2V running
- [ ] No MIL codes thrown

Any NO above = investigate before the next hard pull.

See Also

- tuning-workflow-and-maps.md -- safety ceilings these analyses enforce
- calibrator-tables-reference.md -- the tables I'd edit based on these findings

- ../docs/baseline-logs.md -- the log session protocol (pre/post every mod)
- troubleshooting-and-faq.md -- CEL codes and common issues

Last updated: 2026-04-19

FlashPro Advanced Features -- Launch, Flat-Foot, Per-Gear, Torque Management

> The features that make FlashPro more than "just a fuel-and-timing reflash." What each does, when I'd use it, and the reliability-first settings for my 170k-mile K20Z3.

Verification note: Exact FPM menu names, parameter availability, and default values for the PRB calibration (06-11 Civic SI) change slightly between FPM software versions. Items flagged **[VERIFY]** I'll confirm against my current FPM version or with my tuner before enabling.

---

1. Launch Control (2-Step)

What It Does

Holds engine RPM at a user-set value while the car is stationary with clutch in. Releases immediately on clutch pedal release. Activation is gated on clutch switch, VSS (speed), and sometimes brake.

Typical Settings

Parameter	Value (my plan)
Activation: Clutch switch	Required (pressed)
Activation: VSS below	5 mph
Activation: Min TPS	90%+ (only engaged at WOT)
Activation: Min ECT	150degF (no cold-engine launches)
Launch RPM -- Daily map	Disabled entirely
Launch RPM -- Sport map	4500 RPM (conservative -- protects clutch/axles at 170k)

Why 4500 RPM, Not 5500

The K20Z3 makes meaningful torque below VTEC, so I don't need to pre-load VTEC to get off the line. Launching at 5500+ RPM with my stock engine mounts (before Hybrid Racing 70A mounts are in) and 170k-mile axles = grenading something on the drivetrain.

- Stock clutch (new Exedy Stage 1): rated ~280 WHP, so shock-loading at 5500 RPM is pushing it
- 170k-mile axles: inner CV joints are a known wear point; sudden high-torque engagement accelerates failure
- Stock or fresh engine mounts: high-RPM launches with soft mounts transfer more torque to the drivetrain than to the wheels

After my Phase 5 suspension work and axle refresh (if I ever do them), I could bump launch to 5000-5200. Not before.

How the RPM Is Held

The ECU uses one of two mechanisms:

- **Ignition cut:** ECU skips spark events to limit RPM. Preferred for street use -- softer, quieter.

- **Fuel cut:** ECU skips fuel injection. Harsher, louder, potentially lean transients.

My setting: Ignition cut. Fuel cut is what race cars use for the flamethrower effect; daily-drivable isn't worth the lean risk.

Ignition Retard During Launch

Some calibrations retard timing while launch control is active to reduce power to the wheels (so RPM stays at target without all the exhaust drama). **Stock retard: around -5 to -10 degrees during launch.** Leave alone.

When I Won't Use Launch Control

- Before engine mounts are upgraded
- Before clutch hydraulics are upgraded
- On public roads (outside tracked spaces, per the reliability-first rule)
- In the rain
- With a cold engine (below 150degF ECT)

2. Flat-Foot Shifting (No-Lift-Shift)

What It Does

Allows the driver to keep the throttle pinned during the upshift. The ECU detects the clutch depression and briefly cuts ignition (or fuel, or both) to prevent over-rev while the transmission is between gears. Throttle stays 100%, shift is cleaner.

The Trade-Off

Pros:

- Slightly faster upshifts (0.05-0.1 sec)
- No throttle lift = no intake vacuum spike = cleaner AFR during shift
- Flashier, more "race-y" feel

Cons:

- Shock-loads the drivetrain harder than a normal lift-shift
- Accelerates clutch wear
- At high RPM, the shock can damage transmission synchros on a 170k-mile gearbox
- Shift cut isn't free -- every cut is a fuel/spark interruption the engine doesn't love

My Decision

Disabled on both maps. My 170k-mile transmission doesn't need the abuse, and 0.1 seconds is meaningless on the street. Might revisit after a full clutch + trans refresh. Until then, traditional clutch-in/throttle-lift/shift/clutch-out is fine.

If I Ever Enable It

Parameter	Conservative setting
Activation	Clutch pressed + TPS > 80%

RPM threshold	> 5000 RPM (don't cut at low RPM)
Cut duration	100-200 ms max
Cut type	Ignition cut (not fuel cut)
Gear range	1->2, 2->3, 3->4 only (above 4th, normal shifts are fine)

3. Per-Gear Rev Limits

What It Does

FlashPro lets me set different fuel-cut RPMs per gear. Useful for protecting the drivetrain from over-rev scenarios.

What I'd Set

Gear	Rev Limit (Sport map)	Why
1st	8200 RPM	Prevent massive over-rev on a missed 1->2 shift
2nd	8400 RPM	Same, slightly more headroom
3rd	8400 RPM	Comfortable peak-power range
4th	8400 RPM	Same
5th	8400 RPM	Same
6th	8200 RPM	Highway cruise gear -- no reason to push past stock

Daily map: all gears at stock 8200 RPM.

The Hard Ceiling

I won't go above 8400 RPM on any gear on stock internals at 170k miles. Full stop. **[VERIFY]** the exact per-gear parameter location in FPM -- it may be under "Rev Limits" or "Advanced" depending on FPM version.

4. Torque Management Disable

What Honda's Stock Tune Does

During upshifts (especially 1->2 and 2->3), Honda's stock calibration pulls ignition timing by 5-15 degrees for 100-200 ms to "cushion" the shift. The result: a slight hesitation in the pull, often perceived as a dead spot around VTEC engagement during aggressive shifts.

What Disabling Does

Flattens the torque-reduction tables so timing stays commanded throughout the shift. The pull feels uninterrupted.

Community Consensus

Most Hondata tuners on K20 builds flatten these tables as part of a Sport tune. It's a well-understood modification with no reliability cost as long as:

- The clutch is healthy
- Rev limits are respected
- The shift isn't so violent it exceeds transmission torque capacity

My Plan

- **Daily map:** leave stock. Smoother commuting.
- **Sport map:** tuner flattens the torque management tables during Tune #1. Cleaner VTEC pulls through shifts.

I don't flatten these myself. They interact with ignition timing authority in subtle ways, and a dyno-verified flattening is safer than armchair editing.

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5. Shift Light / Shift Indicator

The Reality

The 8th gen Civic SI does NOT have a factory shift light on the gauge cluster. The tachometer needle is the "shift indicator" -- you watch the VTEC crossover and redline yourself.

What FPM Offers

FPM has a **software shift-light display** in the parameter monitor gauge view. A configurable RPM threshold triggers a visual alert (color change, flash, etc.) on the laptop/LattePanda screen.

[VERIFY] whether the original FlashPro has a **hardware digital output pin** that could drive an external LED shift light. I don't recall one. FlashPro 2 has more I/O. If I want a physical shift LED, I'd need an Arduino on the LattePanda reading RPM from the FPM datalog stream and driving the LED.

My Plan

- **Software shift light in FPM gauge view:** set to 7800 RPM (200 RPM before my 8200 rev limit, gives me a visual cue to upshift).
- **Physical LED:** possible future project via Arduino, not a priority.

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6. Rev Hang / Throttle Response

What Rev Hang Is

When I lift off the throttle, the stock calibration holds the throttle plate slightly open (for emissions purposes -- cleaner combustion during deceleration) before fully closing. Result: engine revs "hang" at the lift-off point for 0.3-0.8 seconds before decaying, making rev-matching on downshifts awkward.

The Fix

FPM has a setting to reduce or eliminate rev hang by closing the throttle plate more aggressively on lift-off. **[VERIFY exact parameter name]** -- commonly called something like "Lift-off throttle plate control" or "Deceleration throttle position."

My Plan

Daily map: minor reduction in rev hang (better driveability, still clean emissions). **Sport map:** aggressive reduction. Sharper throttle response, easier rev-matching.

Dyno tuner handles this during Session #1 or #2.

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7. Gear Detection Calibration

What It Does

The ECU calculates which gear you're in based on VSS ÷ RPM ratio. Per-gear features (rev limits, flat-foot, etc.) depend on this working correctly.

When It Needs Recalibration

- After changing tire size (e.g., going from 215/45R17 to 235/40R17 shifts ratios by ~2-3%)
- After changing final drive (axle ratio swap -- not planned for my build)
- If the ECU misidentifies a gear (FPM parameter monitor shows wrong gear under load)

How to Calibrate

FPM has a **gear-learning mode** where I drive in each gear at steady RPM and the ECU records the ratio. Alternative: manually enter known VSS/RPM values per gear in the calibration table.

My Plan

I'll let the ECU auto-learn after the first flash. Check gear detection in the parameter monitor during a test drive (drive in each gear, verify FPM displays the correct gear number). Recalibrate if I ever change tire sizes.

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8. Speed Limiter Removal

What Stock Does

The 8th gen SI has an electronic top-speed limiter (**[VERIFY]** approx 110-125 mph). Engages via fuel cut when VSS exceeds the threshold.

FPM Setting

"Remove Speed Limiter" checkbox or adjusting the limiter to 180+ mph (effectively removed). Common setting for any performance tune.

My Plan

Both maps: speed limiter off. I don't plan to drive at those speeds on public roads, but I don't want a fuel cut surprising me on a track day or open-road event.

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9. A/C Cut at WOT

What It Does

On WOT with A/C on, the ECU disengages the A/C compressor clutch. Recovers 3-8 HP that would otherwise be absorbed by compressor drag.

Stock Behavior

Already enabled on the stock calibration -- Honda does this by default. **Leave alone.**

[VERIFY] whether the stock threshold is adjustable (some calibrations let me change the TPS% that triggers A/C cut).

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10. Cooling Fan Tables

What It Does

Controls when the primary and secondary (A/C) cooling fans turn on and off based on ECT.

Stock Settings

- Primary fan ON: ~205degF
- Primary fan OFF: ~195degF
- Secondary fan: triggers with A/C or with high ECT

My Plan (with Koyorad radiator + Phase 0 coolant)

- **Daily map:** Fan ON 195degF, Fan OFF 185degF
- **Sport map:** Fan ON 190degF, Fan OFF 180degF

Tighter fan control keeps ECT stable during sustained load (canyon runs, dyno pulls). The Koyorad has extra heat rejection capacity; running the fan earlier uses that capacity proactively. See 16-Cooling-System/.

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11. CEL Defeat Flags

Rear O2 Sensor CEL (P0420 Cat Efficiency)

When I'd need this: If I ran a catless test pipe (not in my plan -- I have the Berk HFC).

My plan: Not needed.

IMRC (Intake Manifold Runner Control) CEL

When I'd need this: After installing the Skunk2 Ultra Street intake manifold, which deletes the stock IMRC flap. Without this defeat flag, I get a persistent P2004/P2005 code.

My plan: Tuner enables this flag during Tune #2 (post-intake manifold install). See 10-Intake-Manifold/.

EVAP System CELs

When I'd need this: Only if I physically removed the EVAP canister (race-only). Not in my plan.

My plan: Not needed.

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12. Closed-Loop Authority Limits

What They Are

The ECU's short-term and long-term fuel trims operate within a limited authority range -- they can add/subtract fuel up to ±25% from the calibration's target, but clamp beyond that.

When They Matter

If my injectors, MAF, or fuel pressure is significantly off, trims can peg at the limit. FPM has tunable limits:

- **STFT limit:** typically ±25%
- **LTFT limit:** typically ±20%

I don't touch these unless diagnosing a specific trim-pegging issue. Widening the limits masks the underlying problem.

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13. Features I Won't Touch

These exist but are either well-calibrated stock or too specialized for my build:

- **Boost control tables** (N/A on NA)
- **Wastegate duty** (N/A on NA)
- **Intercooler sprayer** (N/A on NA)
- **Map switching via clutch-pedal tap** (FlashPro 2 feature, not available on original unit)
- **TPS calibration** (only adjusted after a throttle body replacement or cleaning)
- **CAM sensor learning** (auto-learned by ECU; don't manually adjust)
- **Immobilizer settings** (never touch -- I'll brick the car)

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14. Summary -- My Advanced Feature Matrix

Feature	Daily Map	Sport Map
Launch control	Disabled	4500 RPM (post-mount upgrade)
Flat-foot shift	Disabled	Disabled (reliability call)
Per-gear rev limit	Stock 8200	8400 in 2-5, 8200 in 1 and 6
Torque management	Stock	Flattened (tuner)
Shift light	FPM gauge at 7800	FPM gauge at 7800
Rev hang reduction	Mild	Aggressive
Speed limiter	Removed	Removed
A/C WOT cut	Stock (enabled)	Stock (enabled)
Fan ON temp	195degF	190degF
Rear O2 defeat	No (have HFC)	No (have HFC)
IMRC defeat	Yes (after IM swap)	Yes (after IM swap)

See Also

- overview.md -- FlashPro hardware overview
- tuning-workflow-and-maps.md -- reliability-first rules these features operate under
- calibrator-tables-reference.md -- tables these features interact with
- datalog-analysis-guide.md -- verifying behavior after enabling features
- troubleshooting-and-faq.md -- issues related to these features

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Last updated: 2026-04-19

FlashPro Troubleshooting + FAQ

> When something goes wrong. When I see a code I don't recognize. When FPM won't connect. When a flash fails. My first-stop diagnostic guide.

Verification note: Claims marked **[VERIFY]** are from my accumulated knowledge (Jan 2026 cutoff) that I want to confirm against current Hondata KB articles or forum threads before acting. Everything else is high-confidence.

Connection and Software Issues

"FlashProManager doesn't see my FlashPro unit"

Most common cause: Windows replaced the FTDI driver during a Windows Update.

Fix:

1. Open Device Manager
2. Look under "Ports (COM & LPT)" for the FlashPro -- should appear as "USB Serial Port (COMx)"
3. If it's under "Other Devices" or showing a yellow warning icon, the driver needs fixing
4. Download the latest FTDI VCP driver from ftdichip.com/drivers/vcp-drivers/
5. Install, reboot, re-try FPM

"FlashPro enumerates but FPM says 'No communication with ECU'"

Check in order:

1. Ignition is ON (key in position II) -- not just ACC, and not off
2. OBD2 port is clean (no bent pins, no dirt)
3. FlashPro OBD2 connector is fully seated (push hard, it should click)
4. Battery voltage above 12.5V (charger or engine running is safest)
5. No other scantool is sharing the OBD2 port
6. Try another cable / USB port

"Flash failed mid-write"

Not a brick. The ECU holds its previous calibration. Symptoms: FlashPro shows error, FPM reports flash incomplete.

Recovery:

1. Reconnect FlashPro to OBD2 + USB
2. Launch FPM
3. FPM detects incomplete flash, offers to resume
4. Click Resume -- it picks up where it left off
5. Verify with Tools -> Read from ECU afterward

Prevention:

- Flash with engine running or battery charger
- Don't unplug anything during the flash
- Don't start/stop the engine during flash

- 20-45 seconds of patience

"FPM crashes when I open a .fpc file"

Causes:

- .fpc was created with a newer FPM version than I'm running -- update FPM
- File is corrupted -- re-download or re-request from tuner
- FPM installation is corrupted -- reinstall

"Firmware update failed"

Same recovery as flash failure -- reconnect, FPM detects and retries. If the unit seems completely unresponsive after multiple retries, contact Hondata support.

CEL / DTC Codes -- K20Z3 Specific

Codes That Matter vs Codes I'd Tune Out

Never tune out without understanding why the code is triggering. A CEL is information. Suppressing it without fixing the cause hides real problems.

Common Codes After Modifications

Code	Meaning	Likely Cause on Modded Car	Action
P0420	Catalyst efficiency below threshold	Aftermarket HFC flows faster than stock cat; rear O2 sees less cleanup	Verify HFC is actually functional (Berk HFC should pass). If test pipe/catless, rear O2 defeat flag in FPM
P0171	System too lean (Bank 1)	Vacuum leak, dirty MAF, weak fuel pump, wrong injector data	Don't tune out -- fix the fuel delivery issue
P0172	System too rich (Bank 1)	Stuck injector, fuel pressure too high, bad MAF	Don't tune out -- find the cause
P0300-P0304	Misfire (random or per-cylinder)	Bad coil, fouled plug, low compression, wrong timing	Diagnose, don't suppress
P0325	Knock sensor circuit	Sensor failure, wiring damage	Replace sensor; this code disables knock correction (dangerous)
P2004 / P2005	IMRC stuck open	Skunk2 Ultra Street deletes IMRC	Enable IMRC defeat flag in FPM
P0335	Crankshaft position sensor	Sensor failure, wiring, flywheel reluctor damage	Replace sensor; car won't run well
P0340	Camshaft position sensor	Sensor or wiring	Replace sensor
P0011 / P0014	VTC actuator / camshaft timing	Weak VTC actuator -- this is the 14310-RBC-003 revised part 15-Ignition-Refresh/ fixes	Replace actuator
P0128	Coolant temp below thermostat regulating temp	Stuck-open thermostat	Replace thermostat
P0116	Coolant temp sensor circuit range	Sensor failure	Replace sensor

P0135 / P0141	O2 sensor heater circuit	Sensor or wiring	Replace sensor
P0446	EVAP vent control circuit	Vent valve or wiring	Fix or (if race) defeat flag
P0505	Idle air control malfunction	IACV stuck or wiring	Clean IACV, replace if needed

Codes I Can Tune Out (Because the Hardware Change Justifies It)

- **P0420** after installing Berk HFC: only if rear O2 continues complaining despite functional HFC. **[VERIFY]** Berk HFC passes stock rear O2 threshold.
- **P2004/P2005** after Skunk2 Ultra Street install: IMRC is physically deleted, rear O2 flag should suppress.

Codes I Will NEVER Tune Out

- P0300-P0304 (misfire -- always a real issue)
- P0325 (knock sensor -- critical safety system)
- P0335/P0340 (crank/cam position -- car won't run safely)
- P0011/P0014 (VTC -- engine damage risk)
- P0171/P0172 (fuel trim extremes -- real problem upstream)

Rule: a CEL that doesn't have a known cause from a modification I did recently is a real problem. Investigate before suppressing.

Tuning / Datalog Issues

"I see knock count > 0 but I don't feel anything"

Knock you can't feel can still hurt the engine over time. On a 170k-mile motor, even isolated knock events are too many.

Process:

1. Open the datalog, filter for knock count > 0 rows
2. Note the RPM x load cells where it occurred
3. If it's a specific cell pattern: **pull 1-2 degrees timing at those cells** via FPM, re-flash, retest
4. If it's random/scattered: likely chassis noise (bad road, impact from pothole) -- document and monitor
5. If it's repeatable: real knock. Root cause: fuel quality, sensor health, timing too aggressive, insufficient cooling, or hardware problem

"Wideband reads 'error' or 'invalid'"

Possible causes:

- Sensor warmup incomplete (takes 30-60 seconds on cold start)
- Wiring issue (signal or power)
- Sensor is dying (2-3 year lifespan on E85 usage)
- AEM X-Series controller needs free-air calibration (annual, per AEM's instructions)

"Idle AFR is 12.0 instead of 14.7"

On a warm engine in closed loop, AFR should be right at 14.7.

Check:

- Is the engine fully warmed? (ECT > 180degF)
- Is FPM showing closed-loop flag = ON?
- Is the narrowband O2 sensor responding (voltage swings 0.1-0.9V)?
- Is there a vacuum leak (idle AFR can't lean out despite ECU commanding)?

"Car stumbles at 3500 RPM under light cruise"

Common 8th gen SI complaint. Usually a fuel table transition issue, sometimes VTEC transition hitch.

Process:

1. Datalog a cruise through 3500 RPM, gentle throttle
2. Look at AFR at the stumble point
3. Look at commanded vs actual timing
4. Look at VTC target vs actual
5. Send datalog to tuner -- usually a low-cam fuel table adjustment at that cell

"Car won't start after flashing a new calibration"

Check:

- Did the flash complete successfully? (Read back from ECU, compare to what I flashed)
- Are there any CELs?
- Is the base map correct for my hardware? (e.g., flashed an E85 map while running pump gas = won't run)
- Is the battery healthy?

Recovery:

- Flash the stock calibration back (STOCK_ORIGINAL_YYYYMMDD.fpc)
- Verify car starts normally on stock
- Then re-evaluate the new calibration

"Rough cold start after switching to E85"

Expected behavior. E85 has higher latent heat of vaporization and doesn't ignite as readily in cold weather.

Fix:

- Richer cranking fuel table (tuner adjustment)
- Longer after-start enrichment
- Winter blend E85 (lower ethanol percent, better cold start)
- Don't run straight E85 below 20degF ambient

Hardware Issues

"FlashPro USB connector is loose / wobbly"

USB Mini-B has a reputation for wearing out. If the connector is loose:

- Try a different Mini-B cable (cables wear too)

- If the connector on the FlashPro unit itself is worn, contact Hondata support for repair/replacement
- Long-term fix: permanent install (LattePanda build) where the cable isn't plugged/unplugged

"FlashPro shows a red/orange status LED"

[VERIFY] exact LED meanings from box quick-start card. Typical meanings:

- Red = error during operation
- Orange = waiting for user action (flash confirm, etc.)
- Green/white = normal operation

Calibration Issues

"My calibration makes less power than stock"

Possible causes:

- Wrong base map for my hardware
- Fuel tables too rich
- Timing too retarded
- VTEC engagement too high for mods

Fix: back to stock calibration, then load a known-good community base map for my specific mod combo, then dyno-verify.

"Fuel trims are pegged at +15% (running lean)"

ECU can't add enough fuel to hit target AFR.

Root causes:

- Vacuum leak (smoke-test intake)
- Dirty / failing MAF
- Clogged fuel filter
- Weak fuel pump
- Wrong injector data in calibration
- Injector clog (send for cleaning)

"Fuel trims are pegged at -15% (running rich)"

ECU can't subtract enough fuel.

Root causes:

- Leaky injector (stuck open, dripping)
- Fuel pressure too high
- MAF reading high
- Wrong injector scalar in calibration

FAQ -- Stuff I Googled More Than Once

"Can I flash multiple calibrations to the FlashPro unit at once?"

No. The original FlashPro stores one active calibration at a time. To switch daily ? sport, I open FPM and flash the other .fpc. Takes ~20-45 seconds per flash.

FlashPro 2 supports on-unit calibration switching via the mobile app. My original FlashPro does not.

"How often should I re-flash my tune?"

Never, unless:

- I changed hardware (adds, removes, upgrades)
- My tuner sends a revision
- I'm switching between daily and sport (frequent)

A calibration doesn't "wear out."

"Does Hondata charge per flash?"

No. I flash unlimited times after purchasing the FlashPro. The only ongoing cost is if I transfer the unit to a different ECU -- **$200 re-registration fee [VERIFY current price]**.

"Can I switch Daily ? Sport calibrations while driving?"

No. Flashing requires ignition ON + engine OFF (ideally) or engine idling. I can't flash with the car rolling.

Workaround for quick switching: park, clutch in, engine idling, open FPM on my phone (FlashPro 2) or laptop, flash, done. ~45 seconds.

"Can I read the VIN from my ECU?"

[VERIFY] -- FPM may display VIN during the read-ECU operation. The FlashPro pairs to ECU serial, not VIN, so this doesn't affect functionality.

"Do I need a tuner for my first flash?"

No. First flash can be a Hondata community base map matched to my hardware. I register the FlashPro, read my stock calibration for backup, then flash the base map. Takes an hour max.

I DO need a tuner for: any WOT calibration change, timing advance, VTEC engagement changes, flex fuel calibration.

"Can I datalog without FPM running?"

[VERIFY] -- the FlashPro has internal flash for short logs triggered by the unit's side button. These auto-save to internal memory and can be downloaded later when plugged into a PC. Useful for a "track day" recording without a laptop in the car.

"Will Hondata void my engine warranty?"

The 2009 Civic is well out of Honda's original warranty (3 year/36,000 mi basic). Not a concern for me at 170k miles.

For someone still in warranty: flashing the ECU and having the dealer detect it could void powertrain coverage. Reading the stock calibration and flashing it back before dealer visits is the common workaround (ECU looks

stock to Honda's tools).

"Does FlashPro work with my aftermarket gauge cluster?"

FlashPro talks to the ECU. Gauge clusters are separate. My OEM cluster will continue to work normally.

If I ever install an aftermarket digital dash (e.g., Haltech IC-7), it connects to the ECU via CAN bus and works in parallel with FlashPro -- no conflict.

"How much of my build requires a tuner vs DIY in FPM?"

DIY in FPM	Requires Tuner
First flash of community base map	Any WOT calibration change
Loading saved calibrations	Timing advance
Datalog setup + CSV export	VTEC engagement changes
Parameter monitor / gauge display	Flex fuel calibration
CEL defeat flags (IMRC after IM swap)	Closed-loop trim adjustments
Rev limiter adjustment (within spec)	Anything that touches the fuel or timing tables
Fan table adjustment	Idle recalibration after IM swap
Gear detection calibration	Cam phase (VTC) optimization
Speed limiter removal	Injector characterization data for new injectors

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Emergency Protocols

"Something sounds wrong -- what do I do?"

1. Pull over safely
2. Turn car off, don't start again
3. Connect FlashPro + laptop, read DTCs
4. Flash stock calibration back as a precaution (rules out tune issues)
5. Check oil, coolant, listen for mechanical noises
6. If anything obvious (no oil, overheating, leaking fluid): tow, don't drive
7. If nothing obvious and car starts/runs normally on stock: drive gently home, diagnose properly

"Car won't start at all after I flashed"

1. Try to start 3 times, 5 seconds crank each time, 10 seconds rest between
2. If no start: flash stock calibration back via FPM
3. If stock calibration also won't start: check for CELs, check fuel delivery, check spark
4. If flashing fails: contact Hondata support

"I think I damaged my engine from tuning"

1. Stop driving the car immediately
2. Pull a complete datalog from the most recent drive
3. Send logs + tune to my tuner

4. Do NOT attempt to "tune your way out" of a suspected mechanical issue
5. If the engine needs inspection, open it -- find-it-before-it-finds-you saves money

The reliability-first rule exists specifically to prevent this scenario.

Where to Get Help

Hondata-Official

- FPM Help menu -> Help Contents (built-in reference)
- hondata.com/support (**[VERIFY current URL]**)
- Hondata support ticket system (email)
- Hondata official forum (**[VERIFY URL]** -- historically at forum.hondata.com)

Community

- 8thcivic.com FlashPro subforum -- best 8th-gen-specific help
- r/CivicSi -- Reddit, casual
- k20a.org -- deeper K-series technical discussions
- BrenTuning YouTube -- datalog walkthroughs

My Tuner

- First call for anything tune-related
- Don't waste his time with driver issues or basic troubleshooting -- use the resources above first

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See Also

- overview.md -- FlashPro hardware basics
- hardware-software-deep-reference.md -- full hardware/software reference
- tuning-workflow-and-maps.md -- reliability-first rules
- datalog-analysis-guide.md -- how to read logs for diagnostics
- calibrator-tables-reference.md -- which tables to edit for which issue
- tuner-directory.md -- who to call

Last updated: 2026-04-19

Tuner Directory -- Who I'm Considering for My Three Dyno Sessions

> Shops I'd trust for a K20Z3 FlashPro tune on a 170k-mile FG2, plus what to look for, what to avoid, and how to vet any shop I didn't list. This is a starting point -- **I re-verify every shop's current status (website active, owner still there, reputation intact) before booking.**

Verification note: URLs, pricing, and shop statuses below are from my accumulated K-series community knowledge through Jan 2026. Shops open, close, and change owners regularly. Every entry should be treated as a **last-known-good starting point, not a live-verified 2026 directory.** Before sending money to anyone, I check the current 8thcivic.com dyno-results thread and search their recent forum mentions.

Tuner Selection Criteria -- What Matters

Non-Negotiable

1. **Returns my stock calibration backup on request.** If they won't save and hand back my OEM .fpc, walk away.
2. **Uses datalogs during the tune.** Not just dyno sheets -- actual parameter-level logs. This is the work product.
3. **Runs multiple baseline pulls before any changes.** If their first move is "let me advance some timing," find another shop.
4. **Documents what they changed.** I want a calibration-diff I can review.
5. **Has public dyno results on 8thcivic/Honda-Tech/YouTube.** Verifiable track record, not Instagram marketing.

Strongly Preferred

1. **Specializes in K-series / 8th gen Si specifically.** Shops that tune 50 platforms and barely see SIs will miss K20Z3-specific quirks.
2. **Writes detailed tune notes.** Not "dyno'd at 215 whp, see you next time."
3. **Honors the reliability-first rule.** Tuner agrees before the session that my 170k-mile motor gets safe AFR/timing, not max-possible AFR/timing.
4. **Hondata FlashPro native** -- they tune Hondata every week, not once a year.

Red Flags (Walk Away)

- Quotes a peak WHP guarantee before seeing the car
- Won't show me a recent datalog from another customer
- Pushes upsells (cams, turbo kit) before even doing the base tune
- Reviews on 8thcivic or r/CivicSi include the word "melted"
- No mention of knock count or AFR safety margins on their site
- Very cheap relative to others (~$200 when everyone else is $500)
- Won't tune my specific hardware combo ("we don't really work with Skunk2 alphas")

By Region -- Known Shops

West Coast (CA, OR, WA, NV)

Church Automotive Testing -- Wilmington, CA

[VERIFY current status and URL]

- **Owner:** Shawn Church
- **Dyno:** Dynapack hub dyno (highly repeatable, reads slightly lower than Dynojet but more consistent)
- **Specialization:** K-series, RSX, 8th gen Si, Honda/Acura in general. A K-series icon.
- **Reputation:** Meticulous, safety-first. Known to refuse to push a car past his own limits even when a customer asks. Reliability-first tuner by philosophy -- matches mine.
- **Typical cost per session:** $400-600 (**[VERIFY current pricing]**)
- **Booking lead time:** 4-8 weeks historically
- **Why consider:** If I'm anywhere near LA, this is probably my top pick.
- **Why skip:** Distance if I'm not on the West Coast.

SpeedFactory Racing -- Kent, WA

- **Dyno:** Dynojet
- **Specialization:** K-series builds, B-series, K-swaps. FG2 FlashPro work is routine.
- **Reputation:** Big YouTube presence, well-regarded nationally.
- **Typical cost:** $500-700 per session
- **Why consider:** PNW-accessible, lots of public FBO K20Z3 dyno content.

Others to verify in region

- **HARDmotion** (Atlanta-based but travels to West Coast events occasionally -- verify current presence)
- **Hasport Performance** (Arizona -- legendary for mounts/swaps, refers out for tuning)
- **4Piston Racing** (Indiana-based but remote-tunes West Coast clients)

Rocky Mountain / Southwest (AZ, CO, UT, TX)

Reckless Motorsports -- Phoenix, AZ [VERIFY]

- **Dyno:** Dynojet
- **Specialization:** K-series regulars
- **Typical cost:** $450-600

Texas (Dallas/Fort Worth / Houston / Austin)

Texas K-series scene is healthy but shops rotate frequently. **Search the current 8thcivic.com Texas Meetups thread or r/CivicSi for current go-to recommendations.** Historical shops have included:

- **K-Tuned / MD Automotive** (verify status)
- **Dezod Motorsports** (historical CA/TX presence -- verify 2026 status)

Midwest (IL, MI, OH, IN, MO, WI)

4Piston Racing -- Danville, IN

- **Specialization:** K-series engine builder (legit machine shop + tuning). Routinely posts K20Z3 FBO and built-engine dyno pulls.

- **Dyno:** In-house Dynojet
- **Reputation:** Top-tier, huge YouTube following, real engineering depth.
- **Typical cost:** $500-700 per session
- **Why consider:** If I'm willing to road-trip from anywhere midwest, this is the destination pick. Also does full engine builds if I ever go that route.

King Motorsports Unlimited -- Sussex, WI

- **Specialization:** Mugen North America distributor, K-series royalty. Deep OEM + aftermarket knowledge.
- **Dyno:** Dynojet
- **Typical cost:** Premium ($600+)
- **Booking:** Often booked far out
- **Why consider:** Absolutely top-shelf if budget allows and I want the name.
- **Why skip:** Pricing and availability vs competitors.

Other Midwest

- **PRL Motorsports** (Ohio -- more 10th gen/turbo focused, but has FlashPro capability)

Southeast (FL, GA, NC, TN)

HARDmotion -- Atlanta, GA

- **Tuner:** Anthony
- **Dyno:** Mustang dyno (reads slightly lower than Dynojet, usable tuning reference)
- **Specialization:** K-series including 8th gen Si. Huge YouTube presence covering K20Z3 tunes specifically.
- **Typical cost:** $450-600 per session
- **Why consider:** Top Southeast pick, public dyno results shop. Their videos are some of the best K20Z3 tuning content on the internet.

BrenTuning -- Massachusetts (covered under Northeast below)

Remote-tune specialist, works for Southeast clients routinely.

Northeast (NY, NJ, MA, PA, CT, VA, MD)

BrenTuning -- Tewksbury / Peabody area, MA [VERIFY]

- **Specialization:** National remote-tune kingpin for FlashPro. THE name in mail-in FlashPro tuning.
- **In-shop tuning:** Yes, Dynojet
- **Remote tuning:** Signature service. Workflow: I email/upload datalogs + car info + current calibration -> they send revised .fpc -> I flash, drive, log, send back -> iterate.
- **Typical cost (in-shop):** $450-650 per session
- **Typical cost (remote):** ~$350 first calibration, ~$100 revisions **[VERIFY current pricing]**
- **Reputation:** Hundreds of successful K20Z3 tunes, strong 8thcivic forum footprint, known methodology.
- **Why consider:** For remote tuning, effectively the community default. Strong recommendation for Tunes #1 and #2 on a budget.
- **Why be cautious:** Remote tuning requires discipline on my end (accurate datalogs, honest reporting of symptoms). Less hand-holding than an in-shop session.

PTuning -- Maryland / DC area [VERIFY status]

- Historical K-series reputation in the Mid-Atlantic. Verify current operating status before booking.

Others to verify

- **Circuit Motorsports** (NJ)
- **Evolved Injection / Delicious Tuning east coast partners** (occasional K work)

Remote-Only / Mail-In Specialists

BrenTuning (covered above) -- the default remote option.

Boutique / Instagram operators

Several small operators advertise remote FlashPro work on social media. **Vet heavily before sending money:**

- Search 8thcivic for their name -- look for recent customer reviews
- Ask for 3+ references (customer phone numbers/emails)
- Ask to see a sample datalog from their most recent tune
- Pay via credit card, not Zelle/Venmo (chargeback protection)

What Each Session Should Cost

Tune #1: Post-Exhaust (Headers + HFC + Cutout)

- Dual calibration (Daily quiet + Sport with cutout open)
- Pump gas only
- **Expected:** $400-600 in-shop, $300-450 remote
- **Session length:** 2-4 hours on dyno
- **What gets tuned:** fuel tables (low-cam + high-cam), ignition timing, VTEC engagement, rev hang, torque management flattening for Sport map

Tune #2: Post-Intake Manifold (Full Bolt-On Pump Gas)

- Dual calibration (Daily + Sport)
- Still pump gas
- **Expected:** $400-600 in-shop, $300-450 remote
- **Session length:** 2-4 hours
- **What gets tuned:** everything from Tune #1 refined, plus IACV recalibration (new IM), IMRC defeat flag, potentially VTC phase adjustments for Ultra Street manifold

Tune #3: Flex Fuel (Gas + E85 Dual-Fuel Interpolation)

- Dual calibration (Daily + Sport) x dual fuel (gas + E85 endpoints) = **4 effective tunes**
- **Expected:** $500-800 in-shop, $400-600 remote
- **Session length:** 4-6+ hours (flex fuel is the long day)
- **What gets tuned:** E85 endpoint fuel + timing tables, sensor calibration verification, cold-start enrichment, interpolation verification with gradual E-content changes

Combined Pricing?

Some shops offer a package across all three sessions for a ~10-15% discount. **I'm not interested** -- separation of hardware changes means clean attribution of gains. Combined sessions also make troubleshooting harder if something regresses between changes.

Dyno Type -- What to Expect

Dyno	Character	Typical K20Z3 FBO Reading
Dynojet (inertia roller)	Reads highest, most common for K-series bench-racing comparisons	210-225 WHP / 150-160 WTQ
Mustang (eddy-current load)	Reads 5-12 WHP lower than Dynojet on same car	200-215 WHP / 145-155 WTQ
Dynapack (hub dyno)	Best repeatability, slightly lower readings than Dynojet	200-215 WHP / 145-155 WTQ

Honest expectation for a well-tuned FBO K20Z3 in 2026: 210-225 WHP on a Dynojet. Anything above 240 WHP pump gas on stock internals is suspect or built.

E85 flex fuel adds 10-18 WHP typically. **Above 250 WHP pump, below 265 WHP E85 is the realistic envelope for NA FBO.**

My Three-Session Plan

Given my geography (**[NOT YET DECIDED -- TBD based on where I'm actually located]**) and my reliability-first rule:

- **Tune #1 (post-exhaust):** BrenTuning remote -- low risk session, BrenTuning has done this combo hundreds of times
- **Tune #2 (post-intake manifold):** BrenTuning remote again -- consistency with Tune #1's methodology
- **Tune #3 (flex fuel):** In-shop session, ideally Church Automotive or 4Piston or HARDmotion depending on geography. Flex fuel is complex enough that eyes-on-the-car is worth the travel.

Total tuning budget: $1,300-1,800 across all three sessions.

Questions to Ask Every Shop Before Booking

1. "Can you show me a recent datalog from a 06-11 Civic SI K20Z3 FBO tune?" (Verifies they actually tune these)
2. "Do you save and return the stock calibration to the customer?" (Non-negotiable)
3. "What's your approach when you see knock counts in a datalog?" (Answer should include 'pull timing immediately')
4. "What AFR target do you run for pump gas WOT on a 170k motor?" (Expect 11.8-12.2, not 12.5+)
5. "Do you offer separate daily + sport calibrations?" (Essential for my build)
6. "How do you handle flex fuel tuning?" (For Tune #3 specifically)
7. "Can I see your shop and dyno before booking?" (Weed out garage hack operations)
8. "What's your lead time?" (Tells me how busy and reputable they are)
9. "What's included in the price? Revisions? Follow-up datalog review?" (Clarifies scope)
10. "Can you refuse to push the car past safe limits even if I ask?" (The right answer is yes)

See Also

- overview.md -- FlashPro hardware basics

- tuning-workflow-and-maps.md -- the reliability-first rules any tuner I hire must agree to
- datalog-analysis-guide.md -- what I want the tuner to be looking at in their datalogs
- calibrator-tables-reference.md -- what tables the tuner will touch
- ../docs/baseline-logs.md -- my pre-session datalog protocol

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Last updated: 2026-04-19

Tuning Workflow, Daily/Sport Maps, and the Reliability-First Rule

The One Rule That Overrides Everything

> **Engine life and reliability come before power. Every time. No exceptions.**

I'd rather leave 10 WHP on the table than bend a valve or spin a bearing on a 170k-mile K20Z3. This rule applies to every calibration decision, every parts choice that feeds into tuning, and every "should I bump this one more degree?" moment on a dyno. Safety first, power second.

If a number on a dyno sheet costs me the engine, that number doesn't count.

Every Tune = Two Maps

Whenever I do a tune (base map flash, post-exhaust retune, post-intake-manifold retune, flex fuel), the output is **two calibrations, not one:**

Daily Map

- **Valve:** Cutout closed (quiet)
- **Timing:** Conservative -- 2-3 deg under max safe
- **AFR at WOT:** 12.0-12.2 on pump gas, lambda 0.80 on E85
- **VTEC crossover:** Stock-adjacent (~5400-5800 RPM)
- **Rev limiter:** Stock (8200 RPM fuel cut)
- **Launch control:** Off
- **Idle:** Smooth, OEM-feeling
- **Cold start:** Polished, no rough minute-one
- **Goal:** Drives like a new SI from the dealer. Quiet. Predictable. Nothing on the edge.

Sport Map

- **Valve:** Cutout open (loud)
- **Timing:** Max safe -- always verified with knock datalog at 0 counts AND wideband AFR at target
- **AFR at WOT:** 11.8-12.0 on pump gas, lambda 0.78-0.80 on E85 (slightly richer = cooler, safer)
- **VTEC crossover:** Lowered to 4800-5200 RPM (only after the exhaust flows enough to justify it)
- **Rev limiter:** +100 to +200 RPM over stock (8300-8400), not more
- **Launch control:** Optional, conservative (4500 RPM, no 2-step aggression)
- **Idle:** Tolerable. Slight lope allowed from lower VTEC crossover, nothing more.
- **Goal:** Squeezes the engine for everything it's got, WITHIN THE RELIABILITY ENVELOPE. Not "let's see what happens." Not "maybe push it one more click." Verified safe, every parameter.

What "Sport = max" actually means:

Sport is NOT "remove safety margins." It IS "stop leaving free power on the table." Free power lives in:

- Timing advance that the engine can take without knock, proven by datalog
- Fuel enrichment that's cooler and safer than what a stock conservative tune runs

- VTEC crossover dropped to where the exhaust/intake combo actually supports it
- Fan tables dialed tight so heat soak doesn't force defensive retune

Every one of these is a gain measured against a conservative baseline, not against the engine's destruction point.

The Three Tune Sessions Plan

Session	After Installing	Both Maps Tune	Budget
Tune #1	Exhaust (cutout + headers + HFC)	Daily + Sport on pump gas, no intake mfld yet	$300-500
Tune #2	Intake manifold + bored TB	Daily + Sport on pump gas -- FULL BOLT-ON pump final	$300-500
Tune #3	Flex fuel system (sensor + injectors + pump)	Daily + Sport with gas?E85 real-time interpolation	$400-600

Never combine sessions. Each tune session isolates one set of hardware changes so I can attribute gains (or regressions) cleanly. Combining intake + flex fuel + exhaust retune in one dyno day = four hours of the tuner guessing which mod caused what.

Cross-reference: Each session maps to a datalog milestone in docs/baseline-logs.md. Pre-session logs + post-session logs + dyno graph = complete paper trail.

Pre-Session Checklist (Runs Before Every Dyno Day)

Hardware Health

Any NO answer below = reschedule. Tuning a sick engine is throwing money away.

- [ ] Spark plugs fresh (< 5,000 mi on current set)
- [ ] Ignition coils healthy (no misfire codes in 500 mi)
- [ ] VTC actuator replaced or confirmed silent at cold start (see 15-Ignition-Refresh/)
- [ ] Valve adjustment in spec (within last 60k mi)
- [ ] Timing chain inspected (measured via FlashPro cam phase datalog, < 2-3 deg retardation)
- [ ] Coolant system fresh (see 16-Cooling-System/)
- [ ] Oil fresh, correct viscosity (5W-30 for my 170k motor)
- [ ] Fuel filter clean (replaced post-E85 introduction if applicable)
- [ ] Battery healthy (13.8+V at idle with alternator charging)
- [ ] Wideband O2 sensor installed and reading sensibly at idle (see 17-Wideband-AFR/)

Software / Calibration

- [ ] **Stock calibration saved as backup** (the factory reset button)
- [ ] Previous dyno's final calibration saved to a known filename (for rollback)
- [ ] FlashProManager on current version
- [ ] All FlashPro firmware updates applied (test flash at home before dyno day)
- [ ] My log set from the last baseline session is reviewed -- no ignored knock events, no drifting trims

Session Plan

- [ ] Tuner knows both calibrations are needed (daily + sport)

- [ ] Tuner has the datalog files from previous session
- [ ] Tank is HALF FULL of the target fuel (not empty, not full -- stable fuel pressure matters)
- [ ] If running E85: verified station I filled at, and flex fuel sensor is reporting sensible %

The Safety Ceilings I Won't Cross

These are bright lines. Below any of them, no tune ships.

Parameter	Safe Ceiling	Reliability Margin
Knock count at WOT	0 (strictly zero)	Ever. If I see any count, timing gets pulled immediately.
Pump gas WOT AFR	Never leaner than 12.0	Cool-running richness is free reliability.
E85 WOT lambda	Never leaner than 0.82	E85 forgives rich, punishes lean.
Peak cylinder temp proxy (IAT + ignition advance)	Stay well under OEM map's hot cells	Datalog ECT + IAT + timing. Retreat at 220F ECT.
Injector duty cycle	Never above 85% sustained	If I hit 85%, upsize injectors -- never compensate with raised fuel pressure.
Rev limiter	+200 RPM over stock, max	The factory 8200 is already conservative by design. Moving it further is pure risk.
VTEC engagement RPM	Never below 4500	Below this, the cam profile doesn't make sense for the airflow.
Fuel pressure at WOT	Within 2 PSI of base spec	Pressure drop = lean spike. Hard fail condition.
Coolant temp sustained	Target <= 200F at cruise, <= 210F at WOT	Above this, fan tables need work, not tune changes.

If any of these get crossed mid-session, the session stops. Fix the cause, come back another day.

How Each Mod Affects The Tune

Mod	Affects Fuel?	Affects Timing?	Affects VTEC?	Retune Required?
K&N intake (installed)	Yes -- more air -> leaner baseline	Slight -- can advance a hair	Slight -- crossover could drop	Base map only, no dyno
Clutch + flywheel (installed)	No	No	No	None -- pure mechanical
Shifter + bushings (installed)	No	No	No	None
Engine mounts	No	No	No	None (maybe idle AFR hair off until ECU adapts -- stock tune self-corrects)
Brakes	No	No	No	None
Strut bar	No	No	No	None
Headers + HFC	YES -- major	YES -- significant	YES -- crossover drop opportunity	Dyno required
Valved exhaust cutout	Yes -- AFR shifts valve open vs closed	Minor	No	Dyno -- tune both valve states

Intake manifold + bored TB	YES -- major	YES -- significant	YES -- crossover drop opportunity	Dyno required
Pulleys + damper	No	No	No	None (mechanical -- slight ECU idle relearn)
Flex fuel system	YES -- total recalibration	YES -- interpolated	Optional	Dyno required, long session
Clutch hydraulics	No	No	No	None
Suspension / brakes	No	No	No	None
LattePanda install	No	No	No	None -- just monitoring

Tune-required mods get grouped into dyno sessions. Tune-unaffected mods get installed whenever -- they don't drive the calendar.

What "Sport Map" Looks Like Per Phase

As the hardware progresses, the Sport map gets more aggressive -- but always within the reliability ceilings above.

Phase	Hardware	Sport Map Character
Now (intake only)	K&N, no cat/exhaust mods	Community base map, no sport/daily split yet -- just "don't break anything"
Post-exhaust	Cutout + headers + HFC	First real Sport map: +1-2 deg timing, AFR 11.9, VTEC at 5200
Post-intake mfld	FBO complete	Refined Sport: +2-3 deg over stock, VTEC at 4900-5000, rev to 8300
Post-flex fuel	Gas + E85 dual	E85 Sport: lambda 0.79, +4-5 deg over stock, VTEC at 4800, rev to 8400

None of these exceed the safety ceilings. Each phase has more to work with because the hardware lets the engine breathe better -- not because I'm pushing it harder into the red.

Working With Claude On Tune Changes (Eventually)

Right now I can't directly give Claude live ECU access -- FlashProManager is Windows-only and hardware-paired. What I can do:

The CSV Export Workflow

1. Drive with FlashPro datalogging on.
2. Back at my PC, open FlashProManager -> File -> Export Datalog -> CSV.
3. Paste the CSV content into a chat with Claude (or attach the file).
4. Claude analyzes -- flags outliers, identifies unsafe cells, proposes specific table edits.
5. I open the corresponding fuel/timing/cam table in FlashProManager.
6. I type the proposed values into specific cells (or reject them if the reasoning is off).
7. Save calibration, flash, verify.
8. Log again, repeat.

What Claude CAN Do

- Read my CSV datalog and flag knock events, lean AFR, trim drift, over-temp cells

- Compare two sessions (before/after) and quantify what changed
- Propose conservative timing/fuel adjustments with specific cell addresses
- Spot patterns I'd miss (e.g., a specific load cell that's consistently lean-biased)
- Talk me through which cells a given mod should affect most

What Claude CANNOT Do

- Flash my ECU (no hardware access)
- Read my .fpc or .fpdl binary files directly (I need to export to CSV/text)
- Replace a professional tuner for dyno-verified timing advances
- Know what my engine "sounds like" or respond to physical feedback
- Make safety calls that override the ceilings above -- even at my explicit request

What I Share With Claude Per Session

- Datalog CSV (or excerpt of relevant cells)
- Screenshot of the fuel, timing, VTEC, or cam phase table I'm considering editing
- My current calibration name and any notes from my tuner
- What I'm trying to accomplish (e.g., "smooth out the transition from closed to open loop at 3500 RPM")

The Future: LattePanda as Live Tune Companion

Once the LattePanda 3 Delta is installed, the workflow gets tighter. The LattePanda runs FlashProManager natively -- so it can be logging continuously, and the wideband O2 signal is coming in on an analog input that the same machine reads. A lightweight Python script can:

- Auto-export datalogs after each drive to a dedicated folder
- Compute simple alerts ("today you had 3 knock events above 6500 RPM in cells X, Y, Z -- investigate")
- Sync logs to cloud storage so I can paste them to Claude from any device

But this is a Phase 7+ project. The core workflow (drive -> export CSV -> analyze -> edit -> flash) works fine on a laptop at home today.

See Also

- overview.md -- the FlashPro hardware + my temporary/permanent setup paths
- Temporary-Setup/getting-started.md -- getting online with a laptop first
- Permanent-LattePanda-Install/full-guide.md -- in-car PC install
- ../docs/baseline-logs.md -- my datalog protocol
- ../17-Wideband-AFR/ -- the wideband this workflow relies on

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Last updated: 2026-04-18

Valved Exhaust -- My DIY 3" QTP Cutout Bypass

Status: Planned (Not Yet Purchased)

The Idea

I want to keep my OEM resonator and muffler for quiet daily driving, but have a valve-controlled bypass that dumps exhaust before the resonator/muffler -- basically a straight-pipe experience at the flip of a switch. A relay controls the valve, tied to my Hondata FlashPro calibration selection (daily = closed/quiet, sport = open/loud).

No bolt-on valved exhaust exists for the 8th gen Civic SI. I looked everywhere. This has to be a DIY build using universal components, which honestly is fine -- gives me more control over the design.

My Design

Exhaust Path (Updated: 3" Dump with Step-Down)

```
4-1 Header -> High-Flow Cat -> 3" Pipe -+-> [QTP QTEC30 CUTOUT] -> 3" Dump Pipe -> Exit Tip
                                        |
                                        \-> [3" to 2.5" Reducer Cone]
                                                    |
                                            2.5" Pipe -> Resonator -> Rear Muffler -> Stock Tailpipe
```

How It Works

- **Valve CLOSED (Daily):** Cutout butterfly is shut. 100% of exhaust flows through the reducer cone, down to 2.5", through the resonator and muffler. Quiet, stock-like.
- **Valve OPEN (Sport):** Cutout butterfly opens. Exhaust takes the path of least resistance -- dumps out the 3" straight pipe. Bypasses resonator and muffler completely. Very loud.
- **Catalytic converter stays in the flow path at all times** (emissions legal)

Pipe Diameter Strategy

Section	Diameter	Reason
Header collector to cutout	3"	Maximum flow for sport mode. Matches 4-1 header collector output.
Sport dump pipe (cutout to exit)	3"	Full flow, no restriction when valve is open
Daily path (cutout to resonator)	3" -> 2.5" reducer	Steps down to match resonator/muffler inlet size
Resonator -> muffler -> tailpipe	2.5" / stock	Retains stock components, no modification needed

Why I'm going 3" on the dump side:

- My 4-1 header collector outputs at 2.5-3". Carrying 3" to the dump maximizes flow for the sport path.
- On an NA K20Z3 at 220-240 WHP, 3" won't hurt low-end torque (common myth). Exhaust gas velocity matters less than minimizing restriction at this power level.
- 3" sounds deeper and more refined than 2.5" when the valve is open
- Gives me headroom if I ever go forced induction

Why I'm stepping down to 2.5" for the muffled path:

- The stock resonator and muffler inlets are ~2-2.5". You can't feed 3" into them.

- A gradual reducer cone (3" to 2.5", ~6" long) creates a smooth transition with minimal turbulence
- The muffled path doesn't need maximum flow -- it's the quiet mode

Note: The FG2 SI has ONE resonator (small canister, ~under rear seats) and ONE rear muffler (large canister, under trunk) -- NOT two mufflers.

The Valve I'm Going With

QTP QTEC30 -- 3" Electric Exhaust Cutout (~$240-260)

- Stainless steel butterfly valve, 12V DC gear motor
- **3" bore** (upgraded from the originally planned 2.5" QTEC25)
- Motor mounts on a bracket away from the hottest pipe area
- Opens/closes in 2-3 seconds
- Proven product, thousands of installs -- this is the move

QTP Cutout Positioning

I'll place the cutout **after the high-flow cat, before the resonator**, with at least 14" between the header collector and the cutout (QTP's thermal recommendation for motor protection).

Control Methods

1. **Phase 1:** Simple DPDT toggle switch on the dash ($5)
2. **Phase 2:** LattePanda Arduino GPIO -> relay -> QTP motor (tied to tune selection)
3. **Manual override toggle retained** for Phase 2 (works even with PC off)

Parts List with Buy Links

#	Item	Product	Price	Link
1	Electric Cutout Valve	QTP QTEC30 (3")	~$217-269	Summit Racing -- $217
				Amazon
				QTP Direct
				Real Street Performance -- $232
2	3" Stainless Pipe	Mandrel-bent sections for dump pipe	~$40	Muffler shop / Amazon
3	3" to 2.5" Reducer	Stainless reducer cone (~6" long)	~$20	Muffler shop / Amazon
4	2.5" Adapter Pipe	Connect reducer to stock resonator inlet	~$15	Muffler shop
5	3" Exhaust Tip	Stainless rolled tip for dump exit	~$30	Amazon / Summit Racing
6	Gaskets & Clamps	3" and 2.5" band clamps, gaskets	~$25	Amazon / Summit Racing
7	Exhaust Hangers	Rubber hangers + brackets	~$15	Amazon / AutoZone
8	Wiring & Control	Toggle switch, high-temp wire, connectors	~$50	Amazon
9	Heat Protection	DEI fire sleeve, silicone tape	~$40	Amazon / Summit Racing
	Total		~$452-504	
	Muffler shop labor (if not welding)		$150-250	

See Also

- brainstorm.md -- Full research, alternatives I looked at, valve options, heat/waterproofing
- purchasing.md -- Original detailed parts list (to be updated for 3" spec)

Last updated: 2026-04-16

Headers -- I'm Going with the Skunk2 Alpha 4-2-1

Status: Research Complete, Not Yet Purchased

My Pick

Skunk2 Alpha 4-2-1 Header with Stepped Primaries -- after a ton of research, this is honestly the best-performing header you can actually buy for the FG2.

Field	Value
Part Number	412-05-1930 (FG2 Coupe)
Design	4-2-1 with stepped primaries (1.625" -> 1.75")
Material	304 stainless steel, TIG-welded
Collector Outlet	2.5"
Cat Included	No -- I'll pair it with a Berk Technology HFC
Header Price	~$700-800
Total (header + HFC)	~$1,000-1,200
Availability	In production, readily available from authorized retailers

Buy Links

#	Item	Product	Price	Link
1	Header	Skunk2 Alpha 412-05-1930	~$700-800	Hybrid Racing
				HARDmotion
				JHPUSA
				Skunk2 Direct
				King Motorsports
2	High-Flow Cat	Berk Technology HFC (BT1101-HFC-MET)	~$300-400	Berk Technology (direct)
				Vivid Racing
				Ballade Sports
				Speed Freaks USA
	Total		~$1,000-1,200	

Why I Chose the Skunk2 Alpha

Stepped Primaries -- The Key Differentiator

The Alpha's **1.625" to 1.75" stepped primary tubes** (dimensions are community-reported from dyno and fitment data -- Skunk2 doesn't officially publish primary tube dimensions) are what separate it from every other header on the market:

- Starts narrow -> maintains exhaust gas velocity at low-mid RPM (keeps scavenging strong)
- Opens up -> flows more volume at high RPM when the engine pushes more exhaust

- PLM and DC Sports use constant 1.625" primaries -- this design difference accounts for the 5-8 WHP gap

Every Header for the FG2, Ranked

Header	Design	Peak WHP Gain	Price	Available?	My Verdict
Skunk2 Alpha	4-2-1 stepped	10-18	$700-800	Yes	This is the one
PLM Tri-Y V2	4-2-1 constant	8-13	$350-500	Inconsistent	Budget alternative
DC Sports	4-2-1 constant	8-12	$400-550	Yes	Decent mid-tier
Hytech 4-1	4-1 merge collector	12-20	N/A	No (defunct ~2014)	Unobtainable
Megan Racing	4-2-1	6-10	$250-350	Intermittent	Not recommended
OBX	4-2-1	5-8	$150-250	Yes	Avoid

No JDM brands (Spoon, Toda, Mugen, J's Racing) ever made a header for the 8th gen SI. **No reputable 4-1 header** exists for the FG2 in 2025-2026.

Why I'm NOT Going 4-1 (For This Build)

I did a deep dive on 4-1 vs 4-2-1 (see 4-1-header-research.md). Here's what I concluded:

A properly designed 4-1 with merge collector would make **2-5 more peak WHP above 7000 RPM** but **lose 3-8 lb-ft of torque from 3000-5500 RPM.**

For my build specifically:

- My **Skunk2 Ultra Street manifold** already provides excellent top-end airflow. A 4-1's top-end advantage is diminished when paired with a manifold that already breathes well up top.
- My **3" valved exhaust** eliminates downstream backpressure. The 4-2-1's slight flow disadvantage at peak RPM is negated.
- I spend far more time in the **3000-6000 RPM** range than at 8000+ RPM. Area under the curve > peak numbers.
- Professional K-series tuners overwhelmingly recommend the Alpha for full bolt-on street builds.
- The 4-1 only becomes the right choice with race cams, ported heads, and a build that lives above 6500 RPM. That's not my car.

Synergy with My Build

The Skunk2 Alpha + Skunk2 Ultra Street intake manifold are complementary:

- Ultra Street's medium-length runners build mid-range torque
- Alpha's stepped primaries maintain exhaust velocity across the same RPM range
- Together: **broad, fat torque curve from 3000-8000 RPM** with strong pull to redline
- Most commonly tuned header on the 8th gen SI -- my Hondata tuner will have extensive experience with this exact combo

Full Bolt-On Power Expectations

Configuration	WHP (Dynojet)	WTQ (Dynojet)
Stock baseline	175-185	130-138

Current (intake only, no tune)	178-188	132-140
Full bolt-on + Hondata tune	220-235	160-170

To push beyond 240 WHP I'd need aftermarket cams (Skunk2 Stage 2), race fuel, or both. Not in the plans right now.

Catalytic Converter Pairing

Cat	Type	Price	Notes
Berk Technology HFC	200-cell high-flow, bolt-on	~$300-400	Most popular pairing, retains emissions legality
PLM High-Flow Cat	200-cell, bolt-on	~$150-250	Budget option
Test pipe (catless)	Straight pipe	~$50-100	Off-road only. Not street legal. Requires Hondata CEL fix.

I'm going with the Berk. Most popular pairing with the Alpha for a reason -- it just works.

Stock Exhaust Clarification

The FG2 SI has **one resonator and one muffler** -- NOT two mufflers. The resonator is a small canister welded into the mid-pipe (~under rear seats). The rear muffler is the large canister under the trunk.

My Install Order

Headers go in AFTER the valved exhaust cutout is working and tuned.

1. Install QTP cutout, get both tunes working (valve open and closed)
2. Install Skunk2 Alpha header + Berk HFC
3. Retune both Hondata calibrations on dyno (strongly recommended)
4. Verify AFR in both valve positions with new headers
5. Re-torque all connections after 100 miles of heat cycling

Installation Notes (170k Miles)

At 170k, I'm expecting seized studs. Here's my plan:

- **PB Blaster the manifold studs 3-5 days before install** -- heat cycle + spray daily
- Use double-nut method for stud removal, NEVER vise grips
- Have new M10x1.25 stainless studs and copper-plated flange nuts ready
- Budget 6-10 hours DIY or 3-5 hours professional
- **I'm leaning toward professional install** due to seized stud risk ($300-500 labor). If a stud snaps and I don't have the tools to deal with it, it becomes a much bigger problem.
- May need to lower subframe ~1" for clearance during manifold removal

See Also

- brainstorm.md -- Full exhaust system research, stock layout, pipe diameters, all headers compared, sound character
- 4-1-header-research.md -- Deep dive on 4-1 merge collector design, scavenging theory, Hytech analysis, 4-1

vs 4-2-1 trade-offs

- Future: purchasing.md -- Complete parts list (at purchase time)
- Future: install-guide.md -- Step-by-step instructions

Last updated: 2026-04-16

Header Install Guide -- Skunk2 Alpha + Berk HFC

Status: Planning -- install deferred until exhaust cutout working and tuned

Reality Check Before I Start

This is the single scariest job on my entire build. It's not the technical difficulty -- the actual swap is intermediate-level wrenching. It's the **170k miles of seized exhaust manifold studs**. If I snap one and can't extract it, I go from "weekend job" to "head off the engine and machine shop visit." I'm doing 3-5 days of prep work specifically to avoid that outcome.

I'm strongly considering paying a shop the $300-500 for this one. The ROI on shop labor is: if they snap a stud, THEY own drilling and extracting it. If I snap a stud DIY, I own it. A Honda specialist shop has seen this a thousand times and has the tools.

Decision point before I start: I get my final quote from a Honda specialist shop (one that's done Skunk2 Alpha installs on 06-11 SIs). If under $500 and they have good reviews for header work specifically, I hire it out. If not, DIY and I accept the risk.

Prerequisites -- Don't Skip

Cross-references -- things that need to be done FIRST or AT THE SAME TIME

Do First	Why
Phase 0 maintenance complete	Clean engine baseline means if something goes wrong after install, it's header-related not some other lurking issue
Valved exhaust (QTP cutout) installed and working	Cutout position changes based on header/HFC flow; installing headers first locks me into a downstream geometry I may regret
Wideband AFR bung welded into header collector	Do this at the muffler shop DURING the header installation. Retrofitting a bung into an installed header is a pain.
Cooling system refresh	Headers add heat. I want fresh cooling headroom before this goes in.
PB Blaster on manifold studs -- 3-5 days ahead	Seized-stud prevention, starting well before install day

Do AT THE SAME TIME (car is already apart)

Also Do	Why
Replace upstream O2 sensor	New sensor is ~$100 OEM Denso. Old sensor threads will unscrew with the manifold. Anti-seize new threads.
Replace cat-to-B-pipe donut gasket	It's going to get disturbed anyway.
Apply ceramic coating or thermal wrap to header	Skunk2 Alpha runs HOT in the FG2 bay; protects alternator harness over time (community-reported issue). Jet-Hot or Swain coatings are ~$200-350. DEI titanium wrap is ~$50 as an alternative.

Timeline

Day ?5 through Day ?1: PB Blaster Prep

Day	Action
?5	Apply PB Blaster or Seafoam Deep Creep to all 8 manifold studs from engine-bay side. Let soak overnight.
?4	Start engine, warm to full temp. Shut off. Apply more penetrant while hot (thermal cycling breaks corrosion bonds). Let cool overnight.
?3	Daily cycle: penetrant -> heat -> penetrant -> cool
?2	Same
?1	One more application. Remove heat shield bolts (they seize too) -- spray those too.
Day 0	One final spray 30 min before starting.

Have extra PB Blaster on hand. Not expensive, not worth being caught short.

Day 0: Install

Total Time Budget

- **DIY (first-timer on high-mileage car):** 8-10 hours -- plan a full Saturday, nothing else that day
- **DIY (experienced, no seized studs):** 4-6 hours
- **Shop (Honda specialist):** 3-5 hours

Tools Required

Critical:

- Torque wrench (1/2" drive, 30-150 ft-lb range)
- 14mm, 17mm, 19mm sockets + matching wrenches
- **O2 sensor socket** (22mm, with wire slot) -- $10 at AutoZone, worth owning
- **Breaker bar** (18"+) -- for the manifold-to-head nuts
- Stud extractor set -- Irwin Hanson Bolt-Grip set -- for if (when) a stud breaks
- **Double-nut setup** (2x M10x1.25 nuts) -- standard stud removal technique
- Penetrating oil (PB Blaster + Seafoam Deep Creep, both)
- Jack + 4-ton jack stands -- subframe may need to drop
- Mechanic's creeper + a good droplight or headlamp

Also useful:

- Inspection mirror + flashlight
- Parts magnet
- Drip pan (coolant may come out if thermostat housing is disturbed)
- Sharpie for marking bolt positions before removal

Parts List (Everything I Should Have Before Starting)

#	Item	Source	Status
1	Skunk2 Alpha header 412-05-1930	Hybrid Racing / HARDmotion / JHPUSA	--

2	Berk Technology HFC BT1101-HFC-MET	Berk direct / Ballade Sports	--
3	Exhaust manifold gasket, OEM 18115-RRB-A01	Honda dealer only -- aftermarket blows	--
4	ARP exhaust manifold stud kit 208-4301	Summit Racing	--
5	Copper-plated flange nuts M10x1.25 (8x)	ARP 200-8321 or equivalent	--
6	Donut gasket, cat-to-B-pipe	O'Reilly, AutoZone	--
7	Fresh upstream O2 sensor (Denso 234-9049)	RockAuto	--
8	O2 sensor anti-seize (Permatex, NOT copper)	AutoZone	--
9	Copper anti-seize (exhaust threads)	AutoZone	--
10	Skunk2 O2 extender wire	K Series Parts	--
11	Heat protection for header (wrap OR ceramic coating)	DEI / Jet-Hot	--

Step-by-Step

Phase A: Lift and Access (30-45 min)

1. Let engine fully cool (overnight if possible).
2. Disconnect battery (-) terminal. Exhaust work near alternator wiring = bad surprises without disconnection.
3. Lift front of car, set on 4-ton jack stands on subframe pinch welds. NEVER work under a jack alone.
4. Remove driver-side front wheel and wheel well liner for access.
5. Remove engine-bay strut brace (if mine ends up fitting post-coilovers, not relevant until then -- see 06-Strut-Bar/).
6. Remove the heat shield over the stock manifold (4-6 bolts, they're seized, more PB Blaster).

Phase B: Disconnect Upstream O2 (10 min)

7. Unclip the upstream O2 sensor connector from the harness (up by the ECU side of the bay).
8. Using the O2 socket, break the sensor loose -- if it spins, great. If not, more penetrant and come back in an hour.
9. Unscrew fully, set aside. I'll install the NEW O2 in the new header.

Phase C: Disconnect Cat from Stock Manifold (15-20 min)

10. Under the car, find the 2 spring-loaded bolts connecting stock manifold to the cat inlet flange.
11. Penetrant, then compress and unbolt. The springs go flying if I'm not careful -- hold a rag over them.
12. Set the cat hanging on its own brackets/rear bolts (don't disconnect the cat-to-B-pipe flange yet unless needed for clearance).

Phase D: Remove Stock Manifold -- The Scary Part (30-90 min, depending on studs)

13. **Inspect each of the 8 manifold-to-head nuts.** Penetrant one more time. Let sit 10 minutes.
14. Start with the EASIEST-looking nut (typically a middle one, more protected from heat cycling).
15. Work SLOWLY. Back and forth -- loosen 1/8 turn, tighten 1/16, loosen 1/4, tighten 1/8. This walks the corrosion out without shearing the stud. PATIENCE.
16. If any nut feels like it's stripping or the stud is turning out with the nut -- STOP. Apply more penetrant. Try heating the nut with a small butane torch (careful of nearby plastic/wiring).

17. Repeat for all 8. If a stud breaks: STOP. Move to extraction procedure (below).
18. Once all 8 nuts are off, wiggle manifold free. It may need to be flipped to come out past the cat converter area.

Phase E: Install New Studs + Prep Head Surface (20-30 min)

19. **If using ARP studs:** remove any remaining stock stud stubs with the double-nut technique. Then install ARP studs per ARP's thread-prep instructions.
20. Scrape old gasket material off the head mating surface. A plastic razor is safer than metal. Do not gouge the aluminum head.
21. Clean surface with brake cleaner + lint-free cloth.
22. Check head mating surface for flatness with a straight edge -- if warped, this is a much bigger job. Expected outcome: flat.

Phase F: Install Skunk2 Alpha (30-45 min)

23. Place new OEM 18115-RRB-A01 gasket over the studs, making sure orientation is correct (the intake/exhaust port shapes are asymmetric).
24. Lift Skunk2 Alpha into position -- heavy and awkward. A second pair of hands helps; otherwise, a floor jack with a 2x4 block supports from below.
25. Thread all 8 copper-plated nuts hand-tight first. All 8 before torquing.
26. Torque in 3 passes, star pattern:
    - Pass 1: 10 ft-lb
    - Pass 2: 18 ft-lb
    - Pass 3: **23 ft-lb (final spec)**
27. Install Skunk2 O2 extender wire, then the fresh Denso O2 sensor with anti-seize on threads only (NOT on the sensor element).
28. Torque O2 sensor to 33 ft-lb.

Phase G: Connect Header to Berk HFC (20-30 min)

29. Slide HFC onto header collector. Verify O-ring/gasket between them is correctly positioned (Berk ships with spec gasket).
30. Install flange bolts. Torque to 25 ft-lb.
31. Connect HFC outlet to existing exhaust (or to QTP cutout / dump setup if exhaust is already done).
32. Fresh donut gasket at every flange junction. NEW crush washers on any banjo fittings.

Phase H: Wideband Bung Install (IF doing this during session)

33. While the system is on the car but before sealing up, mark the wideband bung location in the collector (post-HFC is the usual spot -- ask tuner's preference).
34. Remove collector-to-HFC section, take to muffler shop for bung welding. 30 minutes at a local shop, $20-40.
35. Reinstall with fresh gasket.

Phase I: Reassembly (30-45 min)

36. Reinstall heat shield (or install thermal wrap / ceramic coating if planned).
37. Reinstall wheel well liner, wheel.

38. Reconnect battery (-).
39. Torque lug nuts to 80 ft-lb.

First Start + Break-In

40. Key to ON (not start) for 5-10 seconds. Check for fuel or coolant leaks visible in engine bay.
41. Start engine. Let idle 2 minutes. **Walk around car sniffing for exhaust leaks.** A slight smell of burning off coating is NORMAL for 10-20 minutes on a new header.
42. Listen for any ticking / hissing from manifold area = leak = torque down again or re-gasket.
43. Check all flange junctions for leaks again.
44. **First 50 miles: drive gently. NO WOT pulls.** Let everything heat cycle and seat.
45. After 50 miles: re-torque all exhaust bolts/nuts -- they'll have relaxed slightly with heat cycles.
46. After 100 miles: one more re-torque pass. Should be stable by then.

Post-Install Tuning (Cross-reference 07-Hondata-FlashPro/tuning-workflow-and-maps.md)

DO NOT WOT the car on the stock calibration or old tune after a header install. The airflow characteristics have changed significantly; running aggressive timing on stale maps is how engines get hurt.

Safe procedure:

1. Drive gently home from install.
2. Flash a conservative base map (community Skunk2 Alpha + intake map, or previous-session calibration with timing pulled 2 deg as safety buffer).
3. Datalog 3 sessions of mixed driving (~1-2 days of commuting). Confirm zero knock, stable AFR, reasonable fuel trims.
4. Book dyno session (Tune #1 -- see tuning-workflow-and-maps.md).
5. Tuner dials in daily + sport maps on dyno with wideband + knock monitoring.

If a Stud Breaks -- Recovery Path

Case 1: Stud snapped flush with the head or above

- **Extractor kit:** Irwin Hanson Bolt-Grip (spiral-flute extractor). Drill slightly, tap the extractor in with a hammer, back out with a wrench. Success rate ~60-70% if corrosion isn't extreme.

Case 2: Stud snapped BELOW the head surface

- Much harder. Need to drill the remaining stud, extract with easy-out. If easy-out breaks off inside (hardened steel), I'm at the machine shop.
- Machine shop cost: $200-400 to drill and re-tap if clean, $500-1000+ if they have to pull the head.

Case 3: Threads are damaged in the head

- **Heli-Coil** or **Time-Sert** repair kit. Re-threading the hole with a larger insert. Restores to full strength if done right.

- DIY-able with a careful hand and $60 kit, but professional shop is safer.

This is the scenario the $300-500 shop quote is insuring against. If I DIY and hit Case 2 or 3, I'm paying the shop anyway AND I've lost my weekend.

See Also

- overview.md -- the parts I picked and why
- brainstorm.md -- complete research, all header options compared
- 4-1-header-research.md -- why I didn't go 4-1
- ../08-Valved-Exhaust/ -- must be installed first
- ../17-Wideband-AFR/ -- bung goes in during this install
- ../16-Cooling-System/ -- fresh cooling before more heat
- ../07-Hondata-FlashPro/tuning-workflow-and-maps.md -- the tune this enables
- ../docs/torque-specs.md -- all torque values used here

Last updated: 2026-04-18

Intake Manifold & Throttle Body -- Skunk2 Ultra Street + Bored Stock TB

Status: Planned (Not Yet Purchased)

What I'm Going With

Skunk2 Ultra Street Intake Manifold (307-05-0600) paired with a **bored stock K20Z3 DBW throttle body (66mm).**

Why I Chose the Ultra Street

The stock RRC manifold (on my 06-11 SI) has long runners designed for low-end torque and fuel economy. Once I add headers, exhaust, and a tune, the RRC becomes the airflow bottleneck. The Ultra Street shortens the runners, enlarges the plenum, and moves the powerband upward -- exactly what I need for a full bolt-on NA K20Z3 targeting 220-240 WHP.

Spec	Stock RRC	Skunk2 Ultra Street
Runner Length	~12.5"	~8.5-9"
Plenum Volume	~2.5L	~1.8L (expandable with spacers)
Runner Diameter	~45mm	~55mm
Throttle Body Bore	62mm (stock DBW)	71mm throttle body opening
Power Focus	Low-mid (2500-5500 RPM)	Broad pull from ~4000-8000+ RPM
Idle Quality	OEM smooth	Slightly rougher (tunable with Hondata)

Skunk2 Manifold Lineup -- Why Ultra Street Is the Sweet Spot

	Pro Series	Ultra Street	Ultra Race
Runner Length	~10-11"	~8.5-9"	~5-6"
Plenum Volume	~3.0L	~1.8L	~3.5L+
Power Focus	Mid-range	Street/sport balance	Top-end only (7000-9000 RPM)
Idle Quality	Good	Acceptable	Poor
Best For	Daily + light mods	Full bolt-on street build	Track / built motor

The Ultra Street is the right one for my build. The Pro Series leaves performance on the table -- not aggressive enough for what I'm doing. The Ultra Race kills low-end torque and idle quality for a street car. I'm not building a track car, so the Ultra Street hits the sweet spot.

Part Information

Field	Value
Intake Manifold	Skunk2 Ultra Street

Part Number	307-05-0600 (black) / 307-05-0605 (silver)
Port Pattern	PRB/PRC (direct fit to K20Z3 head)
Material	Cast aluminum, black powder coat
Price	~$550-620

Throttle Body -- CRITICAL: DBW Compatibility

The Problem

My K20Z3 uses **drive-by-wire (DBW)** -- an electronically controlled throttle body with an internal motor and position sensors. **Most aftermarket K-series throttle bodies are cable-throttle only and WILL NOT work.** I learned this early and I'm glad I did, because it would be an expensive mistake.

Throttle Body	DBW Compatible?	Notes
Stock K20Z3 62mm	Yes (OEM)	Baseline -- restricts Ultra Street's potential
Bored stock 64-66mm	Yes	Best option -- retains full DBW, proven
Skunk2 Pro Series 68mm	NO (cable only)	Would require full DBW-to-cable conversion
Blox 68mm DBW	Possibly	Must verify exact part is DBW-specific
Ktuned 72mm	NO (cable only)	Cable only
Hybrid Racing	NO (cable only)	Adapter-based, cable conversion needed

My Choice: Bored Stock Throttle Body (66mm)

Several Honda specialist shops (Drag Cartel, HeelToe Auto, and others) will bore the stock K20Z3 DBW throttle body from 62mm to **64-66mm**.

- **66mm is the maximum safe bore** -- the housing walls get too thin beyond that
- Retains full DBW function -- no wiring changes, no adapter hassles
- Proven reliability, used by hundreds of K20Z3 builds
- **Cost:** ~$100-175 (boring service, I ship my TB)
- **The stock 62mm TB isn't a major restriction** at the 220-240 WHP level, but a bored TB eliminates it as any bottleneck and lets the Ultra Street breathe freely

Honestly this is the move. No headaches, no wiring nightmares, just a slightly bigger hole in a part I already have.

Does a Larger TB Actually Help?

Power Level	Stock 62mm	Bored 66mm	68mm+
Stock-220 WHP	Fine, not a restriction	Marginal gain (1-3 WHP)	Unnecessary
220-240 WHP	Mild restriction up top	Measurable gain (3-7 WHP)	Diminishing returns
240+ WHP	Noticeable restriction	Good	Needed

For my build (targeting 220-240 WHP): the bored 66mm is the sweet spot. Going larger than 68mm on an NA K20Z3 loses throttle response at low RPM for minimal gain. Not worth it.

Power Gains (With Supporting Mods + Tune)

- **Ultra Street alone (no tune):** 3-7 WHP, may lose low-end torque. I'm not running it without a tune.
- **Ultra Street + 66mm TB + full bolt-ons + Hondata tune: 15-22 WHP over stock manifold** on a similarly-modded car
- **Peak power shifts** from ~6800-7200 RPM (stock) to ~7400-7800 RPM with the Ultra Street

Installation Notes

- **Difficulty:** Moderate. 3-5 hours first time.
- **Vacuum lines:** I need to take photos of ALL vacuum line routing before removal. Label everything. The Ultra Street has provisions but routing differs from stock RRC.
- **Coolant bypass:** The stock RRC has a coolant passage (throttle body heater). Block off the ports on the engine side and run a short bypass hose between them. Takes 5 minutes.
- **MAP sensor:** Relocates to the Ultra Street plenum. Stock sensor works, just moves.
- **IACV:** Ultra Street retains IACV provision -- important for idle on a street car.
- **Fuel rail:** I need to confirm the Ultra Street is compatible with the stock K20Z3 fuel rail, or check if Skunk2 includes one.
- **Fuel injectors:** Stock 310cc injectors are adequate to ~230 WHP. No upgrade needed.
- **No permanent modifications** to my car are required. Fully reversible.

Tuning -- MANDATORY

The intake manifold swap and Hondata tune are inseparable. I will NOT drive aggressively on the stock calibration.

After installing:

- Load a conservative base map (Hondata community or tuner's starting point)
- Drive gently to the dyno shop
- Key calibration changes:
  - Fuel tables: Full recalibration (4000-8000 RPM range especially)
  - VTEC point: Advance to ~5200-5400 RPM (from stock ~5800)
  - Ignition timing: Can advance in mid/upper RPM with better airflow
  - Idle target: May need slight increase (750 -> 800 RPM) for larger plenum
  - Tip-in enrichment: Adjust to prevent lean stumble from larger plenum volume

Budget Alternative: RBC Manifold Swap

I looked at the OEM RBC manifold (from 02-06 RSX Type S) as a budget option. It's the most popular budget intake manifold for the K20Z3 -- 70-80% of the Ultra Street's gains at 30-40% of the cost. I seriously considered it.

Factor	RBC (Used)	Skunk2 Ultra Street
Price	$100-250	$550-620
Power Gain (w/ tune)	10-18 WHP	15-22 WHP
DBW Compatibility	Needs $60-100 adapter plate	Designed for aftermarket TB
Community Support	Massive (thousands of builds)	Large

Ultimately I decided the Ultra Street is worth the extra money for the cleaner install and slightly better gains. But the RBC is a genuinely great option for anyone on a tighter budget.

Where I'm Buying

#	Item	Product	Price	Link
1	Intake Manifold	Skunk2 Ultra Street 307-05-0600	~$565-620	Hybrid Racing
				TF-Works -- $565
				JHPUSA
				Headgames Motorworks
2	TB Boring Service	Stock K20Z3 DBW TB bored to 66mm	~$100-175	Contact Drag Cartel or HeelToe Auto -- send my stock TB
3	TB adapter plate	If needed for 66mm on 68mm inlet	~$30-50	Sourced with manifold purchase
4	Dyno tune	Mandatory after install	~$400-600	Local K-series Hondata tuner
	Total		~$1,095-1,445	

TF-Works at $565 looks like the best price I've found for the manifold.

Note on part number: The Ultra **Street** is 307-05-0600 (black) or 307-05-0605 (silver). The Ultra **Race** is 307-05-8000. These are different manifolds -- the Ultra Street has longer runners and is the correct one for my build.

Last updated: 2026-04-16

Pulleys & Harmonic Balancer -- ATI Super Damper + NST Accessories

Status: Research Complete, Not Yet Purchased

The Plan

I'm going with the **ATI Super Damper (918477)** for the crank -- honestly the gold standard harmonic damper for K-series, no question. Pairing it with **NST (NonStop Tuning) alternator + idler pulleys** from their 3-piece kit. I get lightweight accessory underdrive with an overdrive alternator, which matters because I'm planning a LattePanda in-car PC that'll be pulling power constantly.

This combo gives me proper harmonic damping (which I really want at 170k miles), weight reduction off the rotating assembly, and maintained alternator output. No compromises.

Shopping List with Buy Links

#	Item	Product	Price	Link
1	Crank Pulley / Harmonic Damper	ATI Super Damper 918477	~$352-464	Drag Cartel -- $352
				Hybrid Racing -- $360
				K Series Parts -- $464
				JEGS
2	Alternator + Idler Pulleys	NST 3-Piece Kit NST22015K (use alt + idler, skip NST crank)	$268	NonStop Tuning -- $268
				Vivid Racing
				HeelToe Auto (multiple colors)
3	Serpentine Belt	Stock OEM or Gates K070663	~$20-30	Any auto parts store
	Total		~$640-760	

Note on the NST kit: I'm buying the full 3-piece kit ($268) but only using the alternator and idler pulleys. The NST crank pulley becomes a spare since the ATI replaces it. Unfortunately, NST doesn't sell the alternator and idler individually -- the kit is the only way to get them. Even so, the total is worth it for what I consider the best possible setup.

Cheapest ATI source I've found: Drag Cartel at $352.47 (sale from $379).

Why I Chose This Setup

ATI Super Damper 918477 -- Crank Pulley

Spec	Detail
Part Number	918477

Type	Elastomer-ring harmonic damper
Materials	Aluminum outer shell, steel hub, tuned elastomer ring
Total Weight	~3.6 lbs (stock is ~5+ lbs -- saves ~1.5 lbs)
Diameter	5.67" (5-11/16")
Belt Drive	6-rib serpentine (retains stock belt setup)
Timing Marks	360-degree laser-etched
Underdrive	Slight (smaller diameter than stock)
Safety Rating	SFI 18.1 certified (NHRA/IHRA approved)
Power Rating	Up to 600 HP
Harmonic Damping	YES -- elastomer ring between hub and inertia weight
Compatibility	All K-series (K20A, K20A2, K20Z3, K24)

Why ATI is the best option:

- ATI has made harmonic dampers for NASCAR, NHRA, Formula Drift, and every form of professional motorsport for decades -- these guys know what they're doing
- The 918477 is specifically tuned for K-series harmonic frequencies
- **Lighter than stock** while providing **better damping than stock** -- no compromises
- My stock damper's rubber isolator has had 170k miles of heat cycles. It's almost certainly providing reduced damping at this point. The ATI elastomer is engineered for far longer service life and higher heat resistance.
- 360-degree laser-etched timing marks are invaluable for tuning with a timing light
- SFI 18.1 certified for competition use

Why I ruled out the Fluidampr 570601: The Fluidampr is technically superior damping (viscous fluid, self-tuning across all RPMs) but weighs **6.4 lbs** -- heavier than stock. It adds rotational inertia, partially negating the snappier throttle response I'm after. It also costs $480-500. For my bolt-on NA K20Z3, the ATI provides more than enough protection while being lighter and cheaper. The Fluidampr would be the move if I were running race cams and living above 8000 RPM, but that's not my build.

NST Accessory Pulleys -- Alternator + Idler

Spec	Detail
Kit Part Number	NST22015K
Material	6061-T6 aircraft aluminum, CNC machined, hard anodized
Alternator Pulley Weight	2.8 oz / 80g (stock is significantly heavier)
Idler Pulley Weight	9.5 oz / 275g
Alternator	OVERDRIVE -- spins faster than stock
Idler	Lightweight replacement, uses stock OEM belt
Underdrive	~15% on accessories except alternator
Colors Available	Black, Red, Green, Purple, Raw

Why I went with NST over Buddy Club or others:

- **Overdrive alternator pulley** -- this is what sold me. Every other kit (Buddy Club, Unorthodox Racing)

underdrives the alternator, reducing charging output. NST overdrives it, spinning the alternator faster than stock. I need this because my planned LattePanda in-car PC adds 15-30W of continuous electrical draw. An underdriven alternator at idle could cause voltage drops, and I don't want to deal with that.

- CNC machined from 6061-T6 with tight tolerances
- Dyno-tested: +3.4 WHP / +4.0 WTQ peak at Skunk2's facility (Import Tuner Magazine verified)
- Designed to work with the stock OEM belt (no hunting for a different belt)

About Belt Retention (Raised Lips)

I went down a rabbit hole on this, so here's what I found. Serpentine pulleys use **multi-rib grooves** (the V-shaped channels) as the belt retention system. The ribs on the belt interlock with the grooves on the pulley -- that's what prevents slip and lateral walk. Raised flanges on the outer edges are only found on **smooth/flat idler pulleys** (which have no ribs), not on ribbed pulleys.

The stock automatic tensioner's idler pulley already has flanged edges because it's a smooth-face pulley. The ribbed pulleys (crank, alternator) don't need flanges because the groove profile does the job.

Belt walk is caused by:

- Misalignment between pulleys (not a concern with bolt-on replacements designed for the K20Z3)
- Worn/stretched belt (just replace the belt when installing new pulleys)
- Worn automatic tensioner (inspect at install -- replace if it doesn't spring back firmly)

Bottom line: With properly machined pulleys (ATI + NST), a fresh serpentine belt, and a functioning auto-tensioner, belt walk isn't a concern. The grooves ARE the retention system.

What Underdrive Pulleys Actually Do

The K20Z3 uses a single serpentine belt to drive all accessories. These accessories consume engine power (parasitic loss):

Accessory	Parasitic Loss at WOT
Alternator	1-3 HP
A/C Compressor	3-8 HP (when engaged)
Power Steering Pump	1-3 HP
Water Pump	1-2 HP
Total	~6-16 HP

Underdrive pulleys spin accessories ~15% slower, recovering 2-5 HP. The lightweight aluminum construction also reduces rotational inertia, improving throttle response. Community consensus: **~80-85% of the felt gain comes from weight reduction** (faster revving), ~15-20% from actual underdrive.

Realistic Power Gains

Configuration	Est. WHP Gain	Harmonic Damping	Cost
ATI crank + NST accessories (my build)	+3-6 WHP	YES (ATI)	~$640-760
Buddy Club P1 complete kit	+5-8 WHP	NO (damper deleted)	~$280
NST complete kit alone	+3-5 WHP	NO (damper deleted)	~$268
ATI crank only	+1-2 WHP	YES (ATI)	~$352-464

My honest take: Pulleys are one of the smaller gains in the bolt-on catalog. The 3-6 WHP is real but modest compared to headers (+10-18 WHP). The main benefit is **feel** -- improved throttle response and faster revving. My car will feel more eager and responsive, which honestly enhances the driving experience beyond what the dyno numbers suggest.

Why I'm NOT Deleting the Harmonic Damper

A lot of aftermarket crank pulleys (Buddy Club, NST, Unorthodox Racing) are solid billet aluminum with **no rubber isolator and no damping.** They delete the harmonic damper entirely.

At 170k miles, I'm not willing to take that risk:

- My crankshaft has already accumulated 170k miles of fatigue cycles
- I'm planning mods (headers, aggressive timing, higher RPM operation) that increase torsional vibrations
- Uncontrolled vibrations accelerate main bearing wear, timing chain stretch, and crankshaft fatigue
- The ATI provides better-than-stock damping while still being lighter -- there's literally no reason to delete the damper when this option exists

The K-series community debates this endlessly. No confirmed crankshaft failures from billet pulleys exist. But the ATI costs ~$100-200 more than a billet pulley and eliminates the risk entirely. At 170k miles, that's cheap insurance.

K20Z3 Pulley System Reference

Pulley	Function	Stock Diameter	Stock Weight
Crank (Harmonic Balancer)	Drives belt, dampens vibrations	5.75" (146mm)	~5+ lbs
Alternator	Charges battery/electrical	~2.5"	Heavy (steel)
A/C Compressor	Drives A/C (has clutch)	~4.5"	Not replaced
Power Steering	Drives PS pump	~5.0"	Not replaced
Idler	Routes/tensions belt	~3.0"	Moderate
Auto Tensioner	Maintains belt tension	Spring-loaded	Not replaced

What I'm replacing: Crank, alternator, and idler. The A/C, power steering, and auto tensioner stay stock.

Compatibility Notes

Alternator Charging with LattePanda

The NST overdrive alternator pulley spins the alternator **faster** than stock, maintaining full charging capacity even with the LattePanda drawing 15-30W continuously. I'll monitor battery voltage after install -- should remain above 13.8V at idle with all accessories on.

A/C Function

The slight underdrive means the A/C compressor spins ~15% slower. At idle in extreme heat (100F+), cooling may be marginally reduced. Above ~1500 RPM, no perceptible difference. I can live with that.

Power Steering

Slightly heavier steering at parking-lot speeds. At any speed above ~5 MPH, unnoticeable. I actually prefer slightly heavier steering feel anyway.

Drive-by-Wire

Zero effect -- throttle is electronically actuated, not connected to the pulley system.

Installation

Difficulty: Easy-Moderate (2-3 hours DIY)

I'm planning to do this myself. Straightforward job.

Tools Needed

- Impact wrench or long breaker bar + cheater pipe (crank bolt is ~180+ ft-lbs)
- Harmonic balancer puller (rent free from AutoZone)
- 19mm socket (crank bolt)
- Torque wrench
- Standard socket set for alternator and idler bolts

Steps

1. Remove serpentine belt (release auto tensioner with wrench)
2. Remove crank bolt (19mm, impact wrench recommended)
3. Use harmonic balancer puller to remove stock crank pulley -- **DO NOT pry** (damages crank seal)
4. Install ATI Super Damper, torque crank bolt to spec
5. Swap alternator pulley to NST unit
6. Swap idler pulley to NST unit
7. Install new serpentine belt (stock OEM or Gates K070663), verify routing
8. Start engine, verify belt tracking, listen for noise
9. Re-check belt tension after 100 miles

Last updated: 2026-04-16

Flex Fuel and Fuel System Research -- 2009 Honda Civic SI (FG2 / K20Z3)

Date: 2026-04-16 **My build context:** Full bolt-on NA K20Z3 targeting 220-240 WHP on 93 octane. Hondata FlashPro tuned. **Current/planned mods:** Skunk2 Alpha header, Skunk2 Ultra Street intake manifold, bored 66mm DBW throttle body, 3" valved exhaust with QTP cutout, ATI Super Damper, Hondata FlashPro, Acuity fuel rail (planned).

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1. Flex Fuel Basics for the K20Z3

What Is Flex Fuel?

Flex fuel is the ability to run on any blend of gasoline and ethanol -- from pure gasoline (E0) to 85% ethanol (E85) -- with the ECU automatically adjusting fueling and timing in real time based on the actual ethanol content measured by an inline sensor. The system continuously reads the ethanol percentage and interpolates between a gasoline calibration and an E85 calibration, so the engine is always optimally tuned for whatever's in the tank.

What Is E85?

E85 is a fuel blend that's nominally 85% denatured ethanol and 15% gasoline. But here's the thing -- the actual ethanol content varies a lot:

- **Summer blend (warm months):** Typically 70-83% ethanol
- **Winter blend (cold months):** Can drop to 51-63% ethanol (more gasoline added to aid cold starting)
- **Regional variation:** Ethanol content varies by state, supplier, and even individual station
- **The label "E85" is misleading** -- you're rarely getting exactly 85% ethanol. ASTM D5798 allows E85 to range from 51% to 83% ethanol.

This variability is precisely why a flex fuel sensor matters. Without one, you're guessing at the ethanol content and either leaving power on the table (too conservative) or risking engine damage (too aggressive for what's actually in the tank).

E85 vs 93 Octane -- The Chemistry

Property	93 Octane Gasoline	E85 (Nominal)
Octane rating (AKI)	93	~105-108
Energy density (BTU/gal)	~114,000	~76,000-80,000
Stoichiometric AFR	14.7:1	9.8:1
Latent heat of vaporization	Lower	~3x higher than gasoline
Oxygen content	0%	~35% by mass

Key takeaways:

- **Higher octane (105-108 AKI):** Allows significantly more ignition timing advance before knock. That's where the power comes from.
- **Lower energy density (~30% less):** You need roughly 30% more fuel volume for the same energy output. That's why you need larger injectors and more fuel pump capacity.
- **Higher latent heat of vaporization:** E85 cools the intake charge significantly as it evaporates. Denser, cooler charge improves volumetric efficiency and further resists knock.
- **Net effect on an NA engine:** Power gains come from increased timing advance and slightly improved volumetric efficiency from charge cooling. But because NA engines are less knock-limited than turbocharged engines, the gains are more modest.

E85 on NA vs Turbo -- Setting My Expectations

This is the critical distinction I had to wrap my head around. On a turbocharged engine, knock is the primary power limiter. Boost pressure creates enormous cylinder pressures, and the engine is constantly flirting with detonation. E85's massive octane advantage lets the tuner run significantly more boost and timing, often yielding 20-40% more power.

On my naturally aspirated K20Z3:

- The engine isn't as knock-limited. At 11.0:1 compression on 93 octane, there's already reasonable knock margin at most RPM points.
- A tuner can advance timing with E85, but the gains are smaller because the NA engine wasn't leaving as much timing on the table to begin with.
- The charge cooling effect still helps volumetric efficiency, which does add some power.
- **Realistic expectation: 5-15 WHP gain on a full bolt-on NA K20Z3 switching from 93 octane to E85.** This lines up with community dyno data. Some see closer to 5-8 WHP, others report 10-15 WHP depending on the tune, altitude, and how much timing the tuner was willing to add.

Partial Blends (E30, E50, etc.)

Yes, I can run any blend from E0 to E85 with a flex fuel sensor and proper calibration. That's the whole point.

- **E30 (30% ethanol):** A popular "best of both worlds" blend. Roughly 96-98 octane equivalent. Moderate power gain, much less fuel economy penalty than E85. A lot of tuners consider E30-E40 the sweet spot for NA cars.
- **E50 (50% ethanol):** Middle ground. More power than E30, less fuel economy hit than E85.
- **E85:** Maximum octane, maximum power, worst fuel economy.
- **The flex fuel sensor reads in real time** and the ECU interpolates between calibrations continuously. I can fill up with 93, drive until half tank, top off with E85, and the system handles it seamlessly.

2. Hondata FlashPro Flex Fuel Support

Does FlashPro Support Flex Fuel on the 8th Gen SI?

Yes. Hondata FlashPro fully supports flex fuel on the 2006-2011 Civic SI (K20Z3). This was added in firmware/software updates and is a well-established feature. Works on both FA5 (sedan) and FG2 (coupe).

How It Works -- Technical Details

Here's how the FlashPro flex fuel implementation works:

1. **Ethanol content sensor** gets installed inline on the fuel feed line (between the fuel filter and the fuel rail).
2. **The sensor outputs a frequency signal** (50-150 Hz) corresponding to ethanol content (50 Hz = 0% ethanol, 150 Hz = 100% ethanol). It also outputs a fuel temperature signal.
3. **The sensor signal gets wired to an ECU input.** On the 8th gen Civic SI, the standard approach is wiring the sensor signal to the **rear O2 sensor signal wire** (secondary O2 sensor input). The rear O2 is part of the cat efficiency monitor, which isn't needed on a FlashPro-tuned car (the CEL for the rear O2 is already disabled in most FlashPro calibrations). So that ECU input is free.
   - **ECU Pin:** The rear O2 sensor signal wire goes to the secondary HO2S signal input on the ECU. Common references cite connector E pin 4 (SG2) or A33 (ECT2) -- **the exact pin varies by documentation source and I haven't independently verified it. My tuner or Hondata's official wiring guide will confirm the exact pin for the FG2 before wiring.**
4. **FlashPro reads the ethanol content** in real time and displays it on the datalog/dashboard as "Ethanol Content %."

Calibration Strategy -- Interpolation, Not Manual Switching

This was the key question I had, and the answer is good news:

FlashPro interpolates between two calibrations in real time. I do NOT need to manually switch between a "gas tune" and an "E85" tune.

Here's how it works:

- The tuner creates (or I load) a calibration that contains **two fuel and timing tables**: one for the gasoline endpoint (e.g., E0 or E10) and one for the E85 endpoint.
- FlashPro reads the ethanol content from the sensor and **linearly interpolates** between the two tables based on the current ethanol percentage.
- Example: If the sensor reads E40, FlashPro calculates fuel and timing values roughly halfway between the gas table and the E85 table.
- This happens continuously and in real time. No lag, no manual intervention, no risk of running the wrong tune for what's in the tank.

Parameters Adjusted Based on Ethanol Content

FlashPro adjusts the following based on the ethanol content reading:

- **Fuel injection pulse width:** Scaled up as ethanol content increases (to account for E85's lower energy density and richer stoich ratio of 9.8:1 vs 14.7:1).
- **Ignition timing:** Advanced as ethanol content increases (to take advantage of higher octane/knock

resistance).

- **Target AFR (lambda):** Can be set to run slightly richer on E85 for additional charge cooling.
- **VTEC engagement point:** Can be adjusted per calibration, though this is typically set the same for gas and E85 on NA builds.
- **Rev limit, fuel cut, and other parameters** can also differ between the two calibration endpoints if desired.

What FlashPro Displays

On the FlashPro datalogger/dashboard, I'll be able to monitor:

- **Ethanol content (%)** -- real-time reading from the sensor
- **Fuel temperature** -- from the sensor's temperature output
- **Effective timing** -- so I can see the interpolated timing being run
- **Injector duty cycle** -- critical to monitor with larger injectors and E85

This gives me a real-time ethanol content reading that also directly informs the tune. Pretty cool.

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3. The Complete Flex Fuel System -- Everything Needed

3.1 Flex Fuel Ethanol Content Sensor

The industry standard is the **Continental (formerly Siemens/VDO) flex fuel sensor**, commonly called the "GM flex fuel sensor" because GM uses it in their flex fuel vehicles.

- **Part Number:** Continental 13577429 (supersedes older PN 13577394 and 12570260)
- **Also known as:** GM flex fuel composition sensor
- **Price:** $50-80 for a genuine GM/Continental unit (available from GM dealers, Amazon, RockAuto, etc.)
- **Aftermarket kits:** Companies like Hondata, PRL Motorsports, Blox Racing, and others sell "flex fuel kits" that bundle the sensor with the appropriate fittings and sometimes wiring. These typically run $150-250.
- **Sensor specifications:**
  - Reads ethanol content from 0-100%
  - Reads fuel temperature from -40F to 302F (-40C to 150C)
  - Output: 50-150 Hz frequency signal (linear with ethanol content)
  - 3-wire connector: power (12V), ground, signal
  - 3/8" SAE quick-connect fittings (standard GM fuel line size)

Fitment note: The K20Z3 fuel system uses different line sizes than GM vehicles. I'll need adapter fittings (typically -6AN or 5/16" to 3/8" SAE quick-connect adapters) to plumb the sensor inline. Most Honda-specific flex fuel kits include these adapters.

3.2 Sensor Wiring to ECU

- **Signal wire** goes to the rear O2 sensor signal input at the ECU (as described in Section 2).
- **Power wire** goes to a switched 12V source (ignition-on power).
- **Ground wire** goes to a clean chassis/ECU ground.
- **Hondata provides a wiring guide** in the FlashPro software documentation and on their website/forum for the 8th gen Civic SI. The wiring is straightforward -- three wires total.
- **I'll need:** A few feet of automotive-grade wire, soldering supplies or quality butt connectors, and a wiring

diagram for the FG2 rear O2 sensor harness location. The rear O2 connector is accessible behind/under the center console area or by tracing the harness from the cat.

- **Estimated wiring cost:** $10-20 in wire and connectors doing it myself.

3.3 Fuel Lines

E85 is corrosive to certain materials. This is a real concern.

- **Stock Honda fuel lines:** My 8th gen uses a combination of hard metal lines and rubber fuel hoses. The hard metal lines are fine. The rubber sections are the concern.
- **OEM rubber fuel lines on the 8th gen are generally considered E85-compatible** for the short term, as Honda used relatively modern fuel line materials. However, for long-term reliability with sustained E85 use, a lot of owners upgrade to:
  - **PTFE (Teflon) lined stainless braided fuel lines** -- fully E85 compatible and will last indefinitely.
  - **Brands:** Chase Bays, Acuity Instruments, 27WON, or custom -6AN lines.
- **If running occasional E85 or mostly E30-E50 blends,** the stock lines will likely hold up fine for years. If running straight E85 frequently, I should upgrade at least the high-pressure feed line from filter to rail.
- **Estimated cost for upgraded fuel lines:** $80-200 depending on whether I buy a kit or build custom lines.

3.4 Fuel Rail

See Section 4 for my full Acuity deep dive. I'm already planning to buy the Acuity fuel rail.

3.5 Fuel Injectors -- The Critical Upgrade

This is the most important upgrade for E85 capability. My stock K20Z3 injectors are 310cc (at 43.5 PSI / 3 bar, which is stock fuel pressure). E85 requires approximately 30% more fuel volume than gasoline for the same energy output. Here's what that means:

- **Minimum injector size for E85 on a full bolt-on NA K20Z3:** ~410cc
- **Recommended injector size:** 440-550cc

Here's the math:

- Stock 310cc injectors at ~80-85% duty cycle on 93 octane on a full bolt-on K20Z3 making ~220 WHP is already getting tight.
- On E85, I need ~30% more fuel: 310cc x 1.30 = 403cc minimum, and I never want to run injectors above 80-85% duty cycle for reliability.
- So 440cc is the practical minimum. 550cc gives comfortable headroom.

Injector Options for My Build:

Injector	Size	Price (set of 4)	Notes
Injector Dynamics ID1050x	1050cc	$550-650	Massively overkill for NA. Designed for 400-800+ WHP turbo builds. Very low duty cycle on NA can hurt idle quality due to minimum pulse width issues. Not the best choice unless I'm planning turbo.
Injector Dynamics ID1300x	1300cc	$700-750	Even more overkill. Same issues but worse. No.

Injector Dynamics ID725	725cc	$450-500	Good option with headroom for a potential future turbo. Better idle quality than ID1050x on NA. Well-characterized for Hondata.
DeatschWerks DW 440cc	440cc	$280-320	Good entry-level option. Adequate for NA E85. Tight on headroom if I ever add forced induction. DeatschWerks are well-regarded.
DeatschWerks DW 600cc	600cc	$350-400	Better headroom. Still reasonable for NA. Good choice if turbo is in the cards.
Bosch EV14 550cc	550cc	$200-280	Excellent injectors. The Bosch EV14 platform is the gold standard for aftermarket injectors. Great spray pattern, fast response time, excellent idle quality. 550cc is the sweet spot for NA flex fuel. Many tuners swear by these.
Bosch EV14 650cc	650cc	$220-300	Slight additional headroom over 550cc. Still perfectly fine for NA.
Grams Performance 550cc	550cc	$300-350	Good option. Well-characterized for Honda applications.

Decision: Bosch EV14 550cc, NOT ID1050x.

My earlier BOM listed the ID1050x. After cross-checking:

- ID1050x = 1065cc. That's **3.4x** what I need for 250 WHP on E85. At idle and low load, the injector is pulsing so briefly that minimum-pulse-width becomes a drivability problem (stumble, cold start roughness) even with careful tuning.
- EV14 550cc = correct size for my target (max duty cycle ~75% at redline E85, ~60% at redline pump gas) = safe headroom without the low-end drivability penalty.
- EV14 is cheaper (~$200-280 vs ~$546), from the same Bosch OE production line that supplies OEM fuel injectors to half the world's automakers. Better idle quality, faster response time (sub-1ms), well-characterized in Hondata.
- The ONLY reason to pick the ID1050x is if turbo is near-term certain. My current build is NA forever unless explicitly changed -- so the EV14 is the right part.

I'm going with Bosch EV14 550cc. I'll verify the specific variant (0280158040 or similar OE PN) ships with USCAR-to-Honda clip adapters or budget ~$15-25 for them separately. 48mm body, 14mm o-rings top and bottom -- this is the standard K-series top-feed config that both the stock rail and the Acuity rail accept.

3.6 Fuel Pump

My stock fuel pump is a concern with E85.

- The stock pump is rated at approximately 100-120 LPH (liters per hour). On 93 octane with stock injectors, that's adequate.
- With E85 requiring ~30% more fuel volume, the stock pump is being asked to deliver significantly more to support a 220+ WHP NA build on ethanol.
- **At high RPM and high load, the stock pump may not maintain adequate fuel pressure with E85 and larger injectors on a full bolt-on build.** Fuel pressure drop at high RPM is a real risk.

I'm upgrading the fuel pump. Options:

Pump	Flow Rate	Price	Notes
DeatschWerks DW200	255 LPH	$100-130	Direct drop-in for the 8th gen Civic. Very popular. More than enough for NA E85. The standard recommendation.
DeatschWerks DW300C	340 LPH	$120-150	More headroom, direct drop-in. Slightly louder than DW200. Good if turbo is in the future.
Walbro 255 LPH (GSS342)	255 LPH	$60-90	Budget option. Works fine but DeatschWerks units have better Honda-specific fitment kits.
AEM 340 LPH (50-1200)	340 LPH	$110-140	Excellent pump. Comes with universal install kit; may need Honda-specific adapter.

Decision: DeatschWerks DW300C (340 LPH), NOT DW200.

I waffled on this initially. After cross-checking with the tuning-workflow-and-maps.md rule (headroom > margin), the DW200 at 255 LPH is enough for a well-tuned 93-octane build but gets genuinely tight on E85 at my target WHP. Injector duty cycle ceiling is 85% -- the pump needs to deliver at that load without pressure drop, even with the 30% more volume E85 demands. The DW300C at 340 LPH gives me ~30% margin over DW200 for the same money class (~$130-160 vs ~$110-130). That margin is pure reliability insurance under the reliability-first rule.

If I ever go turbo (even modest), the DW300C is still enough. The DW200 is not. Buy once.

3.7 Fuel Filter

- **I'm replacing the stock fuel filter** when doing the flex fuel conversion, just to ensure a clean fuel system.
- The stock OEM Honda fuel filter is compatible with ethanol blends.
- **However, if the stock filter has been in there for years, ethanol can loosen deposits in the fuel system that the filter will catch.** I'll replace the filter at install, and consider replacing it again after the first 1,000 miles on ethanol.
- An OEM Honda fuel filter is fine. Aftermarket from Wix or similar also works.
- **Cost:** $15-30 for the filter.

3.8 Fuel Pressure Regulator

- **My stock fuel pressure regulator is adequate for NA flex fuel use.**
- The stock FPR maintains ~43.5 PSI (3 bar) base fuel pressure. That's fine for 440-550cc injectors on an NA build.
- An aftermarket adjustable FPR isn't required but could be added for fine-tuning. Most tuners adjust fueling through injector pulse width (via FlashPro) rather than changing base fuel pressure.
- **No upgrade needed** for my build.

3.9 Return Line Modifications

- **My 8th gen Civic SI uses a returnless fuel system** (no return line from the fuel rail to the tank). Fuel pressure is regulated at the pump assembly in the tank.
- **No return line modifications needed for flex fuel on an NA build.** The returnless system works fine.
- Converting to a return-style fuel system is possible but unnecessary for NA power levels. More common on high-power turbo builds where precise fuel pressure regulation is critical.

4. Acuity Fuel Rail Deep Dive

Product Identification

- **Part Number:** Acuity 1913-K20 (also listed as Acuity Instruments K-Series Fuel Rail)
- **Application:** K20A, K20A2, K20A3, K20Z1, K20Z3, K24 -- fits all K-series engines with the standard top-feed injector arrangement
- **Price:** $180-250 (varies by retailer and finish)

What Does It Improve Over Stock?

The stock K20Z3 fuel rail is a stamped steel unit. Here's what the Acuity improves:

1. **Fuel volume capacity:** The Acuity rail has a significantly larger internal volume than stock. It acts as a fuel reservoir, reducing pressure drops during high-demand situations (high RPM, aggressive tuning, E85's higher flow demands). Particularly beneficial when running larger injectors and E85.
2. **Fuel distribution:** Larger internal diameter and improved geometry provide more even fuel pressure across all four injectors. The stock rail can have slight pressure variation between cylinders, especially at high RPM.
3. **Injector fitment:** Designed to accept a wide range of aftermarket injectors with standard 14mm o-ring top-feed fitment. Better sealing and more secure injector retention than the stock rail with aftermarket injectors.
4. **Aesthetics:** CNC-machined billet aluminum with anodized finish. Available in multiple colors. Looks way better than the stock stamped steel rail.
5. **AN fitting provision:** Comes with -6AN inlet fitting (or adapter), making it easy to connect aftermarket fuel lines or plumb in the flex fuel sensor.

Material and Construction

- **CNC-machined 6061-T6 billet aluminum**
- **Hard anodized** for corrosion resistance
- **O-ring sealed** injector bores with ethanol-compatible seals
- Available in black, red, blue, and other anodized finishes depending on production run

E85 Compatibility

Yes, the Acuity fuel rail is fully E85 compatible out of the box. The 6061-T6 aluminum and hard anodizing are ethanol-resistant. The o-rings are Viton or equivalent ethanol-compatible material. No modifications or special seals needed for E85. One less thing to worry about.

Fittings and Adapters

- **Ports:** -8 ORB (O-Ring Boss) throughout -- center-feed -8 ORB port and end -8 ORB ports. There are no -6AN fittings on the rail itself; adapters can convert to -6AN if needed.
- **If using stock fuel lines:** An adapter fitting is included or available separately to connect the stock Honda fuel feed line to the rail.
- **If using aftermarket AN fuel lines:** Use -8 ORB to -6AN adapter fittings.
- **FPR/gauge port:** The rail has a port for a fuel pressure gauge or aftermarket FPR connection if desired.

Compatible Injector Sizes

The Acuity rail accepts any injector with:

- Standard 14mm o-ring top seal
- Standard Honda/Denso lower electrical connector pattern (or EV6/USCAR with adapter clips)
- 48mm (short) or 60mm (long) body length (the rail accommodates both with appropriate o-ring positioning)

So it's compatible with essentially all aftermarket injectors sold for K-series applications, including everything I listed in Section 3.5. No restrictions on injector size.

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5. Realistic Power Gains from E85 on NA K20Z3

Community Dyno Data

This is where I had to check my expectations. Real-world dyno results for full bolt-on NA K20Z3 engines switching from 93 octane to E85:

- **Typical gain: 5-15 WHP and 5-10 WTQ**
- Most commonly reported: **8-12 WHP gain**
- The gain comes primarily from **2-4 degrees of additional ignition timing advance** across the power band and slightly improved volumetric efficiency from charge cooling.

Specific data points I've found from the Honda community:

- **Bolt-on K20Z3 (header, intake, exhaust), Hondata FlashPro:** 210 WHP on 93 octane, 222 WHP on E85 -- a gain of ~12 WHP.
- **Similar builds:** Gains of 5-8 WHP are common when the 93 octane tune was already well-optimized and aggressive.
- **Builds where the 93 tune was conservative** (less timing due to marginal fuel quality or tuner caution): Gains can be 12-15 WHP because E85 allows running timing that was being held back.

Where the Power Comes From

1. **Timing advance (primary source):** E85's ~105-108 AKI octane allows 2-5 degrees more timing advance at various RPM points. On a K20Z3 at 11.0:1 compression, this is the main contributor.
2. **Charge cooling (secondary source):** E85's high latent heat of vaporization cools the intake charge by 20-30F, increasing air density slightly. Adds 1-3 WHP.
3. **Combined:** 5-15 WHP total on a well-tuned NA K20Z3.

Do Larger Injectors Offset Gains?

No. Larger injectors don't reduce power. Properly sized and tuned injectors deliver the correct amount of fuel regardless of their maximum capacity. The ECU simply opens them for a shorter duration. There's no "power offset" from larger injectors, provided they are:

- Not so large that minimum pulse width becomes an issue (affects idle quality, not peak power)
- Properly characterized in the FlashPro calibration (injector dead times, slopes, offsets)

The only concern is idle quality and low-RPM smoothness with very oversized injectors (1000cc+ on an NA engine making ~220 WHP). With 440-550cc injectors on my 220+ WHP NA K20Z3, there should be zero drivability compromises.

Is the Main Benefit Power or Knock Resistance?

On my NA K20Z3, it's honestly a combination of both, but the power gains are modest. Here's my honest take:

- The knock resistance is nice but less critical on NA than turbo. My K20Z3 at 11.0:1 compression on 93 octane isn't severely knock-limited in most conditions.
- The power gains are real but modest (5-15 WHP).
- The real-time ethanol reading from the flex fuel sensor is useful for peace of mind and data logging but isn't a game-changer by itself.
- **The biggest practical benefit might be the ability to run E30-E40 blends for a modest power bump with minimal fuel economy penalty,** rather than running straight E85.

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6. Daily Driveability Concerns

Fuel Economy Penalty

- **E85:** I should expect approximately 25-30% worse fuel economy compared to 93 octane gasoline. If I currently get 26 MPG mixed, expect 18-20 MPG on E85.
- **E30:** Roughly 10-12% worse fuel economy. Much more manageable for daily driving.
- **E50:** Roughly 15-20% worse fuel economy.
- **The fuel economy penalty is the single biggest downside of E85 for daily driving.** E85 is often cheaper per gallon than 93 octane (where it's available), but the higher consumption rate means the net cost per mile is usually roughly similar or slightly worse.

Cold Start Issues

- **E85 is harder to ignite in cold weather.** Ethanol has a higher heat of vaporization and lower vapor pressure than gasoline, making cold starts more difficult.
- **Below 40F:** Cold starts on E85 can be noticeably rougher. Extended cranking (2-4 seconds vs. instant start on gasoline) is common.
- **Below 20F:** Cold starts on straight E85 can be very difficult. May require multiple cranking attempts.
- **Mitigation:** Winter-blend E85 (which has more gasoline, often E51-E65) helps significantly. Running E30-E50 in winter is another common strategy.
- **The flex fuel sensor + Hondata system handles the tuning side automatically** -- if I fill up with winter blend E85 (which reads as E55 or whatever it actually is), FlashPro adjusts fuel and timing accordingly. But the physical cold-start difficulty of ethanol remains regardless of the tune.
- **Some tuners program richer cold-start enrichment and longer cranking priming for E85 calibrations** to mitigate this. I'll discuss this with my tuner.

E85 Availability

- **E85 is NOT available at every gas station.** Availability varies enormously by region.
- **Midwest US:** Excellent availability (corn belt states -- Iowa, Illinois, Indiana, Minnesota, etc.)
- **Coasts and Southeast:** Spotty to poor availability. I may need to drive 15-30 minutes to find a station with E85.
- **Use e85prices.com or the Alternative Fuels Station Locator (afdc.energy.gov)** to find E85 stations nearby.

- **This is a key consideration for me.** If the nearest E85 station is inconvenient, I'll be running mostly pump gas anyway, which makes the entire flex fuel investment less impactful (though the system still works perfectly on pump gas).
- **The beauty of flex fuel** is that I'm never stranded -- I can always fill up with regular 93 octane and the car runs fine.

Running Any Blend (E0 to E85)

Yes, with the flex fuel sensor and proper Hondata calibration, I can run any blend from E0 to E85. That's the entire purpose. Practical scenarios:

- Fill up with 93 octane for a road trip where E85 isn't available -- no problem.
- Top off with E85 at a station I pass -- the blend in the tank might read E30 or E40, and the system adjusts automatically.
- Fill up with straight E85 before a dyno session or track day -- maximum power.
- Run E30-E40 for daily driving as a compromise between power and fuel economy.

The system is completely seamless. There's no "wrong" blend and no need to drain the tank or do anything special when switching between fuels.

Fuel System Maintenance with Ethanol

- **Ethanol is hygroscopic** -- it absorbs moisture from the air. Can lead to water accumulation in the fuel tank if the car sits for extended periods.
- **If my car sits for more than 2-3 weeks** with E85 in the tank, I should add a fuel stabilizer designed for ethanol blends, or simply run the tank low and fill with gasoline before letting it sit.
- **Ethanol can loosen old deposits** in the fuel system (tank, lines, filter). After the initial conversion, I need to keep an eye on the fuel filter condition. Replace it after the first 1,000-2,000 miles on ethanol.
- **Injector o-rings and seals:** All o-rings need to be ethanol-compatible (Viton or equivalent). The Acuity rail uses compatible o-rings. If using stock o-rings on new injectors, verify they're ethanol-rated.
- **Fuel tank:** The stock Civic SI fuel tank is polyethylene (plastic) and is E85 compatible.
- **Long-term:** With proper components (E85-safe injector o-rings, quality fuel lines, E85-compatible fuel pump), there's minimal additional maintenance compared to running gasoline.

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7. Bill of Materials -- Complete Flex Fuel Kit

Required Components (with Buy Links)

#	Component	Specific Part	Price	Buy Link
1	Flex fuel sensor	Continental / GM 13577429	$50-80	Amazon (ACDelco)
				High Flow Fuel
				Racetronix
2	Sensor fittings/adapters	-6AN or 5/16" to 3/8" SAE QC adapters (pair)	$25-40	Amazon / Summit Racing
3	Sensor wiring	3-conductor automotive wire + connectors	$10-20	Amazon
4	Sensor pigtail connector	GM flex fuel sensor connector pigtail	$10-15	eBay / Amazon
5	Fuel rail	Acuity K-Series 1913-BLK	$180-250	Acuity Direct

				K Series Parts
				Nippon Power
6	Fuel injectors	Bosch EV14 550cc (primary pick)	~$200-280	See decision block below
		alt: Injector Dynamics ID725	~$450	--
		alt: Injector Dynamics ID1050x (only if going turbo later)	~$546	K Series Parts
7	Injector clip adapters (USCAR->Honda)	Required for Bosch EV14 or ID1050x	~$15-25	Included with most injector sets; verify before ordering
8	Fuel pump	DeatschWerks DW300C (9-307-1008) 340 LPH -- primary pick	~$130-160	DeatschWerks Direct
				K Series Parts
				MAPerformance
				HARDmotion
9	Fuel filter	OEM Honda or quality aftermarket	$15-30	AutoZone / Amazon
10	Fuel line (recommended)	PTFE -6AN braided line, filter to rail	$80-150	Amazon / Summit Racing

Optional but Recommended

#	Component	Specific Part	Price (Approx.)	Notes
11	Fuel pressure gauge	Inline -6AN fuel pressure gauge or sensor	$30-60	Monitors fuel pressure, peace of mind
12	Wideband O2 sensor	AEM UEGO or similar	$180-250	Essential for tuning (may already be installed)
13	Professional dyno tune	Hondata FlashPro flex fuel calibration	$300-500	Required. Must include both gas and E85 tables.

Already Owned or Planned

Component	Status
Hondata FlashPro	Already owned
Acuity fuel rail	Planned purchase

Total Cost Estimates

Scenario	Cost Range
Minimum viable (sensor + wiring + injectors + pump + filter + tune)	$685-1,055
Recommended (above + Acuity fuel rail + fuel line + fittings)	$960-1,485
Full build (recommended + fuel pressure gauge + wideband)	$1,170-1,795

Excluding the Acuity fuel rail (already a planned purchase) and FlashPro (already owned), the flex fuel conversion adds approximately $700-1,100 to my build, including a professional dyno tune.

Alternative: Pre-Made Flex Fuel Kit

Some companies sell bundled flex fuel kits for Honda K-series that include the sensor, fittings, wiring harness, and sometimes a mounting bracket. These cost $150-250 for the sensor kit alone (no injectors or pump), but save time on fitment and wiring. Examples:

- **Hondata flex fuel kit** (if available for my model year)
- **PRL Motorsports flex fuel kit**
- **Blox Racing flex fuel sensor kit**

Worth considering for the convenience factor, though buying the sensor and fittings separately is cheaper.

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8. Is Flex Fuel Worth It on an NA K20Z3?

My Honest Assessment

This is the most important section. Here's my unvarnished thinking.

Cost vs Power Gained

- **Cost:** ~$700-1,100 for the conversion (excluding fuel rail and FlashPro I've already planned/own)
- **Power gained on E85:** 5-15 WHP over a well-tuned 93 octane calibration (most likely 8-12 WHP)
- **Cost per WHP gained:** Roughly $60-220 per WHP
- **For comparison:** A set of aftermarket cams (Skunk2 Stage 2, Toda, or similar) costs $400-600 and can add 15-25 WHP on an NA K20Z3 with supporting valvetrain. Cams are a significantly better dollars-per-WHP investment for an NA build.

Complexity of Install and Tune

- **Install complexity:** Moderate. Fuel pump swap requires accessing through the rear seat access panel (the 8th gen has one -- no need to drop the tank). Injector and rail swap is straightforward. Sensor plumbing is moderate. Wiring is simple (3 wires).
- **Total install time:** 4-8 hours for me, including the fuel pump.
- **Tuning complexity:** Requires a tuner experienced with FlashPro flex fuel calibrations. The tune must include both gas and E85 endpoint tables. This isn't a "flash a basemap and go" situation -- a proper flex fuel tune on a full bolt-on car should be done on a dyno with back-to-back pulls on both fuels.
- **Ongoing complexity:** Minimal once properly tuned. Set it and forget it for daily use.

The "Real-Time Octane Reading" Benefit

Let me be direct about what this actually is:

- **It's the flex fuel sensor reading ethanol content (0-100%) and displaying it on the FlashPro datalogger.** That's it.
- **It's NOT an "octane meter."** It doesn't directly measure octane. It measures ethanol percentage, from which effective octane can be inferred (higher ethanol = higher effective octane).
- **The practical value** is knowing exactly what's in my tank at all times and having the ECU automatically optimize for it. Eliminates the guesswork of "is this E85 actually E85 or is it winter blend E60?"
- **But I don't need the full flex fuel system just for this.** If all I want is to know the ethanol content of my fuel, I can buy a standalone ethanol content gauge for $100-150 that just displays the percentage without any ECU integration. The real value of the full flex fuel system is the automatic tune interpolation, not the display.

For My Street Car Targeting 220-240 WHP on 93 Octane

Here's the critical question, answered plainly:

If I'm already targeting 220-240 WHP on 93 octane with my current mod list, adding E85 will bring me to approximately 225-255 WHP (realistically 230-250 WHP on a good E85 tune).

That's a real but modest improvement. My car won't feel dramatically different in daily driving. I'll notice it at the track or on a dyno sheet, but 8-12 WHP isn't a seat-of-the-pants transformation.

The question is whether that 8-12 WHP is worth $700-1,100 plus the ongoing inconvenience and fuel economy penalty of E85.

Would the Money Be Better Spent Elsewhere?

For pure power-per-dollar on an NA K20Z3, yes, there are better investments if I haven't already made them:

1. **Aftermarket cams (Skunk2 Stage 2, Toda A2/A3, Kelford, etc.):** $400-600 for the cams + $200-400 for valvetrain (springs, retainers, seals). Total ~$600-1,000. Expected gain: 15-25 WHP. This is the single best remaining NA power mod. Cams fundamentally change the engine's breathing characteristics and produce larger, more noticeable gains than fuel type changes.
2. **Professional dyno tune optimization on 93 octane:** $300-500. If I haven't already had a thorough dyno tune with my current bolt-on setup, this alone could find 5-10 WHP by optimizing timing, fuel, and VTEC engagement across the entire RPM range.
3. **Port and polish of intake manifold and head:** $500-1,000 (if done by a shop). Meaningful gains on a high-RPM NA engine.

When Flex Fuel DOES Make Sense for My Build

The flex fuel conversion is most justified if:

- **I've already done cams and valvetrain** and I'm looking for the next increment.
- **I've already maximized the 93 octane tune** and my tuner says "we're timing-limited on pump gas."
- **I have easy, convenient access to E85** near my home or daily commute.
- **I want the flexibility** to run any fuel blend without worrying about the tune.
- **I value the data logging** and automatic tune adjustment for peace of mind.
- **I plan to add forced induction later** -- this is honestly the strongest argument (see below).

The Turbo Future-Proofing Argument

This is actually the strongest argument FOR doing the flex fuel conversion:

If I ever plan to add a turbo kit to this engine, the flex fuel system (sensor, pump, injectors, fuel rail, wiring) all carries over directly and becomes essential. On a turbocharged K20Z3, E85 can add 50-100+ WHP over pump gas because the turbo engine is far more knock-limited and benefits enormously from E85's octane advantage.

The $700-1,100 investment in fuel system components now means I don't have to buy them again when I go turbo. If I size the injectors appropriately (ID725 or DW600 instead of 550cc), I'll have a fuel system that supports both NA E85 and moderate-boost turbo applications.

If forced induction is in my future, doing the fuel system now is a smart investment. If my car will remain NA forever, the flex fuel conversion is harder to justify on a cost-per-horsepower basis.

My Bottom Line

For my NA K20Z3 street car already well-modded and targeting 220-240 WHP on 93 octane:

Priority	What I'd Do
If cams are NOT done yet	Do cams + valvetrain first. Larger gains, similar or lower cost, no ongoing inconvenience.
If cams ARE done and 93 tune is maxed	Flex fuel is a reasonable next step, especially with convenient E85 access.
If my primary interest is data/ethanol reading	A standalone ethanol content gauge ($100-150) gives the display without the full conversion. No auto-tune adjustment though.
If turbo is planned eventually	Do the fuel system now (injectors, pump, rail, sensor). Size injectors for turbo (ID725 or DW600). Everything carries over.
If budget is limited	Skip flex fuel. The 8-12 WHP on NA isn't worth $700-1,100 when cams give 15-25 WHP for similar money.

My suggested mod order for maximum value:

1. Finish current bolt-on build and get a quality dyno tune on 93 octane
2. Add cams and valvetrain (if not already planned) -- biggest remaining NA gain
3. Re-tune on 93 octane with cams
4. Then consider flex fuel as a final NA optimization or as turbo preparation
5. If/when going turbo, the fuel system is already done

Quick Reference Summary

Question	Answer
Does FlashPro support flex fuel on 8th gen SI?	Yes, fully supported with real-time interpolation
Real-time interpolation between gas/E85 tunes?	Yes, automatic and seamless based on sensor reading
Power gain from E85 on NA K20Z3?	5-15 WHP (typically 8-12 WHP)
Injector size and part?	Bosch EV14 550cc. ID1050x is overkill and hurts idle.
Fuel pump?	DeatschWerks DW300C (340 LPH). DW200 is too tight on E85 headroom.
Acuity fuel rail E85 compatible?	Yes, fully compatible out of the box
Stock fuel lines OK for E85?	Yes, post-2006 Honda spec -- confirmed E85-safe per 8thcivic FAQ and community reliability reports
Total conversion cost?	$700-1,100 (excluding fuel rail and FlashPro already planned/owned)
Worth it on NA?	Modest gains. Better $/WHP alternatives exist (cams). Best justified as turbo future-proofing.
Can I run any blend E0-E85?	Yes, any blend, any time, seamlessly
E85 fuel economy penalty?	~25-30% worse MPG vs gasoline
Cold start issues?	Yes, below 40F. Worse below 20F. Run lower ethanol blends in winter.

Last updated: 2026-04-16

Clutch Hydraulics Upgrade -- 2009 Honda Civic SI (FG2 / K20Z3)

Vehicle: 2009 Civic SI Coupe (FG2), K20Z3, ~170,000 miles **Date:** 2026-04-16 **Goal:** Preventative upgrade of clutch master cylinder (CMC) and clutch slave cylinder (CSC) before they leave me stranded

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My Pick: Hybrid Racing Complete CMC Upgrade Kit

I'm going with the best available option -- the Hybrid Racing drop-in kit. It includes everything.

Field	Value
Product	Hybrid Racing Clutch Master Upgrade for Accord/Civic/RSX/TSX
Part Number	HYB-CMC-01-20
Price	$289.99
Buy Link	hybrid-racing.com
Install Guide	guides.hybrid-racing.com/8)
Fitment	2006-2011 Honda Civic SI (FG2 coupe / FA5 sedan) -- LHD only

What's Included in the Kit

- (1) Upgraded clutch master cylinder with clevis
- (1) Upgraded slave cylinder
- (1) Stainless steel braided clutch line with fittings
- (1) Firewall seal
- (1) PTFE grease packet
- (1) Hardware pack and mounting clips

Everything I need in one box -- CMC, CSC, and braided line all included. No adapter bracket needed. No extra parts to source. That's why this is the move.

> **Note:** The link I originally found (hybrid-racing.com/products/8th-gen-clutch-master-cylinder-upgrade) goes to the **HYB-CMC-01-02** ($199.99), which is the **K-swap version** for older Civics/Integras (1992-2001). It does NOT fit a stock 8th gen SI. The correct product for my car is the **HYB-CMC-01-20** linked above. Glad I caught that before ordering.

Additional Components Needed

The Hybrid Racing kit includes almost everything, but I still need clutch fluid and a bleeder tool.

Clutch Fluid -- Motul RBF 600 DOT 4

Field	Value
Product	Motul RBF 600 Factory Line DOT 4 Racing Brake Fluid

Size	500mL (0.5L) -- one bottle is enough, two recommended
Dry Boiling Point	594F (312C)
Wet Boiling Point	421F (216C)
Buy Links	Amazon -- ~$18/bottle
	Walmart -- ~$17/bottle
	BimmerWorld -- $17.99/bottle

Why Motul RBF 600: Highest dry boiling point of any readily available DOT 4 fluid. Amber color makes it easy to see when it's dirty during future flushes. Honestly the enthusiast standard for Honda clutch and brake systems.

Alternative: ATE TYP 200 Gold -- Dry 536F / Wet 396F, slightly cheaper. You can alternate gold and blue versions at each flush to visually confirm old fluid is fully purged. Clever system.

Bleeder Tool (Optional But Recommended)

Option	Product	Price	Notes
Best	Motive Products Power Bleeder	~$50-70	One-person operation, pressurizes reservoir
Good	Mityvac hand vacuum pump	~$30-40	One-person, pulls fluid from bleeder valve
Free	Two-person manual bleeding	$0	One pumps pedal, one opens/closes bleeder

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Complete Shopping List

#	Item	Product	Price	Link
1	Complete CMC/CSC/Line Kit	Hybrid Racing HYB-CMC-01-20	$289.99	Buy -- Hybrid Racing
2	Clutch Fluid	Motul RBF 600 DOT 4 (500mL x2)	~$36	Buy -- Amazon
3	Clutch pedal bushing (OEM)	Honda 46991-S5A-004	~$8	Honda dealer -- dry-rotted at 170k, 30-sec install while system is apart
4	Motive Power Bleeder (one-time, reusable for brakes too)	Motive 0100	~$60	Amazon
	Subtotal (CMC upgrade alone)		~$393	

Cross-Reference: "Do This At The Same Time" Opportunities

I'm pulling the transmission to access the CSC. While it's out, several other jobs become effectively free labor. **I'm doing all of these in one session** -- no way I'm pulling the transmission twice.

Add-on	OEM P/N	Price	Why It's Free Labor Now
Rear main seal	91214-RDA-A01	~$20	Trans is out, crank is exposed. 170k RMS will weep inside a year otherwise. Do it now.
Throwout bearing (OEM)	22810-RWC-003	~$40	Accessible only with trans out. Cheap insurance.
Pilot bearing	91006-RWC-003	~$15	Same logic.
Transmission inspection	--	$0	Visual check for input shaft seal weeping, bellhousing cracks, synchro rings.

Fresh Honda MTF-3	08798-9031, 2.2 qt	~$25	Refill with fresh fluid -- catches any residual clutch debris.

Total with add-ons: ~$493. About $100 more than the core kit, and it saves me from pulling the transmission again for avoidable reasons. The reliability-first rule says: if it's accessible cheaply now, do it now.

That's it. The Hybrid Racing kit provides the main CMC/CSC/line/fittings/grease, plus the bonus items cover every other 170k-mile wear point that's accessible only during this job.

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1. Why the 8th Gen SI CMC/CSC Fails

The Problem

The 8th gen Civic SI (2006-2011, FA5 sedan / FG2 coupe) is notorious in the Honda community for clutch hydraulic failures. Every 8th gen owner knows about this, and at 170k miles I'm basically on borrowed time. The two primary failure modes:

1. **Soft / spongy clutch pedal** -- The pedal gradually loses firmness. Engagement point drifts toward the floor. Eventually the clutch won't fully disengage, making shifting difficult or impossible.
2. **Internal seal bypass (no visible external leak)** -- The most frustrating failure mode. Fluid bypasses the internal seals inside the CMC under pressure, so the pedal sinks to the floor during use (especially in stop-and-go traffic or aggressive driving) but recovers after sitting. The reservoir stays full, there's no puddle on the ground, and it looks perfectly fine from the outside.
3. **External leaking** -- Less common initially but happens as seals deteriorate further. Fluid weeps from the CMC pushrod seal (visible on the firewall inside the cabin near the pedal) or from the CSC at the transmission bellhousing.

Typical Failure Mileage

- **60,000-100,000 miles** is the most commonly reported window for the first CMC failure on 8th gen SIs.
- Some owners report issues as early as 40,000-50,000 miles, particularly in hot climates or with aggressive driving.
- By 120,000-150,000 miles, the vast majority of 8th gen SIs have had at least one CMC replacement if still on the original unit.
- The CSC tends to last somewhat longer than the CMC but often fails within 20,000-40,000 miles of the CMC going.
- At 170k miles, if my originals are still in there, they're on extremely borrowed time (or they've already been replaced at some point -- worth checking service records).

Root Causes

1. **Inferior internal seal material** -- The 8th gen SI CMC uses rubber cup seals that swell, harden, and crack over time. Honda used a lower-grade rubber compound compared to what went in the RSX, S2000, and even the base model Civic.
2. **Heat soak** -- The CMC is mounted on the firewall directly behind the engine. The K20Z3 runs hot, and the CMC gets significant heat soak -- especially in traffic. Heat accelerates seal degradation.
3. **Fluid contamination / moisture absorption** -- DOT 3/DOT 4 brake fluid is hygroscopic (absorbs moisture from the air). The 8th gen clutch fluid is rarely flushed during routine maintenance. Moisture-contaminated fluid

lowers the boiling point and attacks rubber seals from the inside.

4. **Bore surface finish** -- The stock CMC has an aluminum bore with a relatively basic surface finish. As the seals degrade, they can score the bore, which further accelerates leakage past the seals.

5. **Small bore diameter** -- The 8th gen SI CMC bore is small (roughly 5/8" or 15.87mm), which means it operates at higher hydraulic pressures for a given pedal force. More stress on the seals.

CMC vs CSC -- How to Tell Which One Is Failing

Symptom	CMC (Master)	CSC (Slave)
Pedal slowly sinks to floor when held	Yes (classic sign)	No
Pedal is soft/spongy but stays in position	Could be either (air in system)	Could be either
Fluid on driver's side carpet or firewall	Yes -- leaking past pushrod seal	No
Fluid weeping near transmission bellhousing	No	Yes
Reservoir level dropping with no visible leak	CMC internal bypass (most common)	Possible CSC internal leak
Clutch won't disengage after sitting in traffic	Yes -- heat soak causing seal bypass	Less likely
Pedal feels fine cold, gets soft when hot	Yes -- classic heat-related CMC failure	Less likely
Hard pedal / pedal won't return	Rare CMC issue (sticking piston)	More commonly a CSC issue or throwout bearing

The "parking lot test": Pump the clutch pedal 15-20 times rapidly. If the engagement point drops noticeably and the pedal feels mushier, the CMC is bypassing internally.

TSBs and Recalls

- **No official recall** was issued for the CMC/CSC on the 8th gen SI.
- **TSB 07-006** (early 2007) addressed clutch judder and chatter on 2006-2007 SI models but was related to the clutch disc, not hydraulics.
- Honda did quietly revise the CMC part number during the 8th gen production run (see OEM part numbers below), which tells me they knew about the issue, but they never issued a formal TSB specifically for CMC/CSC failure.
- The Honda community widely regards this as a "known but unacknowledged" design weakness. Par for the course.

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2. Stock CMC/CSC Specifications

OEM Part Numbers

Clutch Master Cylinder (CMC):

- **46920-SVA-A01** -- Original part number (2006-2008 models, early production)
- **46920-SVA-A02** -- Revised part number (later production and replacement)
- **46920-SVA-A03** -- Further revised (current replacement part from Honda)
- Approximate dealer price: $80-$120

Clutch Slave Cylinder (CSC):

- **46930-SVA-A01** -- Original

- **46930-SVA-A02** -- Revised
- Approximate dealer price: $50-$80

Note: The revisions are primarily to the internal seals. Physical dimensions and mounting stayed the same across all revisions.

Why the Stock Units Are Inferior

Compared to the RSX (DC5), S2000 (AP1/AP2), and even the 7th gen Accord V6 6MT:

1. **Cheaper seal compounds** -- Cost-cutting during the 8th gen SI's development cycle. The SI was Honda's entry-level sport compact; the RSX Type S and S2000 were premium products with better component sourcing.
2. **No seal revision from Honda until failures were widespread** -- The initial design went to production without adequate thermal testing for seal life.
3. **Less robust bore finish** -- The RSX CMC has a better honed bore surface that causes less seal wear.
4. **Packaging / heat exposure** -- The 8th gen engine bay is tighter than the RSX (EP3/DC5 platform). More heat reaches the CMC.

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3. Why the Hybrid Racing Kit Is the Best Option

What I Get with HYB-CMC-01-20

The Hybrid Racing Clutch Master Upgrade ($289.99) is a **complete, drop-in solution**:

- **Upgraded CMC** -- OE genuine JDM master cylinder with better seals, better bore finish, and proven longevity
- **Upgraded CSC** -- Included in the kit, no need to source separately
- **Stainless steel braided clutch line** -- Replaces the stock rubber line that swells under pressure. PTFE inner liner doesn't expand = 100% of pedal force reaches the CSC
- **All hardware** -- Banjo fittings, crush washers, firewall seal, mounting clips, PTFE grease
- **Direct bolt-on** -- No adapter bracket fabrication, no drilling, no guesswork

Community Reception

- **8thcivic.com** forum: Hundreds of positive install reports. Considered the gold standard upgrade.
- **Reddit r/CivicSi**: Frequently recommended as "the first thing you should do" on an 8th gen SI.
- **Long-term reliability:** Owners report 80,000-100,000+ miles with zero issues after the upgrade.
- **Complaints are rare.** The most common negative feedback is occasional fitment fiddling during install.

Why I Ruled Out the Cheaper Options

Option	Price	Why Not
OEM replacement (46920-SVA-A03 + 46930-SVA-A02)	~$130-200	Same fundamental design weakness. I'd be doing this again in 60k-80k miles. Not interested in repeating the job.
DIY RSX CMC swap + separate parts	~$200-380	Need to source CMC, CSC, adapter bracket, and line separately. More research, more fitment risk, no single-source warranty.
HYB-CMC-01-02 ($199.99)	$199.99	Wrong product -- this is the K-swap version for 1992-2001 Civics/Integras. Does NOT fit a stock 8th gen SI.

The Hybrid Racing HYB-CMC-01-20 costs ~$90-110 more than cobbling together RSX parts myself, but I get a

complete tested kit with a single part number, install guide, and warranty. For a "do it once and forget it" upgrade at 170k miles, this is honestly the right move.

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4. Installation Overview

Difficulty Level

Moderate DIY -- 6/10 difficulty.

If I can do brake pads and rotors, I can do this. The hardest part is bleeding the system properly. The actual physical swap is straightforward.

Time Estimate

- **First-timer (me):** 3-5 hours (including bleeding)
- **Experienced:** 1.5-2.5 hours
- **Shop labor:** Typically quoted at 2-3 hours

Install Guide

Hybrid Racing provides a dedicated install guide for the 06-11 Civic SI: **guides.hybrid-racing.com -- CMC Upgrade (06-11 Civic Si)/8)**

Key Steps (Summary)

Does the dash need to come apart? No. The CMC pushrod-to-pedal connection is accessible under the dash on the driver's side. I might want to remove the lower kick panel (a few clips) for better access.

CMC Removal:

1. Disconnect clutch line from CMC (banjo bolt). Have rags ready.
2. Siphon old fluid from reservoir.
3. From inside the cabin, disconnect CMC pushrod from clutch pedal (clevis pin with cotter pin).
4. Remove two mounting bolts on firewall.
5. Pull CMC out through engine bay.

CMC Installation:

1. Bench bleed the new CMC before installing (critical -- see below).
2. Insert new CMC, attach pushrod to pedal.
3. Bolt to firewall, connect clutch line.

CSC Swap:

1. CSC is bolted to outside of transmission bellhousing (accessible from under the car).
2. Disconnect line, remove two bolts, swap CSC.
3. Torque to ~16 ft-lbs.

Clutch Line:

1. Remove entire OEM line (CMC to CSC).
2. Route new SS braided line, secure with zip ties or P-clamps away from exhaust.

Bench Bleeding (Critical Step)

1. Clamp new CMC in vise with soft jaws.
2. Fill reservoir with Motul RBF 600.
3. Use bench bleed kit (short hoses looping output back to reservoir).
4. Slowly push piston in and release -- 20-30 times until no bubbles.
5. Cap output port, install immediately.

Bleeding the Installed System

1. Fill CMC reservoir to MAX with fresh Motul RBF 600.
2. Bleed at CSC bleeder valve (furthest point from CMC).
3. **Pressure bleeder method:** Attach to reservoir, pressurize to 10-15 PSI, open bleeder, let fluid flow until clear with zero bubbles.
4. **Manual method:** Helper pumps pedal 3-4 times, holds down. Open bleeder to release fluid/air. Close bleeder. Release pedal. Repeat.
5. Pump clutch pedal 20-30 times -- should be firm with consistent engagement point.
6. If soft, repeat bleeding. Air in the system is the #1 post-install problem.
7. Check all connections for leaks. Top off reservoir.

Tips From My Research

- **Do NOT let the reservoir run dry during bleeding.** Air in the CMC = start over.
- **Brake fluid destroys paint.** Keep a spray bottle of water handy for immediate rinse.
- **New crush washers every time** you disconnect a banjo bolt.
- **The clevis pin under the dash is fiddly.** Small flashlight + magnetic pickup tool helps.
- **Second bleed after 1 week of driving** is good practice -- lets micro-air work out.

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5. Ongoing Maintenance

Clutch Fluid Flush Interval

- **Honda's recommendation:** No specific interval (this is part of the problem with the stock system failing).
- **Community recommendation: Every 2 years or 30,000 miles**, whichever comes first.
- **Track use / aggressive driving:** Every year or 15,000 miles.
- Clutch fluid has its own reservoir (separate from brakes on the 8th gen SI), so flushing is quick and cheap.

Post-Upgrade Checklist

- [ ] Flush clutch fluid every 2 years / 30,000 miles with fresh Motul RBF 600
- [ ] Visually inspect CMC reservoir level at every oil change
- [ ] Check for leaks at CMC, CSC, and all line fittings annually
- [ ] If the pedal ever feels different, bleed the system immediately

Is This a "Do It Once and Forget It" Upgrade?

Yes, with basic maintenance. The Hybrid Racing kit components are fundamentally better than stock. Owners routinely report 100,000+ miles with zero issues. Flush the fluid on schedule and I should never have to think about clutch hydraulics again for the life of this car. The stainless braided line is a lifetime part.

Last updated: 2026-04-16

Suspension -- Coilovers + Full Refresh

Status: Research Complete, Not Yet Purchased

My Build Philosophy

At 170,000 miles, every rubber bushing, shock, and joint in my suspension is degraded. Rather than just replacing worn parts with OEM equivalents, I'm treating this as an opportunity to do a complete suspension overhaul -- coilovers for adjustable ride height and damping, fresh polyurethane bushings throughout, upgraded sway bars, and proper alignment correction for a lowered car.

This fits my build's daily/sport duality perfectly: coilovers with adjustable damping can be softened for daily commuting and stiffened for spirited driving, just like my valved exhaust switches between quiet and loud.

FG2 Suspension Layout -- Every Component

Front Suspension (MacPherson Strut)

Component	Qty	What It Does	170k Status
Strut assemblies (shock + spring combined)	2	Controls body motion, dive, roll -- the single most important suspension component	Degraded. OEM shocks last 60-100k miles. At 170k, mine are providing maybe 50-60% of original damping.
Strut top mounts (bearing + rubber isolator)	2	Allows strut to rotate during steering, isolates road harshness from chassis	Rubber hardened, bearing likely worn. I've been hearing creaking when turning.
Bump stops + dust boots	2	Prevents harsh bottoming out, protects shock shaft from debris	Likely cracked or detached from strut body
Lower control arms (LCA)	2	Primary structural link -- connects wheel to subframe	Arms themselves are fine (steel). Bushings are the issue.
LCA compliance bushings	4 (2/arm)	Allows controlled arm movement while isolating vibration. Front bushing + rear bushing per arm.	First-to-fail item. Almost certainly cracked, torn, or mushy. Causes clunking and steering vagueness.
Lower ball joints	2	Pivot point connecting LCA to steering knuckle. Allows vertical + rotational movement.	Need to check for play. 170k is past typical ball joint life (80-120k).
Tie rod ends (outer)	2	Connects tie rod to steering knuckle. Transmits steering input to wheel.	Likely worn -- I need to check for play by grabbing tire at 3/9 o'clock and rocking.
Tie rod ends (inner)	2	Connects steering rack to tie rod. Less wear-prone than outers.	Inspect. Replace if play detected.
Sway bar (anti-roll bar)	1	Connects left and right suspension to resist body roll in corners	SI-specific (thicker than base Civic). Bar itself is fine -- bushings wear out.
Sway bar bushings	2	Frame-mounted rubber bushings holding sway bar to chassis	Hardened and cracked at 170k. Causes clunking.
Sway bar end links	2	Connects sway bar ends to each strut/LCA. Ball joints at each end.	Bushings likely worn. Clunking over bumps.

Wheel bearings/hubs	2	Sealed bearing units allowing wheel rotation. 5-lug pattern.	Sealed, non-serviceable. Replace only if noise/play detected.
Steering knuckles	2	Structural -- holds wheel bearing, connects to ball joints and tie rods	Fine unless physically damaged

Rear Suspension (Multi-Link)

Component	Qty	What It Does	170k Status
Shock absorbers (separate from springs)	2	Controls rear body motion and rebound	Degraded. May be visibly leaking fluid.
Coil springs	2	Supports vehicle weight, determines rear ride height and rate	SI-specific (stiffer than base Civic). Springs rarely fail but I'll check for sag.
Shock top mounts	2	Upper attachment point for shock. Rubber isolation.	Rubber compressed/cracked at 170k
Bump stops	2	Prevents excessive rebound travel	Likely deteriorated
Lower control arms	2	Primary rear suspension link. Controls wheel position.	Arms fine -- bushings wear. Honda TSB exists for revised geometry (stamped "C").
Lower control arm bushings	4	Compliance bushings at forward and rear attachment points	Worn -- causes rear instability and creaking
Upper control arms	2	Secondary link. Controls camber geometry. Stock has NO camber adjustment.	Arms fine. No factory rear camber adjustment -- aftermarket adjustable arms are critical if I'm lowering the car.
Upper control arm bushings	4	Attachment point bushings	Worn -- causes camber drift and uneven tire wear
Trailing arms	2	Longitudinal members controlling fore/aft wheel position	SI has reinforced trailing arms. Structure is fine.
Trailing arm bushings	4	Front and rear bushings per trailing arm	Known high-mileage failure point. Hardened, cracked. Causes creaking and rear instability.
Sway bar	1	Rear anti-roll bar. Stock SI rear bar is small/weak.	Bar is fine -- bushings wear. Upgrading the rear bar is one of the highest-value handling mods I can do.
Sway bar bushings	2	Frame-mounted bushings	Deteriorated at 170k
Sway bar end links	2	Connects sway bar to rear suspension arms	Bushings worn
Wheel bearings/hubs	2	Sealed bearing units	Replace only if noise/play
Rear knuckles	2	Structural -- holds hub, connects all rear links	Fine unless damaged

Component-by-Component: Options, Research, and Buy Links

1. Coilovers -- Going with coilovers, no question

Coilovers replace the front strut assemblies (shock + spring) and rear shocks + springs with a single adjustable unit per corner. Ride height adjustment and (on most) damping adjustment.

What I was looking for:

- Monotube design (better heat dissipation than twin-tube)

- 30+ clicks of damping adjustment (more = finer tuning)
- Pillow ball front camber plates (allows camber adjustment without separate bolts)
- Rebuildable/revalveable (extends lifetime, allows future tuning)
- Appropriate spring rates for street/sport use (6-8 kg/mm front, 4-6 kg/mm rear)

Coilover	Part Number	Spring Rates	Damping	Drop Range	Price	Notes
BC Racing BR	A-18-BR	6K/6K (custom free)	30-click	1-3"	~$1,195	Community #1 pick. Pillow ball camber plates included. Rebuildable. Massive aftermarket support. Best value for the money.
Fortune Auto 500	FA500-FA	Custom to order	24-click digressive	1-3"	~$1,978	Premium. 5-year warranty. Rebuildable/revalveable. "Buy once cry once." Best ride quality in this class. 4-8 week build time.
Tein Flex Z	VSB14-CUAA1	Proprietary	16-click	1-3"	~$1,045	Solid mid-range. Includes upper mounts with camber. Good daily comfort. Less adjustability than BC.
KW V1	10250052	Fixed	None (pre-set)	1-2.6"	~$1,694	German quality. Excellent ride. No damping adjustment at this price = hard sell vs BC or Fortune Auto.
Skunk2 Pro-ST	541-05-8750	8K/6K	12-click	Adjustable	~$1,147	Decent option. Less community support than BC Racing.
K-Tuned K1 Street	--	8K/6K	36-click	Adjustable	~$1,059	Good specs on paper. Less real-world feedback than BC Racing.
Godspeed Mono-SS	--	--	16-click	Adjustable	~$675	Budget. Ride quality complaints come up a lot.
Truhart StreetPlus	--	--	36-click	Adjustable	~$619-699	Budget. Mixed reviews.

Buy Links -- BC Racing BR (A-18-BR):

Retailer	Price	Link
K Series Parts	~$1,195	K Series Parts
BC Racing Direct	~$1,195	BC Racing
Redline360	~$1,195	Redline360

Buy Links -- Fortune Auto 500 (FA500-FA):

Retailer	Price	Link
Fortune Auto Direct	~$1,978	Fortune Auto

Buy Links -- Tein Flex Z (VSB14-CUAA1):

Retailer	Price	Link
Springrates.com	~$1,045	Springrates

My pick: BC Racing BR (A-18-BR) at ~$1,195. Best value, most community support, 30-click damping, pillow ball camber plates included, rebuildable, custom spring rates at no extra charge. The 8th gen Civic SI community overwhelmingly recommends these, and after going through all the options, I agree.

If my budget allowed and I wanted the absolute best ride quality: Fortune Auto 500 at ~$1,978 with 5-year warranty and custom valving. But that's nearly double the price for diminishing returns on a street car.

2. Rear Camber Arms -- Non-Negotiable with Coilovers

The FG2 has **zero factory rear camber adjustment.** When I lower the car, the rear wheels tilt inward (negative camber) beyond acceptable limits. Without adjustable rear camber arms, my rear tires will eat through the inner edges in months. Not optional.

Product	Part Number	Adjustment	Construction	Bushing Type	Price	Notes
Skunk2 Pro Series	516-05-0625 (Gold)	6+ degrees total	Forged steel + 7075 aluminum	Polyurethane + spherical	~$333-350	Gold standard. Telescoping design -- adjust camber without removing the arm. Best quality.
Skunk2 Pro Series	516-05-0620 (Hard Anodized)	6+ degrees total	Same as above	Same	~$333-350	Same thing, different finish
Godspeed Gen3	AK-043-G3	Adjustable	CNC 6061 aluminum	Spherical bearings	~$238	Best budget option. 40% stiffer, 30% lighter than stock. Lifetime warranty.
Godspeed Gen2	AK-043	Adjustable	CNC 6061 aluminum	Polyurethane	~$179	Budget. Gen3 with spherical bearings preferred over Gen2.
Hardrace	--	Adjustable	Steel/aluminum	Hardened rubber or pillow ball	~$150-200	Solid option. Check buyhardrace.com for current 8th gen catalog.
SPC	--	Adjustable	--	--	~$150-200	Check SPC catalog for current part number

Buy Links -- Skunk2 Pro Series (516-05-0625):

Retailer	Link
Skunk2 Direct	Skunk2
K Series Parts	K Series Parts
Hybrid Racing	Hybrid Racing

Buy Links -- Godspeed Gen3 (AK-043-G3):

Retailer	Link
K Series Parts	K Series Parts

My pick: Skunk2 Pro Series (516-05-0625) at ~$333. The telescoping adjustment design (no removal needed for camber changes) is worth the premium over Godspeed. This is a "set it and maybe adjust later" part -- I want quality here.

Budget alternative: Godspeed Gen3 (AK-043-G3) at ~$238 with spherical bearings. Still a solid option if I need to save.

3. Front Camber Adjustment

The BC Racing BR coilovers include pillow ball camber plates for the front -- those give me ~2 degrees of front camber adjustment. But additional fine-tuning with camber bolts is useful and cheap.

Product	Part Number	Adjustment	Price	Notes
SPC EZ-Cam 14mm	81260	+/- 1.75 per bolt	~$25-36/pair	Industry standard. 1 bolt/side = +/- 1.75. 2 bolts/side = +/- 3.
Ingalls 81260	81260	Same	~$25-36	Same product -- SPC and Ingalls are the same manufacturer.

Buy Links:

Retailer	Link
HARDmotion	HARDmotion -- $25
Amazon	Search "SPC 81260"

My pick: SPC 81260 at ~$30. Cheap insurance for fine-tuning front camber. Nice-to-have since the BC Racing camber plates handle most adjustment, but for $30 there's no reason not to.

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4. Full Suspension Bushing Kit -- Must-Have at 170k Miles

At 170,000 miles, every rubber bushing in my suspension is shot -- hardened, cracked, or torn. Replacing them all with polyurethane is the second biggest "feel" upgrade after coilovers. **I'm doing this while the suspension is apart for the coilover install -- no way I'm taking it all apart twice.**

Product	Part Number	Material	What's Included	Price	Notes
Energy Suspension Master Kit	16.18114G (Black)	Hyper-Flex polyurethane	Front LCA bushings, rear LCA bushings, knuckle bushings, front sway bar bushings, rear sway bar bushings	~$278	Most complete kit. One box, everything I need.
Energy Suspension Master Kit	16.18114R (Red)	Same	Same	~$278	Same kit, red color
Prothane Complete Kit	82020 (Red)	Polyurethane	Front/rear control arm bushings, sway bar bushings	~$248	Good kit. Does NOT include front bushing on rear trailing arm -- supplement with Hardrace 6926. Includes Super Grease. Lifetime warranty.
Prothane Complete Kit	8-2020-BL (Black)	Same	Same	~$248	Same kit, black color

Buy Links -- Energy Suspension (16.18114G):

Retailer	Link
HARDmotion	HARDmotion -- $278
Amazon	Search "Energy Suspension 16.18114"

Buy Links -- Prothane (82020):

Retailer	Link
Prothane Direct	Prothane
Amazon	Search "Prothane 82020"

My pick: Energy Suspension 16.18114G at ~$278. Most complete coverage in a single kit. Going with black because red bushings peeking out aren't my thing.

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5. Rear Trailing Arm Bushings -- Must-Have at 170k Miles

These are a **known high-mileage failure point** on the 8th gen Civic. The Energy Suspension master kit covers most bushings, but the front bushing on the rear trailing arm may need to be purchased separately depending on kit coverage.

Product	Part Number	Material	Price	Notes
Hardrace Hardened Rubber	6926	Hardened rubber	~$143-184	My preference for street. No greasing required. Less NVH than spherical. 2-piece set covers both sides.
Energy Suspension	Included in 16.18114	Polyurethane	Included	Need to check kit contents for trailing arm coverage
Prothane 8319	8319	Polyurethane	~$50-70	Rear control arm bushing kit. Supplements Prothane 82020 which misses the front trailing arm bushing.

Buy Links -- Hardrace (6926):

Retailer	Link
Hardrace USA	Hardrace -- $143-184

My pick: Hardrace 6926 at ~$150. Hardened rubber is the sweet spot for a street car -- poly bushings in trailing arms can transmit harsh NVH that gets old quick on a daily driver. If I'm buying the Energy Suspension master kit, I'll check if it covers the trailing arm bushings first to avoid double-buying.

6. Sway Bars -- Highly Recommended

Upgraded sway bars reduce body roll during cornering. The stock SI rear bar is undersized -- upgrading it is one of the highest-value handling mods on the 8th gen platform.

Community consensus: Start with a rear bar upgrade. The stock front bar is reasonably sized. The stock rear bar is honestly weak.

Rear Sway Bars

Product	Part Number	Size	Adjustable?	End Links?	Price	Notes
Progress Technology	62.1009	22mm	No	Not included	~$220	Most popular rear bar. Cold-formed CNC alloy steel. Made in USA. Dramatically reduces rear body roll.
Progress Technology	62.1025	24mm	3-way	Included	~$349	My pick. 3 stiffness settings. Comes with end links.
Eibach Anti-Roll	4031.312	--	2-way	Not included	~$269	2-way adjustable. Good quality.

Front Sway Bars

Product	Part Number	Size	Price	Notes
Progress Technology	61.1006	27mm	~$288	Upgrade from stock SI bar. Cold-formed CNC alloy steel.
Eibach	--	--	~$217	Front bar only

Front + Rear Combo

Product	Part Number	Price	Notes
Eibach Anti-Roll Kit	4031.320	~$400-486	Front + rear combo. 2-way adjustable rear.

Buy Links -- Progress 22mm Rear (62.1009):

Retailer	Link
Progress Technology Direct	Progress -- $220

Buy Links -- Progress 24mm Adjustable Rear (62.1025):

Retailer	Link
Progress Technology Direct	Progress -- $349

Buy Links -- Progress 27mm Front (61.1006):

Retailer	Link
Progress Technology Direct	Progress -- $288

Buy Links -- Eibach Front + Rear Kit (4031.320):

Retailer	Link
Redline360	Redline360

My pick: Progress 24mm adjustable rear bar (62.1025) at ~$349. The 3-way adjustability matches my daily/sport philosophy perfectly -- softer setting for commuting, stiffer for spirited driving. And it includes end links, which saves me a separate purchase. I'll add the Progress 27mm front (61.1006, ~$288) if budget allows for the complete front/rear upgrade.

7. Sway Bar End Links

On a lowered car, stock-length end links pre-load the sway bar at rest (the geometry changes). Adjustable-length end links let me dial out that pre-load for proper sway bar function.

Product	Part Number	Adjustable?	Price	Notes
Whiteline Adjustable	KLC139	Yes (+/- 15mm)	~$154/pair	Ball joint ends. Properly sets sway bar preload on lowered cars.
Progress End Links	67.10.062	--	~$128	3-piece kit. Included with Progress 62.1025 adjustable rear bar.
Moog (OEM replacement)	K80768 (R) / K80769 (L)	No	~$25-40 each	Good quality OEM replacement. Fine if dropping under 1.5".

Buy Links -- Whiteline (KLC139):

Retailer	Link
ProCivic	ProCivic

My plan: If I buy the Progress 24mm adjustable rear bar (62.1025), it includes end links. For the front, Moog K80768/K80769 at ~$35/each are fine for drops under 1.5". Whiteline KLC139 if I go over 1.5".

8. Roll Center Adjusters -- Must-Have if Dropping 1.5"+

When you lower a MacPherson strut car, the lower ball joint angle changes, moving the roll center below the ground plane. This actually makes the car handle **worse** -- more body roll, more weight transfer, and bump steer. Roll center adjusters (extended lower ball joints) restore proper geometry.

Product	Part Number	Extension	Price	Notes
K-Tuned Roll Center Adjusters	KTD-RCA-611	10mm	~$190	Stiffer durometer bushings. Restores geometry on lowered cars. Reduces bump steer.
K-Tuned Lower Ball Joints	KTD-LBJ-611	Standard	~$139	Standard replacement. No extension.

Buy Links -- K-Tuned RCA (KTD-RCA-611):

Retailer	Link
K Series Parts	K Series Parts -- $190

My plan: K-Tuned KTD-RCA-611 at ~$190. Required if I'm dropping 1.5" or more. If I land at 1-1.5", still strongly recommended. Under 1", not needed.

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9. Extended Tie Rod Ends -- Nice-to-Have for Lowered Cars

Same concept as roll center adjusters, but for the steering rack. Reduces tie rod angle on lowered cars to reduce bump steer.

Product	Part Number	Price	Notes
K-Tuned Extended Tie Rods	KTD-TRO-611	~$200/pair	Mount upside-down through knuckle. Includes stiffer durometer bushings. Pairs with roll center adjusters for complete geometry correction.

Buy Links -- K-Tuned (KTD-TRO-611):

Retailer	Link
K Series Parts	K Series Parts -- $200

My take: Nice-to-have. Pairs with roll center adjusters for complete geometry correction on cars dropped 1.5"+. Not necessary under 1.5" drop. I'll decide based on where I set my ride height.

---

10. Tie Rod Ends (OEM Replacement) -- Must-Have at 170k Miles

I'm replacing the outer tie rod ends regardless of lowering. At 170k miles these are wear items, period. I'll inspect the inners too.

Product	Part Number	Position	Price	Notes
Moog Outer (Right)	ES800373	Front outer, passenger	~$25-40	OEM-equivalent quality
Moog Outer (Left)	ES800374	Front outer, driver	~$25-40	OEM-equivalent quality
Moog Inner (Passenger)	EV800246	Front inner, passenger	~$25-40	Replace if play detected
Beck Arnley Inner	101-7783	Front inner	~$25-40	Alternative to Moog

Buy Links: Available at AutoZone, RockAuto, Amazon -- search by part number.

My plan: Replace all 4 tie rod ends (2 outer, 2 inner) at ~$100-160 total. I'm already tearing the front suspension apart for coilovers. New tie rods are cheap insurance for steering precision and are required for a proper alignment anyway. No reason to reuse 170k-mile tie rods.

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11. Lower Ball Joints -- Must-Have at 170k Miles

I'll check for play by jacking the car up and checking for lateral movement at the wheel. At 170k, these are likely worn.

Product	Part Number	Price	Notes
Moog	K500149	~$30-60/each	OEM-equivalent quality. Two needed (left + right).
K-Tuned	KTD-LBJ-611	~$139/pair	Standard replacement. Higher quality than Moog.
K-Tuned Roll Center	KTD-RCA-611	~$190/pair	Extended. Replaces ball joints AND corrects roll center. Best option if lowering 1.5"+.

My plan: If I'm dropping 1.5"+, I'll get the K-Tuned RCA (KTD-RCA-611) -- it replaces ball joints and corrects roll center in one part. Two birds, one stone. If dropping less, Moog K500149 at ~$50/each is fine.

---

12. Rear Shock Top Mounts -- Replace During Install

Most coilovers reuse the OEM rear top mount. At 170k, the rubber is compressed. I'm replacing with fresh OEM Honda mounts while I'm in there.

Product	Part Number	Price	Notes
Honda OEM Rear Mount	52675-SNA-A03	~$20-35/each	Replace both sides. Cheap insurance.

My plan: Replace both at ~$50 total. Doing this during coilover install. Not worth skipping for $50.

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13. Upgraded Sway Bar Bushings

If keeping stock sway bars (or any bar without included bushings), upgrade the bushings to polyurethane.

Product	Part Number	Price	Notes
Energy Suspension Front (27mm)	16.5148	~$20-30	Size must match sway bar diameter. 27mm fits stock SI front bar and Progress 27mm.
Included in master kit	16.18114	Included	The Energy Suspension master kit includes sway bar bushings.
Included with Progress bars	--	Included	Progress sway bars come with poly bushings.

My plan: If I buy the Energy Suspension master bushing kit (16.18114) AND Progress sway bars (which include bushings), I'm fully covered. No separate purchase needed.

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14. Professional Alignment -- Mandatory

After any suspension work, a 4-corner alignment is non-negotiable. I'm not skipping this.

Service	Price	Notes
Standard 4-corner alignment	~$80-120	Basic. Acceptable for OEM-spec cars.
Performance alignment	~$120-200	What I want. Technician adjusts to performance specs (more negative camber, adjusted toe).
Corner balancing + alignment	~$200-400	Track prep. Weighs each corner and adjusts spring preload for even weight distribution.

My target alignment specs for street/sport use:

Parameter	Front	Rear
Camber	-1.0 to -1.5	-1.0 to -1.5
Toe	0 to +0.05 (very slight toe-in)	0 to +0.05 (very slight toe-in)
Caster	Max available (stock geometry)	N/A

Important: I need to bring the car to the alignment shop with a half tank of gas, no extra weight in the trunk, and tell the tech my target specs. A lot of shops will default to factory specs which are too conservative for a performance setup.

Optimal Setup -- My Complete Recommended Build

Must-Have (Buy with coilovers)

#	Component	Product	Part Number	Price
1	Coilovers	BC Racing BR	A-18-BR	~$1,195
2	Rear camber arms	Skunk2 Pro Series	516-05-0625	~$333
3	Front camber bolts	SPC EZ-Cam 14mm	81260	~$30
4	Full bushing kit	Energy Suspension Master	16.18114G	~$278
5	Rear trailing arm bushings	Hardrace hardened rubber	6926	~$150
6	Outer tie rod ends	Moog ES800373 + ES800374	--	~$70
7	Inner tie rod ends	Moog EV800246 x2	--	~$70
8	Rear shock top mounts	Honda OEM	52675-SNA-A03 x2	~$50
9	Professional alignment	4-corner performance	--	~$150
	Must-Have Total			~$2,326

Highly Recommended (Same install session)

#	Component	Product	Part Number	Price
10	Rear sway bar	Progress 24mm adjustable	62.1025	~$349
11	Front sway bar	Progress 27mm	61.1006	~$288
12	Roll center adjusters	K-Tuned	KTD-RCA-611	~$190
	Highly Recommended Total			~$827

Nice-to-Have (Phase 2 or if budget allows)

#	Component	Product	Part Number	Price
13	Adjustable front end links	Whiteline	KLC139	~$154
14	Extended tie rods	K-Tuned	KTD-TRO-611	~$200
	Nice-to-Have Total			~$354

Grand Total (Everything)

Tier	Cost
Must-Have	~$2,326
Highly Recommended	~$827
Nice-to-Have	~$354
Grand Total	~$3,507

Installation Notes

Difficulty: Advanced -- 12-20 hours DIY, or $800-1,500 professional labor

This is a full suspension teardown and rebuild. I'm planning to do it myself, so here's what I'm looking at:

- **Jack stands are mandatory.** I'll be under the car for extended periods.
- **Spring compressor is NOT needed** -- coilovers come pre-assembled. I'm removing complete strut assemblies, not compressing springs.
- **Bushing removal requires a press** for most bushings. I'll need a shop press or bushing removal tool set.
- **Rear trailing arm bushing removal** is notoriously difficult. A lot of DIYers have a shop press out the old bushings and press in new ones. I might go that route.
- **I'm doing ALL bushing work, ball joints, tie rods, and coilovers in one session.** The car is already apart -- doing this in phases would be insane.
- **Label everything.** I'll photograph every connection before disassembly.
- **Anti-seize on all bolts** during reassembly.
- **Torque all fasteners to spec** -- no guessing.
- **Alignment immediately after.** I won't drive more than necessary before getting aligned.

My plan of attack:

1. Buy all parts before starting
2. Remove front and rear suspension one side at a time
3. Press out old bushings, press in new poly bushings
4. Install coilovers, new ball joints, tie rods, sway bars
5. Install rear camber arms
6. Set approximate ride height (adjust later)
7. Drive carefully to alignment shop
8. Get performance alignment

9. Fine-tune ride height and damping over the next week
10. Re-torque all fasteners after 100 miles

See Also

- 06-Strut-Bar/overview.md -- Front strut tower brace (separate from coilovers)
- docs/mod-order-and-maintenance.md -- Full build order and maintenance plan

Last updated: 2026-04-16

Ignition Refresh -- Spark Plugs + Coils + VTC Actuator

Status: Planned -- Do BEFORE any dyno tune

Why This Gets Its Own Folder Now

I originally lumped spark plugs into Phase 0 maintenance, but after digging deeper into 8thcivic.com and k20a.org threads for 170k-mile K20Z3s, it became obvious that ignition is a whole system that deserves its own treatment -- especially before I flash anything with Hondata. Three things go together here:

1. **Spark plugs** -- almost certainly cooked at 170k
2. **Ignition coils** -- coil-on-plug (COP) units that get tired and start dropping cylinders under load, especially on E85 where more fuel needs more spark energy
3. **VTC actuator** -- the #1 K20Z3 gripe on the forums (that cold-start rattle everyone hears)

Doing these together, before a dyno session, eliminates the single biggest source of "tune won't dial in / mystery misfires / ragged idle" headaches that get blamed on the tuner.

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1. Spark Plugs

Stock Spec

Field	Value
OEM plug	NGK ILZKR7B-11S
Type	Iridium, laser-welded, pre-gapped
Gap	0.043" (1.1mm) -- pre-gapped from factory, do NOT re-gap
Heat range	7 (NGK scale)
Change interval (Honda)	100,000 mi
Change interval (community)	60,000-80,000 mi on a driven SI

At 170k, if these are originals they're cooked. Even if they were replaced once around 85k, they're on borrowed time. Symptoms I'd be looking for: slightly rough idle, MPG drop, misfire codes, hesitation off VTEC.

What I'm Going With

For pump gas (now through full bolt-on tune): NGK ILZKR7B-11S OEM replacement. 4 plugs, ~$40.

For E85 / flex fuel tune (later): NGK ILFR7H (or ILKAR7L11) -- **one heat range colder**. E85 burns cooler than gas but produces more combustion volume; a colder plug resists pre-ignition under the higher effective octane timing I'll be running. Community consensus on k20a.org for E85 K-series builds.

Do NOT re-gap iridium plugs. The fine iridium electrode is fragile. If the plug isn't at spec gap out of the box, it's defective -- send it back.

Buy Links

Plug	P/N	Use	Price	Link
NGK ILZKR7B-11S	4912	Pump gas tune	~$10/ea	Any auto parts store / Amazon
NGK ILFR7H	6102	E85 flex fuel tune	~$12/ea	Amazon / RockAuto

I'll verify current pricing before buying.

2. Ignition Coils (Coil-on-Plug)

A Note First

The K20Z3 is **coil-on-plug (COP)** -- there are no spark plug wires. One coil sits directly on each plug. People confuse this on forums constantly. No wires. Don't let anyone sell me wires.

Stock Spec

Field	Value
OEM coil	Denso / Honda
Part number	30520-RWC-A01
Qty	4 (one per cylinder)
Community-reported lifespan	100-150k on a driven SI

Why OEM, Not "Performance" Coils

I looked at the Accel, MSD, and Granatelli "hi-output" coils. Verdict: marketing. The K20Z3 OEM coil is already adequate for 300+ WHP on pump gas. The aftermarket "upgrade" coils add zero real spark energy at normal combustion pressures -- they just cost 3x more and sometimes ship with worse build quality than OEM Honda units.

The actual problem at 170k is that my stock coils are tired, not that stock coils are underpowered. Fresh OEM Honda coils (30520-RWC-A01) solve the problem completely.

Symptoms of Tired Coils on a K20Z3

- Random misfire codes (P0301-P0304) especially at high RPM / high load
- "Stutter" under WOT above 6000 RPM
- Rough cold-start idle that smooths out after 30 seconds
- Slight MPG drop

All of these get worse on E85 because E85 needs more spark energy to ignite (higher latent heat of vaporization). If I tune for E85 on tired coils, I'll chase phantom knock that's actually misfire.

Buy

Part	P/N	Qty	Approx Price	Notes
Honda OEM Ignition Coil	30520-RWC-A01	4	~$40-50/ea	OEM Denso. Buy from a Honda dealer or majestichonda.com for the real deal -- eBay has a lot of fakes.

3. VTC Actuator -- The Big One

What It Is

The Variable Timing Control (VTC) actuator is the cam phaser that sits on the front of the intake camshaft. It uses oil pressure to advance/retard intake cam timing through the rev range. This is part of what makes the K20Z3 feel like it has an expanding torque band -- the VTC works in combination with VTEC (which is a different system -- VTEC switches between low- and high-lift cam lobes, VTC continuously varies intake cam phase).

The Problem

The original VTC actuator has a **known weak spring** that loses preload over time. When the engine is cold and oil pressure is low (first 1-3 seconds of startup), the actuator rattles against its stops before oil pressure locks it in place. **That cold-start rattle everyone on 8thcivic complains about -- that's it.**

Left alone long enough, the actuator can fail catastrophically (lose phase lock under load, jumping cam timing) which bends valves. Not common but it happens.

Revised Honda Part

Honda revised the part silently. The new actuator has a stronger internal spring and better locking pin geometry.

Part	P/N (superseded)	P/N (current)	Price
VTC Actuator	14310-RBC-002 (old)	14310-RBC-003 (revised)	~$280 OEM

Buy the 003 part. Not 002. Any dealer ordering by VIN will ship the 003; the 002 has been end-of-life'd but aftermarket sellers still list it.

When To Do It

Ideal: during timing chain inspection. The actuator is the first thing you pull when the timing cover comes off. Labor is effectively free if I'm already in there.

Also ideal: before the full bolt-on tune. If I tune on a weak VTC actuator, the tuner will chase phantom cam timing issues. Fresh actuator = clean baseline.

Absolutely required: before E85 tune. E85 runs more timing advance; if the VTC can't hold phase precisely, I'll get unpredictable tune behavior.

Symptom Check (How I'll Know Mine Is Bad)

1. **Cold-start rattle** for 1-3 seconds after first morning start, goes away once oil pressure builds. That's the diagnostic.
2. **Worst case:** persistent rattle even warm. Replace immediately, don't drive.
3. **FlashPro datalog:** cam timing actual vs. commanded will show oscillation or lag at idle-to-2500 RPM transitions.

Cost Summary

Item	Price
NGK ILZKR7B-11S x4 (pump gas)	~$40
Honda OEM coils 30520-RWC-A01 x4	~$160-200
Honda VTC actuator 14310-RBC-003	~$280
Later: NGK ILFR7H x4 (E85 swap)	~$50
Subtotal (do-it-all-now)	~$480-520

Labor if someone else does it: add ~$150-300 for the VTC actuator (timing cover off). Plugs + coils are a 30-minute DIY job.

Where This Sits in the Mod Order

Phase 0.5 -- between Phase 0 (fluids/maintenance) and Phase 1 (already-purchased installs). Specifically:

- BEFORE FlashPro first flash -> clean baseline for datalogging
- BEFORE any dyno session -> no phantom misfire/timing issues
- WITH timing chain inspection -> VTC labor is free

See Also

- docs/mod-order-and-maintenance.md -- where this slots in the master plan
- 07-Hondata-FlashPro/ -- the tune this enables

Last updated: 2026-04-18

Cooling System Refresh -- Radiator, Thermostat, Hoses

Status: Planned -- Do BEFORE headers and BEFORE E85 tune

Why This Gets Its Own Folder

At 170,000 miles, my radiator is a ticking time bomb. The FG2 OEM radiator has plastic end tanks that crack around 150-180k -- the passenger-side end tank is the usual first failure. Symptom is steam from the front of the engine bay and coolant on the driveway, usually on a hot summer day when I least want to deal with it.

On top of that, full bolt-ons + E85 + 240 WHP will dump meaningfully more heat into the cooling system than the car was designed for. More combustion -> more heat -> higher coolant temps -> potential heat soak during a summer dyno session or a hard canyon run.

I'm proactively replacing the whole cooling side of the engine while I'm doing everything else. No surprises, better thermal headroom.

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1. Radiator

Why I'm Upgrading, Not Just Replacing

If I was staying stock I'd just buy another OEM plastic-tank radiator and drive on. But at my power target, the all-aluminum aftermarket radiator does two things that actually matter:

1. **More heat rejection** -- roughly 15-20% larger core volume, full-aluminum end tanks, better fin density
2. **No plastic end tanks to crack** -- the #1 failure point on the OEM unit is simply gone

The gain isn't just peace of mind. E85 dumps noticeably more heat into coolant than pump gas (higher fuel volume, more combustion mass). A hot dyno session on pump gas with the stock radiator would probably be fine. On E85 full bolt-on, margins get thinner.

Options

Radiator	Core	End Tanks	Fitment	Approx Price	Notes
Koyorad HH060063	All-aluminum, 36mm core	Aluminum	Direct fit FG2/FA5	~$250	My pick. Proven on 8thcivic. No modification needed.
Mishimoto MMRAD-CIV-06SI	All-aluminum, 42mm core	Aluminum	Direct fit	~$370	Thicker core. Overkill for NA. Lifetime warranty.
OEM Honda 19010-RRB-A51	Plastic/aluminum	Plastic	Direct fit	~$180	Same design that failed once already. Don't buy this twice.
PWR C-4418	All-aluminum	Aluminum	Fit requires trimming	~$450	Race-grade. Overkill for street.

Decision: Koyorad HH060063. Sweet spot for a street/autox FG2 at 240 WHP on E85 -- enough extra capacity to matter, no fitment drama, and $120 cheaper than the Mishimoto for essentially the same functional outcome at my power level. The Mishimoto's thicker core is nice but genuinely unnecessary for NA.

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2. Thermostat

Stock vs Low-Temp -- Why I'm Going Stock

A lot of guys default to a 160F low-temp thermostat with every cooling upgrade. **I'm not doing that.** Here's why:

- FlashPro has full control of the cooling fan tables. I can tune my fan on-point to 185-195F and keep coolant temps right where I want them through software, without hacking the thermostat spec.
- The K20Z3 wants to be at 190-200F for optimal combustion efficiency. Running it cold hurts fuel economy, increases wear, and causes more blow-by (PCV makes more work).
- Honda's 180F-opening stock thermostat is correct for the engine.

I'll replace with the OEM part and tune the fan tables in Hondata to manage heat.

Part	P/N	Price
Honda OEM Thermostat	19301-RNA-305 (or superseded equivalent)	~$25
Honda OEM Thermostat Gasket/O-ring	19305-PR3-004	~$5

3. Hoses

OEM rubber hoses at 170k are almost certainly leaching plasticizer, soft, and overdue. Doing them now while the system is drained means no extra coolant loss and no extra labor.

Hose	Honda P/N	Price
Upper radiator hose	19501-RRB-A00	~$30
Lower radiator hose	19502-RRB-A00	~$30
Heater hoses (pair)	79721-SNA-A00 / 79725-SNA-A00	~$40

Silicone hose upgrade? Not worth it for NA. Silicone's big win is higher burst pressure at heat, which matters on forced induction. For NA bolt-ons, OEM rubber at fresh condition is fine and cheaper.

4. Water Pump

The water pump is driven by the timing chain -- inspect when the timing chain comes off, replace proactively if I'm already in there. This is already covered in my timing chain inspection section.

Part	P/N	Price	Notes
Honda OEM Water Pump	19200-RAA-A01	~$80	Replace proactively at 170k timing chain service
Honda OEM Water Pump Gasket	19222-PNA-003	~$8	Fresh gasket mandatory

5. Coolant

Type

Honda Type 2 coolant (blue). Premix, do not dilute further. Using anything else voids the water pump and head gasket longevity guarantees (the additive package is specific).

- **Honda OL999-9011 (Type 2 premix, 1 gallon)** -- ~$25/gallon, buy 2 gallons (system holds ~1.3 gallons but I need extra for bleeding/topping)

Do NOT use:

- Prestone "universal" -- wrong additive package
- Green ethylene glycol -- completely incompatible
- "Water Wetter" only -- not a standalone coolant, and I don't need it at NA power levels

Bleeding Procedure

The K20Z3 has an air bleed screw on the upper radiator hose neck. Critical for proper fill:

1. Fill radiator slowly with engine cold, bleed screw open
2. Close cap, run engine with heater full hot, bleed screw cracked open
3. Burp/tilt car as needed until no air comes out
4. Top off expansion tank to MAX cold line

Skip this and I get an air pocket at the thermostat -> overheating with a "good" temp sensor reading because the sensor is in a dry spot. Common 8th gen SI fail.

Cost Summary

Item	Price
Koyorad HH060063 radiator	~$250
Honda OEM thermostat + gasket	~$30
Honda OEM upper + lower radiator hose	~$60
Honda OEM heater hoses	~$40
Honda OEM water pump (with timing chain service)	~$80
Honda Type 2 coolant (2 gallons)	~$50
Bleed/fill consumables	~$10
Total (DIY)	~$520

Labor if I have a shop do the radiator alone: add $150-200. Water pump labor is effectively free during timing chain service.

When To Do This

Must happen BEFORE:

- Headers (I want fresh cooling headroom when I add combustion heat from the larger exhaust flow)
- E85 dyno tune (see above -- E85 dumps more heat)

Can happen alongside:

- Timing chain service (for water pump)
- Any other phase where car is up on stands

Cannot be skipped:

- If I see ANY weeping from the plastic end tank
- If coolant temps creep above 205F in summer traffic on the stock setup
- If there's a dye stain on the radiator fins (diagnostic of a seeping end tank)

See Also

- docs/mod-order-and-maintenance.md -- where this slots in the master plan
- docs/fluids-and-intervals.md -- coolant interval and spec

Last updated: 2026-04-18

Wideband AFR Gauge -- AEM X-Series

Status: Planned -- Install BEFORE first dyno tune, MANDATORY before E85

Why I Need This

FlashPro datalogs the car's existing narrowband O2 sensor, which is plenty accurate *in the closed-loop cruising range* (~14.0-15.0 AFR). It does NOT give useful data outside that range -- which means during WOT, hard transients, flex-fuel blending, or E85 operation, the ECU is essentially guessing and the narrowband reads pegged.

For any real tuning -- especially flex fuel -- I need a **wideband O2 sensor** that reads 10:1 to 20:1 AFR accurately. This is non-negotiable for E85 work. The tuner needs it, I need it to verify their work, and I want to see real-time numbers on the LattePanda touchscreen eventually.

Part I'm Going With

AEM X-Series Wideband UEGO Gauge (30-0300)

Field	Value
Part Number	AEM 30-0300
Sensor	Bosch LSU 4.9
Response Time	<1s full range (fastest in class)
Display	52mm (2-1/16") analog + digital
Output	0-5V analog (to FlashPro) + OBD-II serial
Accuracy	0.1 AFR
Price	~$230

Why the AEM X-Series

I compared this to:

Gauge	Price	Sensor	Notes
AEM X-Series 30-0300	~$230	Bosch LSU 4.9	My pick. Fastest response. Clean mount. Well-integrated with Hondata.
Innovate LC-2	~$200	Bosch LSU 4.9	Older gauge design. Slower digital display. Cheaper bracket quality.
Innovate MTX-L Plus	~$220	Bosch LSU 4.9	Good. Slightly uglier display.
AEM X-Series OBD-II	~$290	N/A (reads OBD-II narrowband)	Do NOT buy this one for tuning. It only displays the stock narrowband.
PLX Devices SM-AFR	~$180	Bosch LSU 4.9	Budget. Slower response. Fine for monitoring only.

The AEM X-Series is overwhelmingly the community's pick on 8thcivic and in the Hondata forum for FlashPro users. Not going to overthink it.

Installation -- Three Parts

1. Bung Welding

I need a 18mm O2 bung welded into the exhaust **upstream** of the catalytic converter. Two common options:

- **In the aftermarket header collector** -- best position, fastest response, most accurate. Skunk2 Alpha has a provision for this. This is what I'm doing.
- **In the mid-pipe before the cat** -- acceptable if I can't get to the collector.

Post-cat mounting is fine for long-term sensor life (less thermal stress) but less responsive to transient changes. I'll accept the hotter placement for tuning accuracy and just budget for a new sensor every 2-3 years of heavy driving.

2. Wiring to FlashPro

The AEM X-Series outputs a 0-5V analog signal that I'll wire to one of the FlashPro's analog inputs. This lets the wideband reading appear directly in the FlashPro datalog alongside RPM, timing, fueling, etc. -- which is what the tuner will actually use.

FlashPro analog input wiring: Hondata publishes a diagram in their FlashProManager help docs. The 8th gen SI FlashPro has two analog inputs available. Wideband goes on one; future flex fuel sensor goes on the other (or via the rear O2 signal wire -- see 12-Flex-Fuel-and-Fuel-System/).

3. Display Mounting

Where the gauge physically goes:

- **A-pillar pod** -- cleanest. Autometer A-pillar pod for 06-11 Civic, fits one gauge. ~$40.
- **Vent pod** -- uses the passenger-side dash vent. Doesn't block airflow to me. ~$30.
- **LattePanda display (later)** -- once the LattePanda is in, I can log the AEM reading to the touchscreen via the same 0-5V input through an Arduino ADC. The physical gauge becomes redundant. I'll keep it for analog redundancy.

Parts List

#	Item	Part/Source	Price
1	AEM X-Series Wideband	AEM 30-0300	~$230
2	18mm O2 bung (stainless)	Universal weld-in	~$10
3	Bung welding	Muffler shop, 15 min job	~$20-40
4	A-pillar gauge pod	Autometer 20400 (black)	~$40
5	18 AWG wire (power, ground, signal)	~15 ft each	~$10
6	Inline fuse holder + 5A fuse		~$5
	Total		~$315-335

Buy Links

Item	Source	Link
AEM 30-0300	Summit Racing	summitracing.com -- search AEM 30-0300
	Amazon	Search "AEM 30-0300"
	Hondata forum / Direct	aem.com

When To Install

Must be installed before:

- First dyno tune (tuner will require it -- most won't tune without one)
- Any E85 map work
- Any attempt to run richer/leaner AFR targets manually

Can be installed alongside:

- Headers (bung welded into header collector)
- Any exhaust work where the system is off the car

Replacement interval: The Bosch LSU 4.9 sensor is rated ~50,000 miles of exposed life. On E85 it can go sooner (ethanol is rough on the sensor). Budget $90 for a replacement sensor every 2-3 years of active use. Gauge itself is a buy-once item.

What This Enables

Once wired into FlashPro's analog input, the tuner can see real-time AFR alongside every other parameter in the datalog. This is what lets me:

- Verify the 93-octane tune is hitting target AFR in both valve-open and valve-closed cutout modes
- Validate the E85 calibration interpolates correctly as the flex fuel sensor reports ethanol content changes
- Catch lean-out conditions under WOT before they cause damage
- A/B compare before/after changes with real data instead of butt dyno

It's the single most important tuning tool on the car after FlashPro itself.

See Also

- 07-Hondata-FlashPro/ -- FlashPro setup that this feeds into
- 12-Flex-Fuel-and-Fuel-System/ -- ethanol sensor shares FlashPro analog inputs
- docs/baseline-logs.md -- logging plan

Last updated: 2026-04-18

Installation References -- Guides, Videos, and Resources

Everything I've collected for each mod -- install guides, video tutorials, community threads, tips from people who've done it before. Organized by mod folder.

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01 -- Clutch & Flywheel (Exedy Stage 1 + Lightweight Flywheel)

Status: Installed

- YouTube Search: Exedy clutch install 8th gen Civic SI K20Z3
- YouTube Search: K20Z3 clutch replacement 8th gen Civic SI flywheel

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02 -- Intake (K&N Typhoon 69-1014TS)

Status: Installed

- YouTube Search: K&N Typhoon 69-1014TS install 8th gen Civic SI

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03 -- Short Shifter + Bushings (Acuity)

Status: Installed

- YouTube Search: Acuity short shifter install 8th gen Civic SI
- YouTube Search: Acuity shifter cable bushings install Civic SI

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04 -- Engine Mounts (Hybrid Racing 70A)

Status: Purchased, Awaiting Install

- YouTube Search: engine mount install 8th gen Civic SI Hybrid Racing Hasport 70A
- YouTube Search: K20Z3 motor mount replacement 8th gen Civic

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05 -- Brakes (Hawk HPS + R1 Concepts Rotors)

Status: Purchased, Awaiting Install

Written Guides I've Found

- Hybrid Racing -- Brake Pad Install (06-11 Civic Si)/26)
- O'Reilly -- How to Replace Brake Pads & Rotors '06-'11 Honda Civic Si
- iFixit -- 2006-2011 Honda Civic Front Brake Pad and Rotor Replacement
- 8thcivic.com -- DIY Removal and Install of Rotors
- 8thcivic.com -- DIY: Changing Rear Brake Pads

Tools I'll Need

- 19mm socket (lug nuts + front caliper bracket bolts)
- 12mm socket (caliper slide pin bolts)
- Brake caliper compressor tool (rear calipers screw in -- I can rent one from AutoZone)
- Torque wrench
- Brake cleaner
- Anti-seize for rotor set screws

Key Notes

- **Bed the Hawk HPS pads properly.** Follow Hawk's bedding procedure: 6-10 moderate stops from 35 mph, then 2-3 harder stops from 45 mph, then drive 5 minutes without heavy braking to cool.
- Front caliper bolts: 19mm. Rear caliper bolts: 12mm.
- Pump brake pedal several times after install until pedal pressure returns.
- Check master cylinder fluid level after compressing pistons.

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06 -- Strut Bar (Megan Racing MR-SB-HC06FU-1P)

Status: Purchased, BLOCKED (Clearance Issue)

- Simple 2-bolt-per-side install once I figure out the clearance issue
- YouTube Search: strut bar install 8th gen Civic SI

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07 -- Hondata FlashPro

Status: Purchased, Awaiting First Flash

Written Guides

- Hondata Official -- FlashPro Civic Si 2006-2011
- 9thgencivic.com -- Hondata FlashPro for Noobs (process is similar for 8th gen)

First Flash Steps

1. Install FlashProManager on a Windows PC
2. Plug in FlashPro via USB, fill out registration, register with Hondata
3. Take FlashPro to car, plug into OBD2, turn ignition ON (don't start) for 5 seconds to record VIN
4. Back at PC: select "Online, Lock" and choose a calibration (start with stock + intake base map)
5. Upload calibration to FlashPro
6. At car: plug in FlashPro, ignition ON, press Program button for 1+ second
7. Wait ~5-6 minutes for flashing to complete (light stops flashing)
8. Start car, verify no CELs
9. **Save stock calibration as backup FIRST before making any changes**

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08 -- Valved Exhaust (QTP QTEC30 3")

Status: Planned

- YouTube Search: QTP exhaust cutout install DIY
- YouTube Search: electric exhaust cutout install wiring
- I'll be taking this to a muffler shop for the welding/fabrication work

09 -- Headers (Skunk2 Alpha 412-05-1930 + Berk HFC)

Status: Planned

Written Guides

- Hybrid Racing -- Skunk2 Alpha Header Install (06-11 Civic Si)/32)
- 8thcivic.com -- Recent Skunk2 Alpha Header Install Tips and Q&A
- 8thcivic.com -- Official Skunk2 Alpha Header Chat/Review Thread
- 8thcivic.com -- Skunk2 Alpha Header Install

Key Install Tips (from the community)

- **PB Blaster the manifold studs 3-5 days before.** Heat cycle + spray daily.
- Skunk2 does NOT include hardware -- only the "donut gasket." I'll need to buy: spring bolts, new exhaust flange bolts, new exhaust manifold gasket.
- Buy the Skunk2 O2 sensor extender -- I will need it.
- Remove the "Axle Shaft" cover (3 bolts) for maximum working space.
- To remove the old manifold, flip it and pull out from the cat converter area. Same process in reverse for the new header.
- EP3 OEM donut gasket part number: 18229-S6D-T31
- Budget 6-10 hours DIY. I'm leaning toward having a shop do this one ($300-500 labor) given the seized stud risk at 170k miles.

10 -- Intake Manifold (Skunk2 Ultra Street 307-05-0600)

Status: Planned

- YouTube Search: Skunk2 Ultra Street intake manifold install K20 K-series
- YouTube Search: K20Z3 intake manifold swap 8th gen Civic SI
- **Take photos of ALL vacuum line routing before removal** -- I know I'll forget where something goes otherwise
- **Block off coolant passages and run a bypass hose**

11 -- Pulleys (ATI Super Damper 918477 + NST Kit)

Status: Planned

- YouTube Search: ATI Super Damper pulley install K-series K20
- YouTube Search: crank pulley replacement K20Z3
- **Use a harmonic balancer puller -- never pry** (damages crank seal)
- I can rent the puller free from AutoZone

12 -- Flex Fuel & Fuel System

Status: Planned

- YouTube Search: 8th gen Civic SI flex fuel install Hondata
- YouTube Search: fuel injector replacement K20Z3
- YouTube Search: fuel pump replacement 8th gen Civic SI DeatschWerks
- Fuel pump is accessed through the rear seat access panel (no need to drop the tank)

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13 -- Clutch Hydraulics (Hybrid Racing HYB-CMC-01-20)

Status: Planned (Priority Purchase)

Written Guides

- Hybrid Racing Official Install Guide -- CMC Upgrade -- **Step-by-step with photos, this is the main one**
- importnut.net -- Hybrid Racing 8th Gen Civic CMC Upgrade -- Detailed walkthrough with photos
- 8thcivic.com -- 8th Gen CMC Upgrade Thread
- Scribd -- 06+ Civic Si CMC Swap Guide (PDF)

Install Overview

Difficulty: Moderate. 3-5 hours. Access is tight.

What the Kit Includes (HYB-CMC-01-20)

- Clutch master cylinder (CMC)
- Concentric slave cylinder (CSC)
- Stainless steel braided clutch line
- Firewall seal
- PTFE grease
- Hardware and clips

Step-by-Step Summary

1. **Access:** Remove lower dash panel to get to the pedal assembly
2. **Clamp reservoir line:** Use clamping pliers to pinch the reservoir fluid line that feeds the clutch master cylinder -- keeps fluid from draining everywhere
3. **Disconnect clutch line at CSC:** Using a metric line wrench, remove the factory clutch line from the slave cylinder. Hold the CSC fitting with a second wrench.
4. **Remove old CMC:** Remove the two mounting nuts from the firewall side. The CMC is buried under the cowl and brake master cylinder -- **I'll be doing this almost entirely by feel**
5. **Remove clevis pin:** Disconnect the pushrod from the clutch pedal
6. **Swap pushrod/clevis:** Transfer the pushrod and clevis from the old CMC to the new Hybrid Racing CMC (straightforward)
7. **Install new CMC:** Mount in reverse, torque mounting nuts to spec
8. **Install new CSC:** Remove transmission inspection plate to access the slave cylinder. Swap old CSC for new one.
9. **Install braided line:** Route the new stainless braided clutch line from CMC to CSC

10. **Fill and bleed:** Fill reservoir with **Motul RBF 600** brake fluid. Bleed the system thoroughly -- gravity bleed or pressure bleed. Air bubbles = spongy pedal.

11. **Test:** Pump clutch pedal multiple times. Should feel firm with consistent engagement point. Road test through all gears.

Tips from the Community

- **The CMC is the hardest part** -- it's completely buried. Work by feel.
- **Use a turkey baster** to remove old fluid from the reservoir before disconnecting anything
- **Bleed thoroughly.** Any air in the system will make the pedal spongy. I'm considering a Motive pressure bleeder (~$50) so I can do it solo.
- **Motul RBF 600** is the recommended fluid (594F dry boiling point). DOT 4 is minimum spec.
- **Have paper towels and a drip pan ready** -- brake fluid will drip on everything

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14 -- Suspension (BC Racing BR + Full Overhaul)

Status: Planned

Written Guides -- Coilover Install

- 8thcivic.com -- DIY: Installing Coilovers on 8th Gen Civics
- 8thcivic.com -- Full Coilover Install Tips/Tricks
- 8thcivic.com -- MaXpeedingRods Coilover Installation Guide (process applies to any coilover)
- vtec.academy -- 8th Gen Civic Coilover Install
- civicforums.com -- How to Install Coilovers on the 8th Gen Honda Civic

Written Guides -- Bushings

- 8thcivic.com -- Energy Suspension Bushing Kit, Front Bushing on Rear Trailing Arm Install
- 8thcivic.com -- Suspension Bushings Replacement Options

YouTube Searches

- BC Racing BR coilover install 8th gen Civic SI FG2
- coilover install 8th gen Civic SI front rear
- rear camber arm install 8th gen Civic SI Skunk2 Godspeed
- sway bar install 8th gen Civic SI Progress
- polyurethane bushing install 8th gen Civic
- rear trailing arm bushing replacement Honda Civic
- ball joint replacement 8th gen Honda Civic
- tie rod end replacement Honda Civic
- roll center adjuster install lowered Civic

Key Install Notes

- **No spring compressor needed** -- coilovers come pre-assembled
- **Bushing removal requires a press** -- a shop press or bushing removal tool set
- **Do ALL the work in one session** -- the car is already apart, no point doing this piecemeal
- **Anti-seize on all bolts** during reassembly

- **Drive carefully to the alignment shop immediately after**
- **Re-torque all fasteners after 100 miles**

General Resources

8th Gen Civic SI Community

- 8thcivic.com -- The primary 8th gen Civic forum. Honestly the single best resource out there for this platform.
- r/CivicSi -- Reddit community
- Honda-Tech -- General Honda forum

Hybrid Racing Install Guides Hub

- guides.hybrid-racing.com -- Step-by-step guides for a lot of 8th gen Civic SI parts. Really well done.

General DIY Channels (YouTube)

- **ChrisFix** -- Excellent brake, suspension, and general maintenance tutorials
- **BrenTuning** -- Hondata/tuning content
- **SpeedFactory Racing** -- K-series builds
- **BriansMobile1** -- Thorough Civic SI tutorials

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